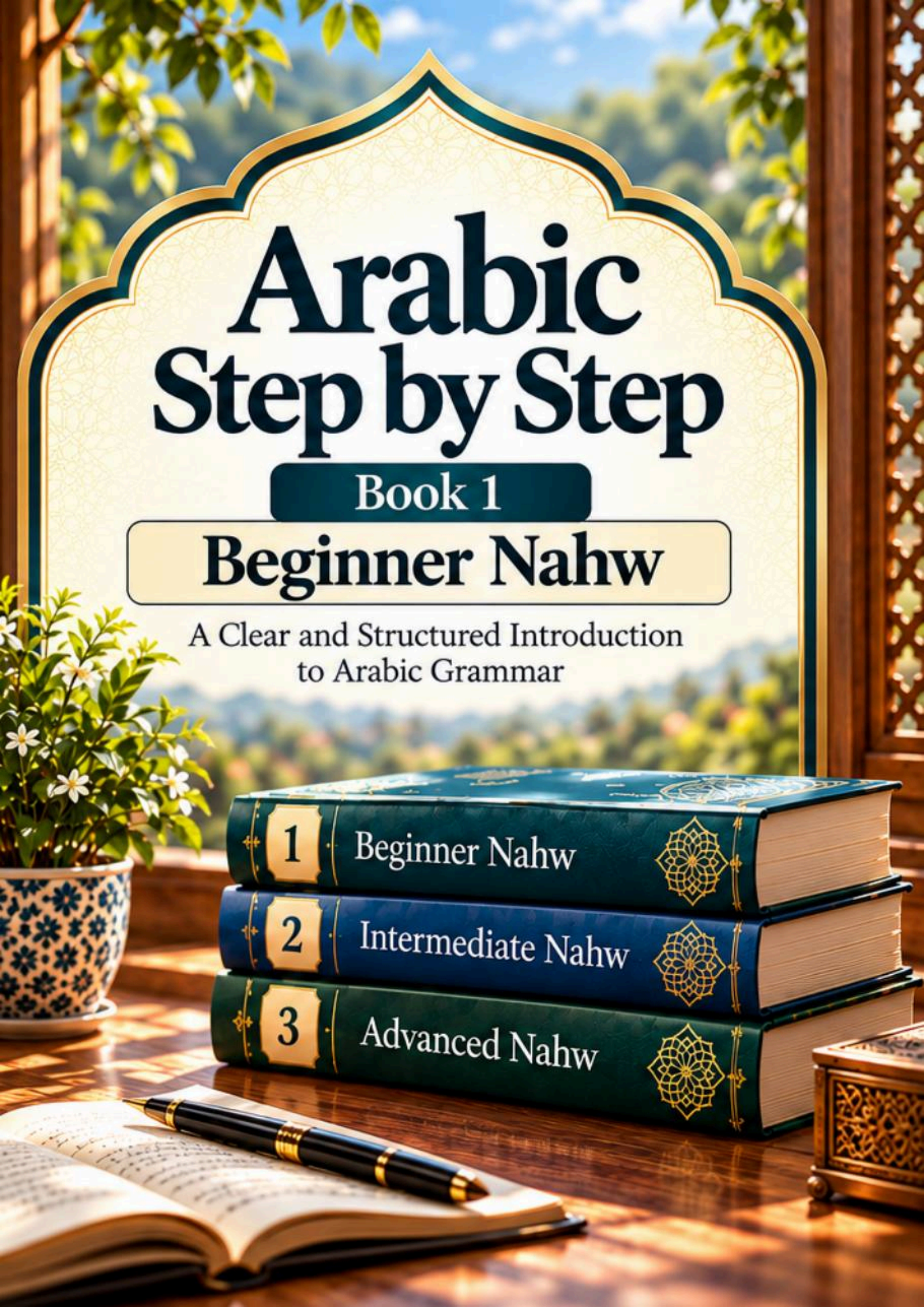
Arabic Step by Step

Book 1

Beginner Nahw

A Clear and Structured Introduction to Arabic Grammar



Publication Information

Book 1 - Beginner Nahw

Final Publishing Edition - 2026

Series:	Arabic Grammar from Zero
Level:	Beginner Nahw
Edition:	Final Publishing Edition
Publication year:	2026
Author:	To be completed before commercial publication
Publisher:	To be completed before commercial publication
ISBN:	To be assigned before commercial publication

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The visible pages use a fixed-layout design so Arabic shaping, tables and sentence maps remain stable.

This PDF also includes searchable text and document bookmarks for navigation.

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Navigation tip

The contents entries are clickable in the PDF. Full lesson-level navigation is also available in the bookmarks panel.

How to use this book

Core teaching rule: understand the idea in simple English first. Then learn the Arabic grammatical term. Do not memorise Arabic labels before you understand what the word is actually doing.

This book is the first Nahw book in a coordinated beginner-to-advanced Nahw and Sarf curriculum. It begins with almost no assumed grammar knowledge. Every major idea is taught in layers: meaning, recognition, Arabic term, examples, guided practice, independent practice, and review.

Nahw asks: What job is this word doing inside this sentence?

Sarf asks: How is the word itself built, and how does its form change? Sarf is a separate book in this series.

Standard learning pattern used throughout this book

1. Simple English idea → 2. Arabic term → 3. Easy example → 4. Visual breakdown → 5. More examples → 6. Common mistake → 7. Guided practice → 8. Independent practice → 9. Answer explanation → 10. Mastery check.

Some shorter lessons combine two of these stages, but the learning sequence stays the same.

Book 1 progress map

Unit	Topic	Status
1	Understanding grammar, Nahw and Sarf	Final enriched
2	Ism, Fi'l and Harf	Final enriched
3	The Ism in depth	Final enriched
4	Pronouns	Final enriched
5	Demonstratives	Final enriched
6	Definite and indefinite nouns	Final enriched
7	Adjectives and agreement	Final enriched
8	The two main sentence types	Final enriched
9	The doer and the object	Final enriched
10	Case endings from zero	Final enriched
11	Prepositions	Final enriched
12	Idafah / possession	Final enriched
13	Questions and negation	Final enriched
14	Full beginner sentence analysis	Final enriched
15	Revision, final exams and answer explanations	Final enriched

Diagnostic Pre-Test - Before You Begin

> **Purpose:** this is not a pass/fail test. It shows what you already know before studying. Do it without looking anything up, then compare your score with the final examination at the end of the book.

20 marks - 1 mark each unless stated otherwise.

1. In plain English, what does grammar study?
2. What is a noun?
3. What is a verb?
4. What is a pronoun?
5. In “Ahmed opened the door”, identify the action.
6. In the same sentence, identify the doer.
7. In the same sentence, identify the object.
8. Classify كِتَابٌ as Ism, Fi‘l or Harf.
9. Classify كَتَبَ as Ism, Fi‘l or Harf.
10. Classify فِي as Ism, Fi‘l or Harf.
11. What does الـ usually do to a noun?
12. What does هُوَ mean?
13. What is the difference between singular and plural?
14. Translate الْبَيْتُ.
15. Translate فِي الْبَيْتِ.
16. In كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ, who is the doer?
17. Is الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ a complete sentence?
18. What is an adjective?
19. What does a preposition do in simple English?
20. Write one Arabic word you already recognise and give its meaning.

> **Do not worry about a low score.** The answer key is in Unit 15. A score of 16/20 (80%) at the end of the course shows strong mastery of these entry-level foundations.

Permanent Visual Key

The same colours are used throughout this series whenever a sentence is visually broken into jobs.

Colour job	Meaning	Typical Arabic term
Verb / action	what happened or is happening	فِعْلٌ
Doer	who or what performs the action	فَاعِلٌ
Object	what receives the action	مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ
Particle	small grammatical word affecting meaning/grammar	حَرْفٌ
Adjective	describes an Ism	نَعْتٌ / صِفَةٌ
Case/state sign	visible sign connected with raf', nasb, jarr or jazm	عَلَامَةُ الإِعْرَابِ

Controlled Beginner Vocabulary Bank

These words are deliberately recycled so you can focus on grammar instead of learning new vocabulary on every page.

Arabic	English	Arabic	English
طَالِبٌ	student	مُعَلِّمٌ	teacher
وَلَدٌ	boy	رَجُلٌ	man
بِنْتٌ	girl	امْرَأَةٌ	woman
بَيْتٌ	house	مَدْرَسَةٌ	school
مَسْجِدٌ	mosque	فَصْلٌ	classroom
كِتَابٌ	book	دَفْتَرٌ	notebook
بَابٌ	door	نَافِذَةٌ	window
مَاءٌ	water	طَعَامٌ	food
دَرْسٌ	lesson	رِسَالَةٌ	letter/message
سَيَّارَةٌ	car	طَاوِلَةٌ	table
كُرْسِيٌّ	chair	حَقِيبَةٌ	bag
كَتَبَ	wrote	فَتَحَ	opened
جَلَسَ	sat	ذَهَبَ	went
دَخَلَ	entered	خَرَجَ	went out
قَرَأَ	read	شَرِبَ	drank
أَكَلَ	ate	سَمِعَ	heard
يَكْتُبُ	writes/is writing	يَذْهَبُ	goes/is going
كَبِيرٌ	big	صَغِيرٌ	small
جَدِيدٌ	new	قَدِيمٌ	old
جَمِيلٌ	beautiful	مُجْتَهِدٌ	hard-working
فِي	in	مِنْ	from
إِلَى	to	عَلَى	on/upon
عَنْ	from/about	مَعَ	with
هُنَا	here	هُنَاكَ	there
الْيَوْمَ	today	غَدًا	tomorrow
نَعَمْ	yes	لَا	no/not

Scope of Book 1 - What We Deliberately Leave for Later

Beginner does not mean incomplete. It means the material is deliberately sequenced. This book teaches the foundation needed to understand later rules correctly.

Covered here	Reserved mainly for Intermediate Nahw
Ism / Fi'l / Harf	expanded governing-particle systems
basic Mubtada' / Khabar	advanced types of Khabar and complex nominal structures
Fa'il / Maf'ul Bihi	the wider family of mansubat
basic raf' / nasb / jarr / jazm	full secondary case signs and detailed exceptional systems
basic negation	full syntax of كَانَ, إِنَّ, لَيْسَ and related operators
basic Idafah and adjectives	advanced dependencies, apposition and wider التَّوَابِعُ
basic sentence analysis	advanced I'rab and complex clauses

Sarf boundary: full verb conjugation, roots, patterns, weak verbs and derived forms belong to Beginner/Intermediate Sarf, not this Nahw book.

Unit 1 - Understanding Grammar, Nahw and Sarf

Unit 1 of 15

Unit 1 learning plan

Before you begin
No previous grammar knowledge is required.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Explain Nahw in plain English.
- Explain the difference between Nahw and Sarf.
- Recognise the basic parts of a complete sentence.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
نَحْوٌ	Nahw / sentence grammar
صَرْفٌ	Sarf / word-form study
جُمْلَةٌ	sentence
كَلِمَةٌ	word
مَعْنًى	meaning

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: understand what Nahw studies, how it differs from Sarf, and what makes a complete sentence.
Prerequisite: none.

Lesson 1 - What is Nahw?

Learning goal: understand that Nahw studies the jobs and relationships of words inside sentences.
Prerequisite: none.

Start with a very simple English sentence

Ahmed opened the door.

Three things are happening. There is an action, someone doing the action, and something receiving the action.

Word	Simple job	Question to ask
Ahmed	person doing the action	Who opened?
opened	action	What happened?
the door	thing receiving the action	What was opened?

Now the Arabic sentence

فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ

Arabic	Meaning	Simple job
فَتَحَ	opened	action
أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed	doer
الْبَابَ	the door	object / receiver of the action

Later, the technical Arabic terms will be:

Simple idea	Arabic term
verb/action	فِعْلٌ
doer	فَاعِلٌ
direct object	مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ

Important: do not rush to memorise the Arabic labels. First understand the job.

Why do the endings look different?

Notice that أَحْمَدُ ends with ـُ but الْبَابَ ends with ـَ Arabic often changes the end of a word because the word is doing a different grammatical job. Nahw teaches you why.

The correct learning order is: **meaning → job → grammatical state → sign on the ending**.

More examples

أَكَلَ مُحَمَّدٌ التُّفَّاحَةَ

Muhammad ate the apple.

Question	Answer	Arabic word
What happened?	ate	أَكَلَ
Who ate?	Muhammad	مُحَمَّدٌ
What was eaten?	the apple	التُّفَّاحَةَ

جَلَسَ أَحْمَدُ

Ahmed sat.

This sentence has an action and a doer, but no object. You can simply *sit*; you do not need to sit something.

> Later we will learn the terms لَازِمٌ and مُتَعَدٍّ for verbs that do not take an object and verbs that can take an object.

Guided practice

فَتَحَ مُحَمَّدٌ النَّافِذَةَ
Muhammad opened the window.

1. What is the action?
2. Who did the action?
3. What received the action?

Answer

1. فَتَحَ = opened.
2. مُحَمَّدٌ = Muhammad, the doer.
3. النَّافِذَةَ = the window, the object.

Your turn

For each sentence identify the action, the doer, and the object if there is one.

1. كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الرِّسَالَةَ
2. شَرِبَ الْوَلَدُ الْمَاءَ
3. جَلَسَ عَلِيٌّ
4. فَتَحَ الطَّالِبُ الْبَابَ

Answers with explanation
1. كَتَبَ action; أَحْمَدُ doer; الرِّسَالَةَ object.
2. شَرِبَ action; الْوَلَدُ doer; الْمَاءَ object.
3. جَلَسَ action; عَلِيٌّ doer; there is no object.
4. فَتَحَ action; الطَّالِبُ doer; الْبَابَ object.

Lesson 2 - Nahw and Sarf: what is the difference?

Learning goal: understand why Arabic grammar is often studied as two connected subjects.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

Nahw and Sarf work together, but they ask different questions.

Subject	Main question	Simple memory
النَّحْوُ Nahw	What job is this word doing here?	sentence grammar
الصَّرْفُ Sarf	How is this word built and how can it change?	word building

One sentence, two viewpoints

كَتَبَ مُحَمَّدٌ الدَّرْسَ

Muhammad wrote the lesson.

Nahw looks at the jobs

كَتَبَ - the verb/action.

مُحَمَّدٌ - the doer.

الدَّرْسَ - the object.

Sarf looks inside the word

The verb كَتَبَ is related to the root letters ك ت ب, which carry a writing-related meaning.

Form	Meaning
كَتَبَ	he wrote
يَكْتُبُ	he writes / is writing
اُكْتُبْ	write!
كَاتِبٌ	writer / one who writes
مَكْتُوبٌ	written

Easy memory: Nahw = job in the sentence. Sarf = shape of the word.

Quick check

1. Which subject explains why مُحَمَّدٌ is the doer?
2. Which subject explains how كَتَبَ becomes يَكْتُبُ?

Answers: 1. Nahw. 2. Sarf.

Lesson 3 - What is a complete sentence?

Learning goal: recognise when a group of words gives a complete idea.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

A sentence gives the listener a complete idea. A group of words can be grammatically connected but still feel unfinished.

Words	Complete?	Why?
Ahmed opened the door.	Yes	The thought is complete.
Because Ahmed...	No	You are waiting for the rest.
أَحْمَدُ طَالِبٌ	Yes	Ahmed is a student.
فِي الْبَيْتِ	Not normally by itself	It means “in the house” and usually belongs to a larger expression.

Arabic has two major sentence families that we will study later in depth:

Type	Arabic	Example
Nominal sentence	جُمْلَةٌ اِسْمِيَّةٌ	أَحْمَدُ طَالِبٌ
Verbal sentence	جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ	كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ

For now, only recognise that both are complete Arabic sentences. Detailed analysis comes later.

Unit 1 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ = Ahmed opened the door. Ask: What happened? Who did it? What received it?

Contrast pair
Nahw asks what أَحْمَدُ is doing in this sentence. Sarf asks how a word such as فَتَحَ is built and changes.

Error-correction focus
Wrong idea: “Nahw only means memorising the final vowel.” Fix: Nahw begins with meaning and grammatical job; the ending is evidence of that job.

Build it yourself
Write one English sentence with an action, doer and object. Then label those three jobs.

Spiral review
Explain in your own words why “Ahmed opened the door” is a complete idea.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 2 - Ism, Fi'l and Harf

Unit 2 of 15

Unit 2 learning plan

Before you begin
Know that a sentence is made from words with different jobs.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Classify a word as Ism, Fi'l or Harf.
- Recognise several signs of an Ism.
- Distinguish the three basic verb types.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
اِسْمٌ	noun-type word
فِعْلٌ	verb
حَرْفٌ	particle
مَاضٍ	past
مُضَارِعٌ	present/future
أَمْرٌ	command

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: recognise the three broad classical word families and their main beginner signs.
Prerequisite: Unit 1.

Lesson 4 - The three great word families

Learning goal: put Arabic words into the three broad classical categories.
Prerequisite: Unit 1.

Traditional Arabic grammar begins by dividing words into three large families:

Arabic	Name	Simple idea	Examples
اِسْمٌ	Ism	noun-type word	رَجُلٌ، بَيْتٌ، كَبِيرٌ، هُوَ
فِعْلٌ	Fi'l	verb connected to time	كَتَبَ، يَكْتُبُ، اُكْتُبْ
حَرْفٌ	Harf	particle / grammatical connector	فِي، مِنْ، إِلَى، لَمْ

Important: the Arabic category اِسْمٌ is wider than the English word "noun". It includes adjectives, pronouns, demonstratives and other noun-like words.

One sentence containing all three

ذَهَبَ مُحَمَّدٌ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ

Word	Family	Why?
ذَهَبَ	Fi'l	It expresses an action in the past: went.
مُحَمَّدٌ	Ism	It is a person's name.
إِلَى	Harf	It is a particle meaning "to".
الْمَسْجِدِ	Ism	It names a place: the mosque.

Classify each word

1. كِتَابٌ
2. فِي
3. جَلَسَ
4. جَمِيلٌ
5. إِلَى
6. هُوَ

Answers:
1 Ism. 2 Harf. 3 Fi'l. 4 Ism. 5 Harf. 6 Ism.

Why is جَمِيلٌ an Ism? English calls "beautiful" an adjective, but classical Arabic places adjectives inside the broad Ism family.

Lesson 5 - What exactly is an Ism?

Learning goal: understand that Ism is a broad Arabic category, not a direct one-to-one translation of "noun".
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

An Ism can name a person, place or thing. But it can also describe something, replace a noun, or point to something.

English category	Arabic example	Meaning	Broad Arabic family
common noun	رَجُلٌ	a man	Ism
proper noun	أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed	Ism
adjective	كَبِيرٌ	big	Ism
pronoun	هُوَ	he	Ism
demonstrative	هَذَا	this	Ism

Common and proper nouns

General type	Specific name
رَجُلٌ - a man	مُحَمَّدٌ - Muhammad
مَدِينَةٌ - a city	مَكَّةُ - Makkah
بَلَدٌ - a country	مِصْرُ - Egypt

Easy test: "What is it?" often gives a common noun. "What is its exact name?" often gives a proper noun.

Lesson 6 - Signs that help you recognise an Ism

Learning goal: recognise common clues that a word belongs to the Ism family.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

You do not always have to guess. Arabic gives clues.

Sign	Example	What you notice
الـ	الْبَيْتُ	The word accepts "the".
Tanwin	كِتَابٌ	The word carries an -un/-an/-in type ending.
After a preposition	فِي الْبَيْتِ	الْبَيْتِ follows فِي.
After يَا	يَا مُحَمَّدُ	A person/name can be directly called.

Do not overgeneralise: not every Ism shows every sign. هُوَ is an Ism even though it does not take الـ or tanwin.

Spot the clue

1. الطَّالِبُ
2. بَيْتٌ
3. مِنَ الْمَسْجِدِ
4. يَا أَحْمَدُ

Answers:

1. الـ is the clue.
2. Tanwin is the clue.
3. الْمَسْجِدِ is after a preposition.
4. أَحْمَدُ is being directly called after يَا.

Lesson 7 - What is a Fi‘l?

Learning goal: recognise the three basic verb types without yet learning full conjugation.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

A Fi‘l is a verb. It expresses an action or state connected to time. At beginner level, learn three main types.

Type	Arabic term	Example	Meaning
Past	فِعْلٌ مَاضٍ	كَتَبَ	he wrote
Present/Future	فِعْلٌ مُضَارِعٌ	يَكْتُبُ	he writes / is writing
Command	فِعْلُ أَمْرٍ	اُكْتُبْ	write!

More examples

Past	Present	Command
دَخَلَ	يَدْخُلُ	اُدْخُلْ
فَتَحَ	يَفْتَحُ	اِفْتَحْ
جَلَسَ	يَجْلِسُ	اِجْلِسْ

Full 14-form conjugation belongs mainly in the separate Beginner Sarf book. In Nahw, we first need to recognise that a word is a verb and understand its job in the sentence.

Identify the verb type

1. ذَهَبَ
2. يَجْلِسُ
3. اِفْتَحْ
4. شَرِبَ
5. يَدْخُلُ

Answers: 1 past, 2 present, 3 command, 4 past, 5 present.

Lesson 8 - What is a Harf?

Learning goal: understand what Arabic grammarians mean by Harf and recognise common particles.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

In this context, حَرْفٌ does **not** mean a letter of the alphabet. It means a grammatical particle: a small word that connects, modifies or affects other words.

Particle	Simple meaning	Example
فِي	in	فِي الْبَيْتِ
مِنْ	from	مِنَ الْمَسْجِدِ
إِلَى	to	إِلَى الْمَدْرَسَةِ
عَلَى	on	عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ
هَلْ	question particle	هَلْ أَنْتَ طَالِبٌ؟
لَمْ	did not	لَمْ يَكْتُبْ

Why particles matter

Some particles change the grammatical state of the word after them. For example, after many prepositions the following Ism becomes مَجْرُورًا. We will study that slowly later.

For now: learn to recognise the particle before you learn all of its grammatical effects.

Final review for Units 1-2

A. Classify each word as Ism, Fi'l or Harf:
1. أَحْمَدُ 2. فِي 3. كَتَبَ 4. كَبِيرٌ 5. إِلَى

B. In فَتَحَ الطَّالِبُ الْبَابَ, identify the action, doer and object.

C. Explain in one sentence the difference between Nahw and Sarf.

Answers:
A. 1 Ism, 2 Harf, 3 Fi'l, 4 Ism, 5 Harf.
B. فَتَحَ action; الطَّالِبُ doer; الْبَابَ object.
C. Nahw studies the job of words in sentences; Sarf studies how words are built and change form.

Foundation Checkpoint Exam

Complete this without looking back if possible.

1. What does Nahw study?

2. What does Sarf study?

3. Name the three broad word families in Arabic grammar.

4. Why is كَبِيرٌ an Ism even though English calls "big" an adjective?

5. Give one sign that may help you recognise an Ism.

6. Name the three basic verb types.

7. What does حَرْفٌ mean in grammar?

8. Analyse: شَرِبَ عَلِيٌّ الْمَاءَ.

9. Is جَلَسَ أَحْمَدُ a complete sentence even though it has no object? Explain.

10. Classify هُوَ as Ism, Fi'l or Harf.

Model answers

1. Nahw studies grammatical jobs and relationships inside sentences.
2. Sarf studies how words are built and how their forms change.
3. اِسْمٌ، فِعْلٌ، حَرْفٌ.
4. Because the Arabic Ism family is broader than the English category “noun”; adjectives belong to it.
5. Examples: accepting الـ, taking tanwin, coming after a preposition, or being called after يَا.
6. Past, present/future, command.
7. A grammatical particle.
8. شَرِبَ action, عَلِيٌّ doer, الْمَاءَ object.
9. Yes. “Ahmed sat” gives a complete idea; not every verb needs an object.
10. Ism.

Unit 2 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
In ذَهَبَ مُحَمَّدٌ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ: ذَهَبَ is Fi'l, مُحَمَّدٌ is Ism, إِلَى is Harf, and الْمَسْجِدِ is Ism.

Contrast pair
كَبِيرٌ is an adjective in English-style terminology, but it still belongs to the broad Arabic category اِسْمٌ.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: "Every Ism must take الـ." Fix: هُوَ is an Ism but cannot take الـ.

Build it yourself
Classify: بَيْتٌ، يَكْتُبُ، فِي، جَمِيلٌ، مِنْ.

Spiral review
Return to Unit 1: state the difference between Nahw and Sarf in one sentence.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit's main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit's review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 3 - The Ism in Depth

Unit 3 of 15

Unit 3 learning plan

Before you begin
Recognise the broad Ism category.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Distinguish common/proper and concrete/abstract nouns.
- Recognise masculine/feminine and singular/dual/plural.
- Recognise sound and broken plurals at beginner level.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
مُذَكَّرٌ	masculine
مُؤَنَّثٌ	feminine
مُفْرَدٌ	singular
مُثَنًّى	dual
جَمْعٌ	plural
جَمْعُ التَّكْسِيرِ	broken plural

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: understand the most important beginner features of Arabic noun-type words before we begin pronouns and sentence structure in greater depth.

In Unit 2 you learned that اِسْمٌ is a broad category. Now we slow down and study the Ism more carefully. This unit will teach you how to recognise several important types and features without yet overwhelming you with advanced case rules.

Remember: an Ism can be a noun, adjective, pronoun, demonstrative, proper name and more. In this unit we focus mainly on ordinary nouns and descriptions.

Lesson 9 - Common Nouns and Proper Nouns

Learning goal: understand the difference between a general name and a specific name.
Prerequisite: Unit 2.

Start with English

A **common noun** gives a general name. A **proper noun** gives the exact name of a person, place or other named thing.

Question	Common noun	Proper noun
What kind of person?	man	Ahmed
What kind of place?	city	Makkah
What kind of country?	country	Egypt

Now Arabic

General word	Meaning	Specific name	Meaning
رَجُلٌ	a man	أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed
مَدِينَةٌ	a city	مَكَّةُ	Makkah
بَلَدٌ	a country	مِصْرُ	Egypt
نَهْرٌ	a river	النِّيلُ	the Nile

Easy test: ask “What is it?” for the general category, then ask “What is its exact name?” for the proper noun.

Why this matters in Arabic

Proper names often behave as definite words because they identify a particular person or place. Later, when we study الْمَعْرِفَةُ وَالنَّكِرَةُ (definite and indefinite), this will become important.

Practice

Decide whether the Arabic word is a common noun or proper noun.

1. طَالِبٌ
2. خَالِدٌ
3. مَدْرَسَةٌ
4. دِمَشْقُ
5. كِتَابٌ

Answers with reasons
1. Common noun - it means “a student”, not one named person.
2. Proper noun - Khalid is a specific person's name.
3. Common noun - “a school” is a general category.
4. Proper noun - Damascus is the name of a particular city.
5. Common noun - “a book” is a general thing.

Lesson 10 - Concrete and Abstract Meaning

Learning goal: understand that some nouns name physical things while others name ideas, qualities or actions.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

This distinction comes from general language study. It helps beginners understand what kinds of meanings Arabic nouns can carry.

Concrete nouns

A concrete noun usually names something you can physically see, hear, touch, taste or smell.

Arabic	Meaning
بَيْتٌ	a house
كِتَابٌ	a book
شَجَرَةٌ	a tree
مَاءٌ	water

Abstract nouns

An abstract noun names an idea, quality, state or concept rather than a physical object.

Arabic	Meaning
عِلْمٌ	knowledge
صَبْرٌ	patience
حُبٌّ	love
عَدْلٌ	justice

Important: “concrete” and “abstract” are meaning-based labels. They do not replace the Arabic grammatical category اِسْمٌ. Both types are still Ism.

Practice
Label each meaning as concrete or abstract:
1. بَابٌ - door
2. عِلْمٌ - knowledge
3. سَيَّارَةٌ - car
4. صِدْقٌ - truthfulness

Answers: 1 concrete, 2 abstract, 3 concrete, 4 abstract.

Lesson 11 - Masculine and Feminine

Learning goal: recognise grammatical masculine and feminine and learn common clues without assuming that every word follows one visible ending.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

Arabic nouns have grammatical gender. The two main categories are:

Arabic term	Meaning	Example
مُذَكَّرٌ	masculine	طَالِبٌ
مُؤَنَّثٌ	feminine	طَالِبَةٌ

The easiest feminine clue: ة

Many feminine nouns and adjectives end in ة, called تَاءٌ مَرْبُوطَةٌ.

Masculine	Feminine	Meaning
طَالِبٌ	طَالِبَةٌ	male / female student
مُعَلِّمٌ	مُعَلِّمَةٌ	male / female teacher
كَبِيرٌ	كَبِيرَةٌ	big (masculine / feminine)

But do not use one rule for every word

Some feminine words do not end in ة.

Arabic	Meaning	Gender
شَمْسٌ	sun	feminine
مَرْيَمُ	Maryam	feminine name

And some words ending in ة may be masculine proper names, such as حَمْزَةُ. Therefore the ending is a useful clue, not an infallible test.

> **Beginner rule:** treat ة as a strong feminine clue, then learn important exceptions as vocabulary.

Practice

1. مُسْلِمٌ
2. مُسْلِمَةٌ
3. سَيَّارَةٌ
4. شَمْسٌ
5. حَمْزَةُ

Which are masculine and which are feminine?

Answers:

1 masculine. 2 feminine. 3 feminine. 4 feminine even though it has no ة. 5 masculine proper name despite ending in ة.

Lesson 12 - Singular, Dual and Plural

> **Learning goal:** understand that Arabic distinguishes one, exactly two, and more than two.
> **Prerequisite:** the previous lesson in this unit.

English mainly contrasts singular and plural. Arabic has an additional number category for exactly two.

Arabic term	Simple meaning	Example	Meaning
مُفْرَدٌ	singular	طَالِبٌ	one student
مُثَنًّى	dual	طَالِبَانِ	two students
جَمْعٌ	plural	طُلَّابٌ	students

The dual is special

At this stage, learn the basic nominative-looking form:

طَالِبٌ ← طَالِبَانِ

مُعَلِّمَةٌ ← مُعَلِّمَتَانِ

> **Preview only:** later, when we study case endings, you will learn that the dual ending can change from ـَانِ to ـَيْنِ. Do not memorise the case rule yet.

Plural is not always made one way

Arabic has several important plural types. We will study three beginner categories next:

- sound masculine plural
- sound feminine plural
- broken plural

Quick check

1. What does مُثَنًّى mean?
2. Is طَالِبَانِ singular, dual or plural?
3. Why does Arabic need a separate dual category?

Answers:

1. Dual - exactly two.
2. Dual.
3. Because Arabic grammatically distinguishes exactly two from one and from three-or-more plural.

Lesson 13 - Sound Masculine Plural

> **Learning goal:** recognise the basic sound masculine plural pattern and understand what "sound" means.
> **Prerequisite:** the previous lesson in this unit.

The Arabic term is:

جَمْعُ الْمُذَكَّرِ السَّالِمِ

The word سَالِمٌ here suggests that the basic singular form remains largely intact and an ending is added.

Singular	Basic plural form	Meaning
مُسْلِمٌ	مُسْلِمُونَ	Muslim / Muslims
مُعَلِّمٌ	مُعَلِّمُونَ	teacher / teachers
مُجْتَهِدٌ	مُجْتَهِدُونَ	hard-working person / hard-working people

Do not assume every masculine noun uses this plural

Beginner formation rule: this plural is used especially with words referring to rational male persons and with many masculine adjectives describing them. It is **not** a general plural ending that can be added to every masculine noun. The detailed classical formation conditions belong mainly to Sarf.

Many Arabic nouns instead use a broken plural. For example:

رَجُلٌ ← رِجَالٌ

So ـُونَ is an important pattern, but it is not a universal “male plural” ending for every noun.

Preview: later you will learn that the sound masculine plural can also appear with ـِينَ depending on its grammatical state.

Practice
Which of the following shows a sound masculine plural?
1. مُعَلِّمُونَ
2. رِجَالٌ
3. مُسْلِمُونَ

Answers: 1 and 3 are sound masculine plurals. رِجَالٌ is a broken plural.

Lesson 14 - Sound Feminine Plural

Learning goal: recognise the common ـَاتٌ pattern and understand that it is not limited only to human females.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

The Arabic term is:

جَمْعُ الْمُؤَنَّثِ السَّالِمِ

A common way to make this plural is to remove the singular ة and add ات.

Singular	Plural	Meaning
مُسْلِمَةٌ	مُسْلِمَاتٌ	Muslim woman / Muslim women
طَالِبَةٌ	طَالِبَاتٌ	female student / female students
سَيَّارَةٌ	سَيَّارَاتٌ	car / cars

Important: the label “sound feminine plural” describes the grammatical pattern. Words using it are not restricted to female humans; سَيَّارَاتٌ is a normal example.

Later, case rules will show that this plural has some special behaviour in the accusative state. For now, simply recognise the form.

Make the basic plural
1. مُعَلِّمَةٌ
2. طَالِبَةٌ
3. سَيَّارَةٌ

Answers:
1. مُعَلِّمَاتٌ
2. طَالِبَاتٌ
3. سَيَّارَاتٌ

Lesson 15 - Broken Plurals

Learning goal: understand that many Arabic plurals change the internal pattern of the singular word.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

The Arabic term is:

جَمْعُ التَّكْسِيرِ

It is called “broken” because the internal shape of the singular word changes instead of simply receiving one standard plural ending.

Singular	Broken plural	Meaning
كِتَابٌ	كُتُبٌ	book / books
رَجُلٌ	رِجَالٌ	man / men
وَلَدٌ	أَوْلَادٌ	boy/child / boys/children
بَيْتٌ	بُيُوتٌ	house / houses
مَسْجِدٌ	مَسَاجِدُ	mosque / mosques

Why broken plurals need vocabulary learning

Arabic has many broken-plural patterns. At beginner level, the safest method is to learn the common plural together with the singular word.

Vocabulary habit: do not learn only كِتَابٌ. Learn كِتَابٌ - كُتُبٌ together.

Advanced preview: broken plurals have many morphological patterns, and some have special case behaviour. Those details belong to later Nahw and Sarf levels.

Match the singular to its plural

A. كِتَابٌ
B. رَجُلٌ
C. بَيْتٌ

1. رِجَالٌ
2. بُيُوتٌ
3. كُتُبٌ

Answers: A-3, B-1, C-2.

Unit 3 Review - The Ism in Depth

What you should now know: common/proper nouns, concrete/abstract meaning, masculine/feminine, singular/dual/plural, and three important plural types.

Idea	Arabic term	Example
masculine	مُذَكَّرٌ	طَالِبٌ
feminine	مُؤَنَّثٌ	طَالِبَةٌ
singular	مُفْرَدٌ	طَالِبٌ
dual	مُثَنًّى	طَالِبَانِ
plural	جَمْعٌ	طُلَّابٌ
sound masculine plural	جَمْعُ الْمُذَكَّرِ السَّالِمِ	مُسْلِمُونَ
sound feminine plural	جَمْعُ الْمُؤَنَّثِ السَّالِمِ	مُسْلِمَاتٌ
broken plural	جَمْعُ التَّكْسِيرِ	كُتُبٌ

Unit 3 Checkpoint Exam

1. Explain the difference between a common noun and a proper noun.

2. Is عِلْمٌ concrete or abstract?

3. Give one common visible clue that a noun may be feminine.

4. Why is شَمْسٌ important when learning feminine nouns?

5. What does مُثَنًّى mean?

6. Give the basic dual form of طَالِبٌ used in this lesson.

7. Which plural type is مُسْلِمُونَ?

8. Which plural type is طَالِبَاتٌ?

9. Which plural type is كُتُبٌ?

10. Why is it useful to learn a broken plural together with its singular?

Model answers with explanation

1. A common noun gives a general category; a proper noun gives a specific name.
2. Abstract - it means “knowledge”, an idea rather than a physical object.
3. ة is a common feminine clue, although it is not a perfect rule.
4. Because شَمْسٌ is grammatically feminine without ending in ة; it shows that the ending is only a clue.
5. Exactly two - the dual.
6. طَالِبَانِ.
7. Sound masculine plural.
8. Sound feminine plural.
9. Broken plural.
10. Because broken plurals use many internal patterns and cannot always be predicted safely by a beginner.

Cumulative Review 1 - Units 1-3

Mastery target: 80%. Do this without looking back. Answers are collected in Unit 15.

1. Explain Nahw in one sentence.
2. Explain Nahw vs Sarf.
3. Classify بَيْتٌ، كَتَبَ، فِي.
4. Give two signs of an Ism.
5. Give one common noun and one proper noun in Arabic.
6. Make one masculine/feminine pair.
7. Give the dual of طَالِبٌ in the basic raf‘ form.
8. Identify the plural type: مُسْلِمُونَ.
9. Identify the plural type: كُتُبٌ.
10. Explain why كَبِيرٌ is still in the broad Ism category.

Unit 3 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
طَالِبٌ → طَالِبَانِ → طُلَّابٌ. One, two, more than two. Notice that the plural may change inside the word.

Contrast pair
مُسْلِمُونَ is a sound masculine plural; كُتُبٌ is a broken plural.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: “Every feminine noun ends in ة.” Fix: words such as شَمْسٌ can be grammatically feminine without that ending.

Build it yourself
Give one masculine/feminine pair and one singular/dual/plural set.

Spiral review
Classify each example as Ism, Fi‘l or Harf before naming its smaller noun type.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 4 - Pronouns

Unit 4 of 15

Unit 4 learning plan

Before you begin
Understand person, gender and number.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Use the 14 traditional pronoun positions.
- Distinguish detached, attached and hidden pronouns.
- Recognise possessive, prepositional and object suffixes.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
ضَمِيرٌ	pronoun
مُنْفَصِلٌ	detached
مُتَّصِلٌ	attached
مُسْتَتِرٌ	hidden
هُوَ	he
نَحْنُ	we

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: understand what a pronoun is, learn the traditional 14 pronoun positions, and recognise detached and attached pronouns in simple Arabic.

A pronoun is a word that can stand in place of a noun. English uses words such as **he, she, they, I** and **we**. Arabic does the same, but Arabic also distinguishes masculine, feminine, singular, dual and plural more carefully.

Important: in traditional Arabic grammar, pronouns belong to the broad category اِسْمٌ. So هُوَ "he" is an Ism, even though English calls it a pronoun.

Lesson 16 - What is a pronoun?

Look at the English:

Without a pronoun: Ahmed entered. Ahmed sat. Ahmed read.

With a pronoun: Ahmed entered. **He** sat. **He** read.

The word **he** replaces the name Ahmed. Arabic does the same:

Arabic	Meaning	What happened?
أَحْمَدُ دَخَلَ	Ahmed entered.	The name is stated.
هُوَ جَلَسَ	He sat.	هُوَ replaces the male name.

Quick check
In “Fatimah came. She sat.” which word is the pronoun?

Answer: “She.” It replaces the name Fatimah.

Lesson 17 - Person, number and gender

Arabic pronouns tell us three important things:

Idea	Simple question	Examples
Person	Are we talking about **he/she/they**, **you**, or **I/we**?	third, second, first person
Number	One, exactly two, or more than two?	singular, dual, plural
Gender	Masculine or feminine?	male / female forms where Arabic distinguishes them

Why this matters: the pronoun often controls the form of the verb. This is why Sarf uses the pronoun system when teaching conjugation.

Lesson 18 - The 14 traditional pronoun positions

Do not panic at the number 14. There are not 14 completely different English meanings. Some Arabic forms repeat because masculine and feminine dual positions are counted separately in traditional Sarf tables.

#	Pronoun	Plain English	Person
1	هُوَ	he	3rd
2	هُمَا	they two (m)	3rd
3	هُمْ	they (m)	3rd
4	هِيَ	she	3rd
5	هُمَا	they two (f)	3rd
6	هُنَّ	they (f)	3rd
7	أَنْتَ	you (one male)	2nd
8	أَنْتُمَا	you two (m)	2nd
9	أَنْتُمْ	you (m plural)	2nd
10	أَنْتِ	you (one female)	2nd
11	أَنْتُمَا	you two (f)	2nd
12	أَنْتُنَّ	you (f plural)	2nd
13	أَنَا	I	1st
14	نَحْنُ	we	1st

Memory structure: positions 1-6 = people spoken *about*; positions 7-12 = people spoken *to*; positions 13-14 = the speaker.

Lesson 19 - Why do some pronouns repeat?

هُمَا is used for “they two” whether the pair is masculine or feminine. أَنْتُمَا is used for “you two” whether the pair is masculine or feminine.

Traditional Sarf still places them in separate slots because the surrounding verb system keeps the masculine and feminine rows distinct.

هُمَا
they two - masculine pair

هُمَا
they two - feminine pair

أَنْتُمَا
you two - masculine or feminine pair

Lesson 20 - Detached pronouns in sentences

The pronouns in the previous table are called **detached pronouns** because they can appear as separate words.

Arabic term:

الضَّمَائِرُ الْمُنْفَصِلَةُ

Sentence	Meaning	Pronoun
هُوَ طَالِبٌ	He is a student.	هُوَ
هِيَ طَالِبَةٌ	She is a student.	هِيَ
أَنَا مُعَلِّمٌ	I am a teacher.	أَنَا
نَحْنُ طُلَّابٌ	We are students.	نَحْنُ

English difference: Arabic simple present nominal sentences usually do not need a separate word for “am/is/are”. هُوَ طَالِبٌ literally has “he + student”, but naturally means “He is a student.”

Lesson 21 - Detached, Attached and Hidden Pronouns

Learning goal: distinguish three different pronoun ideas that beginners often mix together: الضَّمِيرُ الْمُنْفَصِلُ, الضَّمِيرُ الْمُتَّصِلُ, and الضَّمِيرُ الْمُسْتَتِرُ.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

Arabic pronouns do not all appear in the same way. Some stand by themselves, some attach visibly to another word, and some are understood even though no separate pronoun is written.

Type	Arabic term	Example	What is happening?
Detached	ضَمِيرٌ مُنْفَصِلٌ	هُوَ طَالِبٌ	هُوَ stands as a separate word: “he”.
Attached	ضَمِيرٌ مُتَّصِلٌ	كَتَبْتُ	The ـتُ is a visible attached pronoun functioning as the doer: “I wrote”.
Hidden / understood	ضَمِيرٌ مُسْتَتِرٌ	أَكْتُبُ	The subject pronoun أَنَا is understood from the verb form; it is not written as a separate pronoun.

Important correction: a visible ending such as ـتُ in كَتَبْتُ or ـوا in كَتَبُوا is **attached**, not hidden. A hidden pronoun is grammatically understood without appearing as a separate written pronoun.

Where can attached pronouns appear?

Attached to	Example	Beginner job
a verb	كَتَبْتُ	doer: “I wrote”
a noun	كِتَابُهُ	possession: “his book”
a preposition	بِهِ	object of the preposition: “with/by it/him”
a verb as object	رَأَيْتُهُ	direct object: “I saw him/it”

Mastery check: In هُوَ كَتَبَ, هُوَ is detached. In كَتَبْتُ, ـتُ is attached. In أَكْتُبُ, the understood subject أَنَا is hidden.

Lesson 22 - Attached possessive pronouns

Arabic can attach a short pronoun ending directly to a noun to show possession.

English uses phrases such as **my book, his book, her book**. Arabic attaches the owner to the noun:

Arabic	Meaning	Attached ending
كِتَابِي	my book	ـي
كِتَابُكَ	your book (m sg)	ـكَ
كِتَابُكِ	your book (f sg)	ـكِ
كِتَابُهُ	his book	ـهُ
كِتَابُهَا	her book	ـهَا
كِتَابُنَا	our book	ـنَا
كِتَابُهُمْ	their book (m)	ـهُمْ

Important: once a noun has a possessive pronoun attached, it refers to a specific possessed item. كِتَابُهُ means “his book”, not merely “a book”.

Lesson 23 - Full possession suffix reference

Owner	Suffix	With كِتَاب	Meaning
هُوَ	ـهُ	كِتَابُهُ	his book
هُمَا	ـهُمَا	كِتَابُهُمَا	their book (two)
هُمْ	ـهُمْ	كِتَابُهُمْ	their book (m pl)
هِيَ	ـهَا	كِتَابُهَا	her book
هُنَّ	ـهُنَّ	كِتَابُهُنَّ	their book (f pl)
أَنْتَ	ـكَ	كِتَابُكَ	your book (m sg)
أَنْتُمَا	ـكُمَا	كِتَابُكُمَا	your book (two)
أَنْتُمْ	ـكُمْ	كِتَابُكُمْ	your book (m pl)
أَنْتِ	ـكِ	كِتَابُكِ	your book (f sg)
أَنْتُنَّ	ـكُنَّ	كِتَابُكُنَّ	your book (f pl)
أَنَا	ـي	كِتَابِي	my book
نَحْنُ	ـنَا	كِتَابُنَا	our book

Why there are fewer visibly different suffixes: the dual masculine/feminine positions use the same dual suffix, just as some detached dual pronouns repeat.

Lesson 24 - Pronouns after prepositions

The same family of attached pronouns can attach to many prepositions.

Start with لِـ = “for/to”.

Arabic	Meaning
لِي	for me / mine in some contexts
لَكَ	for you (m)
لَكِ	for you (f)
لَهُ	for him
لَهَا	for her
لَنَا	for us

With فِي:

Arabic	Meaning
فِيهِ	in it / in him (depending on context)
فِيهَا	in it / in her
فِيهِمْ	in them (m)

> **Nahw connection:** when a pronoun is attached to a preposition, the pronoun is in the grammatical position of jarr. We will learn the full meaning of الْجَرُّ later.

Lesson 25 - Attached object pronouns

An attached pronoun can also be the object of a verb.

Arabic	Literal breakdown	Meaning
رَأَيْتُهُ	I saw + him	I saw him.
رَأَيْتُهَا	I saw + her	I saw her.
سَاعَدَنِي	he helped + me	He helped me.
عَلَّمَنَا	he taught + us	He taught us.

Do not overanalyse this yet. At beginner level, recognise that the little ending can stand for the person receiving the action. Detailed object-pronoun i'rab comes later.

Lesson 26 - Do not confuse the three jobs

The same person can be expressed by different pronoun forms depending on the job.

Job	Arabic	Meaning
separate subject pronoun	هُوَ	he
possessive ending	كِتَابُهُ	his book
object ending	رَأَيْتُهُ	I saw him
after a preposition	لَهُ	for him

Big idea: the meaning "him/he/his" is related, but English changes the word according to its job. Arabic often changes the form or attaches it to another word.

Guided practice

A. Identify the pronoun meaning

1. هِيَ
2. أَنْتُمْ
3. نَحْنُ
4. هُنَّ
5. أَنَا

Answers:
1. she
2. you, masculine plural
3. we
4. they, feminine plural
5. I

B. What does the attached pronoun show?

1. كِتَابُهَا
2. بَيْتُنَا
3. رَأَيْتُهُمْ
4. لَكَ

Answers with explanation:

1. “her book” - ـهَا shows a female owner.
2. “our house” - ـنَا shows “our”.
3. “I saw them (m)” - ـهُمْ is the object receiving the action.
4. “for you (m sg)” - ـكَ is attached to the preposition لِـ.

Unit 4 Review - Pronouns

Concept	Arabic term/example	Simple meaning
pronoun	ضَمِيرٌ	a word/form standing in place of a noun
detached pronoun	هُوَ، هِيَ، أَنَا	stands as its own word
attached pronoun	ـهُ، ـهَا، ـنَا	joins another word
possession	كِتَابُهُ	his book
object pronoun	رَأَيْتُهُ	I saw him
after preposition	لَهُ	for him

Unit 4 Checkpoint Exam

1. In plain English, what is a pronoun?

2. Why are pronouns considered part of اِسْمٌ in traditional Arabic grammar?

3. Translate هُوَ, هِيَ, أَنَا and نَحْنُ.

4. What is the difference between هُمْ and هُنَّ?

5. Why does traditional Sarf speak of 14 pronoun positions even though some pronouns repeat?

6. Translate كِتَابُهَا.

7. Translate كِتَابُنَا.

8. In رَأَيْتُهُ, what job does هُ have?

9. Translate لَهَا.

10. Explain the difference between هُوَ, كِتَابُهُ and رَأَيْتُهُ.

Model answers

1. A pronoun stands in place of a noun/name so it does not have to be repeated.
2. Because the classical Arabic category اِسْمٌ is broader than the English category “noun” and includes pronouns.
3. he, she, I, we.
4. هُمْ = they, masculine; هُنَّ = they, feminine.
5. Masculine and feminine dual positions are counted separately in the traditional conjugation order even where the written pronoun is the same.
6. Her book.
7. Our book.
8. It is an attached object pronoun: “him”.
9. For her.
10. هُوَ is a detached “he”; كِتَابُهُ uses the ending for possession “his”; رَأَيْتُهُ uses it as the object “him”.

Unit 4 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
Compare هُوَ (he), كِتَابُهُ (his book), and رَأَيْتُهُ (I saw him). The same pronoun meaning appears in different grammatical positions.

Contrast pair
Detached هُوَ can stand alone; attached ـهُ must attach to another word.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: counting only 12 pronouns because هُمَا and أَنْتُمَا repeat. Fix: traditional Sarf counts 14 positions because the meanings/slots differ.

Build it yourself
Turn “book” into “his book”, “her book”, “my book” using attached pronouns.

Spiral review
Review number from Unit 3: identify which pronouns are singular, dual and plural.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 5 - Demonstratives

Unit 5 of 15

Unit 5 learning plan

Before you begin
Know basic pronouns and gender/number.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Use near and far demonstratives.
- Use basic dual and plural demonstratives.
- Apply the non-human plural agreement rule.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
هَذَا	this (m)
هَذِهِ	this (f)
ذَلِكَ	that (m)
تِلْكَ	that (f)
هَؤُلَاءِ	these
أُولَئِكَ	those

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: understand Arabic words such as هَذَا (this), هَذِهِ (this), ذَلِكَ (that), and how they point to nouns.

A **demonstrative** is a pointing word. In English we use **this, that, these, those**. Arabic also uses different pointing words, but Arabic pays much more attention to **gender** and **number**.

Simple idea: a demonstrative answers the question: *Which one?*

Lesson 27 - What is a demonstrative?

Imagine two books. You point to the book near you and say:

هَذَا كِتَابٌ

This is a book.

The word هَذَا points to something near you. It means **this** when the noun is masculine singular.

English	Arabic	What it does
this	هَذَا	points to one masculine thing nearby
this	هَذِهِ	points to one feminine thing nearby
that	ذَلِكَ	points to one masculine thing farther away
that	تِلْكَ	points to one feminine thing farther away

Nahw connection: demonstratives belong to the broad Arabic category اِسْمٌ. English gives them their own label, but traditional Arabic grammar treats them as noun-type words.

Lesson 28 - Near demonstratives: هَذَا and هَذِهِ

Arabic chooses the demonstrative according to the gender of the noun.

Noun	Gender	Demonstrative	Example	Meaning
كِتَابٌ	masculine	هَذَا	هَذَا كِتَابٌ	This is a book.
بَيْتٌ	masculine	هَذَا	هَذَا بَيْتٌ	This is a house.
سَيَّارَةٌ	feminine	هَذِهِ	هَذِهِ سَيَّارَةٌ	This is a car.
مَدْرَسَةٌ	feminine	هَذِهِ	هَذِهِ مَدْرَسَةٌ	This is a school.

Easy test: if the noun is one masculine thing, start with هَذَا. If it is one feminine thing, start with هَذِهِ.

Guided practice

Choose هَذَا or هَذِهِ.

1. _____ بَابٌ
2. _____ شَجَرَةٌ
3. _____ قَلَمٌ
4. _____ حَقِيبَةٌ

Answers
1. هَذَا بَابٌ
2. هَذِهِ شَجَرَةٌ
3. هَذَا قَلَمٌ
4. هَذِهِ حَقِيبَةٌ

Lesson 29 - Far demonstratives: ذَلِكَ and تِلْكَ

When the thing is farther away, Arabic commonly uses:

Gender	Near	Far	Example	Meaning
masculine singular	هَذَا	ذَلِكَ	ذَلِكَ بَيْتٌ	That is a house.
feminine singular	هَذِهِ	تِلْكَ	تِلْكَ سَيَّارَةٌ	That is a car.

Compare:

Near	Far
هَذَا كِتَابٌ	ذَلِكَ كِتَابٌ
This is a book.	That is a book.
هَذِهِ مَدْرَسَةٌ	تِلْكَ مَدْرَسَةٌ
This is a school.	That is a school.

> **Do not translate mechanically.** Context decides how near or far something feels. At this stage, simply learn the core contrast: **this** versus **that**.

Lesson 30 - “This is a book” versus “this book”

This is one of the most important beginner distinctions.

Sentence

هَذَا كِتَابٌ

This is a book.

Here كِتَابٌ is indefinite. The demonstrative and the noun form a complete statement.

Pointing to a definite noun

هَذَا الْكِتَابُ

this book

Here الْكِتَابُ has الـ and is definite. The expression identifies a particular book.

Arabic	Meaning	What changed?
هَذَا كِتَابٌ	This is a book.	noun is indefinite
هَذَا الْكِتَابُ	this book	noun is definite with الـ
هَذِهِ سَيَّارَةٌ	This is a car.	noun is indefinite
هَذِهِ السَّيَّارَةُ	this car	noun is definite

Very useful beginner rule: demonstrative + indefinite noun often gives a complete "This is ..." sentence. Demonstrative + definite noun often gives the phrase "this ...".

Which meaning?

1. هَذَا قَلَمٌ
2. هَذَا الْقَلَمُ
3. تِلْكَ مَدْرَسَةٌ
4. تِلْكَ الْمَدْرَسَةُ

Answers
1. This is a pen.
2. this pen.
3. That is a school.
4. that school.

Lesson 31 - Dual demonstratives

Arabic has special words for **two** things.

Meaning	Arabic	Example	Translation
these two (masculine)	هَذَانِ	هَذَانِ طَالِبَانِ	These two are students.
these two (feminine)	هَاتَانِ	هَاتَانِ طَالِبَتَانِ	These two are female students.

Important for later: dual demonstratives can change form according to grammatical case. You will later meet هَذَيْنِ and هَاتَيْنِ. For now, learn هَذَانِ and هَاتَانِ as the basic nominative forms and recognise that the dual can change.

Gender	Raf‘ form	Nasb / Jarr form	Example
masculine	هَذَانِ	هَذَيْنِ	رَأَيْتُ هَذَيْنِ الطَّالِبَيْنِ - I saw these two students.
feminine	هَاتَانِ	هَاتَيْنِ	مَرَرْتُ بِهَاتَيْنِ الطَّالِبَتَيْنِ - I passed by these two female students.

Beginner recognition: the dual demonstrative changes with case just as the dual noun does. Raf‘ uses ـانِ; nasb and jarr use ـيْنِ.

Lesson 32 - Plural demonstratives

For a group of people nearby, a common demonstrative is:

هَؤُلَاءِ

these

For a group farther away:

أُولَئِكَ

those

Arabic	Meaning
هَؤُلَاءِ طُلَّابٌ	These are students.
هَؤُلَاءِ مُعَلِّمَاتٌ	These are female teachers.
أُولَئِكَ طُلَّابٌ	Those are students.

Notice: هَؤُلَاءِ can be used for masculine or feminine human plurals. Context and the following noun tell you which group is meant.

Lesson 33 - A special rule for non-human plurals

Arabic has a very important rule that surprises English speakers:

> **Non-human plurals are commonly treated as feminine singular for agreement.**

So with a plural of things, animals, or other non-human nouns, you will often see the feminine singular demonstrative.

Plural noun	Demonstrative	Example	Meaning
كُتُبٌ	هَذِهِ	هَذِهِ كُتُبٌ	These are books.
سَيَّارَاتٌ	هَذِهِ	هَذِهِ سَيَّارَاتٌ	These are cars.
بُيُوتٌ	تِلْكَ	تِلْكَ بُيُوتٌ	Those are houses.

> **Do not panic about this rule.** We will meet it again with adjectives and verbs. For now, recognise the pattern.

Lesson 34 - Demonstratives with people and names

Demonstratives can point to people just as they point to objects.

Arabic	Meaning
هَذَا أَحْمَدُ	This is Ahmed.
هَذِهِ فَاطِمَةُ	This is Fatimah.
ذَلِكَ مُحَمَّدٌ	That is Muhammad.
تِلْكَ مَرْيَمُ	That is Maryam.

Again, the demonstrative must match the gender and number of the person being pointed to.

Lesson 35 - Demonstratives inside longer sentences

Once you recognise demonstratives, you can understand longer sentences more easily.

هَذَا الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ

This book is new.

Part	Arabic	Simple job
demonstrative	هَذَا	points to the noun
noun	الْكِتَابُ	the thing being discussed
description/news	جَدِيدٌ	tells us something about it

We will later analyse this more precisely using مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ.

هَذِهِ السَّيَّارَةُ سَرِيعَةٌ

This car is fast.

The word هَذِهِ matches the feminine noun السَّيَّارَةُ.

Common beginner mistakes

Mistake	Why it is wrong	Correct form
هَذَا سَيَّارَةٌ	سَيَّارَةٌ is feminine	هَذِهِ سَيَّارَةٌ
هَذِهِ كِتَابٌ	كِتَابٌ is masculine	هَذَا كِتَابٌ
هَؤُلَاءِ كُتُبٌ	non-human plural normally takes feminine singular agreement	هَذِهِ كُتُبٌ

Unit 5 Review - Demonstratives

Meaning	Masculine	Feminine
this - one nearby	هَذَا	هَذِهِ
that - one farther away	ذَلِكَ	تِلْكَ
these two	هَذَانِ	هَاتَانِ

Meaning	Arabic	Main beginner use
these	هَؤُلَاءِ	near human plural
those	أُولَئِكَ	far human plural
these/those non-human plurals	هَذِهِ / تِلْكَ	feminine singular agreement

Unit 5 Checkpoint Exam

1. What is a demonstrative in plain English?

2. Give the Arabic for “this” with one masculine noun.

3. Give the Arabic for “this” with one feminine noun.

4. Translate: ذَلِكَ بَيْتٌ.

5. Translate: تِلْكَ مَدْرَسَةٌ.

6. Explain the difference between هَذَا كِتَابٌ and هَذَا الْكِتَابُ.

7. What do هَذَانِ and هَاتَانِ mean?

8. Which demonstrative is commonly used for a nearby human plural?

9. Why can we say هَذِهِ كُتُبٌ even though كُتُبٌ is plural?

10. Correct this sentence: هَذَا سَيَّارَةٌ.

Model answers

1. A word used to point to a particular person or thing: this, that, these, those.
2. هَذَا.
3. هَذِهِ.
4. That is a house.
5. That is a school.
6. هَذَا كِتَابٌ is a complete statement: “This is a book.” هَذَا الْكِتَابُ identifies “this book”.
7. These two (masculine) and these two (feminine).
8. هَؤُلَاءِ.
9. Non-human plurals commonly take feminine singular agreement in Arabic.
10. هَذِهِ سَيَّارَةٌ.

Unit 5 Enrichment Lab

Worked example

هَذَا كِتَابٌ = This is a book. هَذَا الْكِتَابُ = this book. One is a sentence; the other points to a definite noun.

Contrast pair
Near: هَذِهِ / هَذَا. Far: تِلْكَ / ذَلِكَ.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: using a masculine demonstrative with a clearly feminine singular noun. Fix: match basic gender: هَذِهِ سَيَّارَةٌ.

Build it yourself
Write four phrases/sentences using this (m), this (f), that (m), that (f).

Spiral review
Identify the pronoun or noun gender before choosing the demonstrative.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 6 - Definite and Indefinite Nouns

Unit 6 of 15

Unit 6 learning plan

Before you begin
Recognise nouns and demonstratives.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Explain nakirah and ma'rifah.
- Recognise common ways a noun becomes definite.
- Use definiteness correctly with adjectives.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
نَكِرَةٌ	indefinite
مَعْرِفَةٌ	definite
الـ	the / definite article
عَلَمٌ	proper name
ضَمِيرٌ	pronoun

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal
Understand the difference between a general, non-specific Ism and a specific, identified Ism. Learn the Arabic terms نَكِرَةٌ and مَعْرِفَةٌ, recognise the main beginner ways an Ism becomes definite, and see why definiteness matters for adjectives and sentence meaning.

Lesson 36 - What does "indefinite" mean?

Start with English. Compare:

English	What it means
a man	any man; we have not identified a particular one
the man	a particular man that the speaker and listener can identify

Arabic makes the same basic distinction.

Arabic	Meaning	Grammar
رَجُلٌ	a man	نَكِرَةٌ - indefinite
الرَّجُلُ	the man	مَعْرِفَةٌ - definite

Simple idea
نَكِرَةٌ = not identified or not specific.
مَعْرِفَةٌ = identified or specific in the grammar.

More easy examples

Indefinite	Meaning	Definite	Meaning
كِتَابٌ	a book	الْكِتَابُ	the book
بَيْتٌ	a house	الْبَيْتُ	the house
طَالِبٌ	a student	الطَّالِبُ	the student
سَيَّارَةٌ	a car	السَّيَّارَةُ	the car

Important: tanwin is a clue, not a complete definition.
A beginner often sees ـٍ / ـً / ـٌ and thinks “indefinite”. That is often useful, but do not turn it into an absolute rule. Proper names such as مُحَمَّدٌ can have tanwin and are still definite because the name itself identifies a particular person. Later you will also meet nouns that are indefinite but do not take tanwin for other grammatical reasons.

How to think about it

If I say:

رَأَيْتُ رَجُلًا

I saw **a man**. You do not yet know which man.

If I say:

رَأَيْتُ الرَّجُلَ

I saw **the man**. The man is being treated as already identifiable.

Guided practice
For each pair, say which one is indefinite and which one is definite.

1. قَلَمٌ / الْقَلَمُ
2. بَابٌ / الْبَابُ
3. مَدْرَسَةٌ / الْمَدْرَسَةُ
4. وَلَدٌ / الْوَلَدُ

Answers
In every pair, the first noun is indefinite and the second noun is definite because it has الـ.

Lesson 37 - Making a noun definite with الـ

The most visible beginner way to make an ordinary noun definite is to add:

الـ

This is commonly called the Arabic definite article. It often corresponds to English **the**.

Without الـ	With الـ
كِتَابٌ - a book	الْكِتَابُ - the book
بَيْتٌ - a house	الْبَيْتُ - the house
مَسْجِدٌ - a mosque	الْمَسْجِدُ - the mosque
مُعَلِّمٌ - a teacher	الْمُعَلِّمُ - the teacher

Beginner rule
When an ordinary noun takes الـ, it becomes definite. Tanwin does not remain on that noun.

الْكِتَابُ ← كِتَابٌ
Not: الْكِتَابٌ.

Why the tanwin disappears

For now, remember the pattern rather than trying to memorise a long technical explanation:

Indefinite	Definite with الـ
رَجُلٌ	الرَّجُلُ
قَلَمٌ	الْقَلَمُ
سَيَّارَةٌ	السَّيَّارَةُ

Sun and moon letters: only the pronunciation idea

You may notice that الـ is not always pronounced in exactly the same way. Compare:

Written	Approximate reading
الْقَمَرُ	al-qamaru
الشَّمْسُ	ash-shamsu

The spelling still contains الـ. The detailed sun-letter and moon-letter lesson belongs mainly to pronunciation/reading, so we will not let it distract us from the Nahw point: both nouns are definite.

Make these nouns definite

1. كِتَابٌ
2. مَسْجِدٌ
3. طَالِبٌ
4. سَيَّارَةٌ
5. بَابٌ

Answers
1. الْكِتَابُ
2. الْمَسْجِدُ
3. الطَّالِبُ
4. السَّيَّارَةُ
5. الْبَابُ

Lesson 38 - Other ways an Ism can already be definite

A noun does **not** need الـ in order to be definite. Some types of Ism are definite by their nature or by another construction.

Type	Example	Why it is definite
Proper name	مُحَمَّدٌ	the name identifies a particular person
Pronoun	هُوَ	“he” points to an identified person in context
Demonstrative	هَذَا	“this” points to an identified thing/person
Noun with الـ	الْكِتَابُ	the definite article identifies it
Idafah to something definite	كِتَابُ مُحَمَّدٍ	“Muhammad's book” is identified through Muhammad

We are previewing, not finishing, the full classical list.
Later you will study relative pronouns such as الَّذِي, detailed Idafah rules, and other constructions. At beginner level, the important point is this: **definite does not simply mean “has الـ”.**

Proper names

Compare:

General	Specific name
a man - رَجُلٌ	Ahmed - أَحْمَدُ
a city - مَدِينَةٌ	Makkah - مَكَّةُ

أَحْمَدُ and مَكَّةُ are already definite as names. We do not need to add الـ to make them specific.

Pronouns

Pronouns such as:

أَنَا - أَنْتَ - هُوَ - هِيَ - نَحْنُ

are treated as definite because they refer to identified participants in the speech.

Demonstratives

You already studied:

هَذَا - هَذِهِ - ذَلِكَ - تِلْكَ

These are definite because they point to a particular person or thing.

Idafah preview

Look at:

كِتَابُ مُحَمَّدٍ

Muhammad's book.

Because Muhammad is definite, the whole expression identifies a particular book: Muhammad's book. We will study Idafah carefully in its own unit.

Why is each item definite?

1. الْمَسْجِدُ
2. أَحْمَدُ
3. هُوَ
4. هَذِهِ
5. بَابُ الْبَيْتِ

Model answers

1. It has الـ.
2. It is a proper name.
3. It is a pronoun.
4. It is a demonstrative.
5. It is an Idafah whose second noun, الْبَيْتِ, is definite. We will learn the full rule later.

Lesson 39 - Definiteness and adjective agreement

Definiteness is not only about translating “a” and “the”. It also helps Arabic words agree with each other.

Compare:

Arabic	Meaning	What you notice
بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ	a big house	both words are indefinite
الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ	the big house	both words are definite

Beginner adjective rule
When an adjective directly describes a noun, the adjective normally matches the noun in definiteness.

رَجُلٌ طَوِيلٌ = a tall man
الرَّجُلُ الطَّوِيلُ = the tall man

A very important contrast

Compare these two:

Arabic	Meaning	Complete sentence?
الرَّجُلُ الْكَبِيرُ	the big man	usually just a noun phrase by itself
الرَّجُلُ كَبِيرٌ	the man is big	yes, a complete nominal sentence

This difference is extremely important. In the first expression, الْكَبِيرُ is a definite adjective describing الرَّجُلُ. In the second, كَبِيرٌ is giving new information about the man. Later you will learn the formal terms مُبْتَدَأٌ and خَبَرٌ.

More comparisons

Noun + adjective phrase	Nominal sentence
الْبَيْتُ الْجَدِيدُ the new house	الْبَيْتُ جَدِيدٌ the house is new
السَّيَّارَةُ السَّرِيعَةُ the fast car	السَّيَّارَةُ سَرِيعَةٌ the car is fast

Do not try to learn every adjective-agreement rule here.
Adjectives also agree in gender, number and grammatical case. We will teach those systematically in the adjective unit. For now, master one idea: **direct adjective phrases match in definiteness.**

Choose the correct form

1. “a new book” = كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ or الْكِتَابُ الْجَدِيدُ?

2. “the new book” = الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ or الْكِتَابُ الْجَدِيدُ?

3. Which means “the house is big”: الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ or الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ?

4. Correct: الرَّجُلُ طَوِيلٌ if you mean “the tall man”.

Answers with reasons

1. كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ. Both noun and adjective are indefinite.
2. الْكِتَابُ الْجَدِيدُ. Both noun and adjective are definite.
3. الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ. The second word gives the information “is big”.
4. الرَّجُلُ الطَّوِيلُ. A direct adjective describing a definite noun must also be definite.

Unit 6 Visual Summary

Idea	Arabic	Simple memory
Indefinite	نَكِرَةٌ	not specifically identified
Definite	مَعْرِفَةٌ	identified/specific
Definite article	الـ	often like English “the”
Proper name	أَحْمَدُ	definite by being a name
Pronoun	هُوَ	definite
Demonstrative	هَذَا	definite
Direct adjective phrase	الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ	noun and adjective match in definiteness

Unit 6 Checkpoint Exam

1. Explain نَكِرَةٌ in plain English.

2. Explain مَعْرِفَةٌ in plain English.

3. Make بَيْتٌ definite.

4. Why is مُحَمَّدٌ definite even though it has tanwin?

5. Name three types of Ism that can be definite without adding الـ.

6. Translate: رَجُلٌ طَوِيلٌ.

7. Translate: الرَّجُلُ الطَّوِيلُ.

8. Translate: الرَّجُلُ طَوِيلٌ.

9. Explain why the meanings in questions 7 and 8 are different.

10. Correct: الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ if the intended meaning is “the new book”.

11. Is هَذَا definite or indefinite? Why?

12. Is كِتَابُ أَحْمَدَ definite or indefinite at the beginner level, and why?

Model answers

1. An Ism that is not specifically identified.
2. An Ism that is identified or specific in the grammar.
3. الْبَيْتُ.
4. Because it is a proper name; proper names are definite by themselves. Tanwin is not a perfect test for definiteness.
5. For example: proper names, pronouns, demonstratives. An Idafah to a definite noun can also make the whole expression definite.
6. A tall man.
7. The tall man.
8. The man is tall.
9. In question 7, the second word is a direct adjective and matches the noun in definiteness. In question 8, the second word gives new information and forms a complete sentence.
10. الْكِتَابُ الْجَدِيدُ.
11. Definite, because a demonstrative points to an identified person or thing.
12. Definite in this example because the expression identifies Ahmed's book, and Ahmed is definite as a proper name.

Mastery target before Unit 7

You should now be able to look at a simple Ism and ask: Is it general or identified? What made it definite? Does a following adjective match it in definiteness? You do not need advanced case analysis yet.

Cumulative Review 2 - Units 4-6

Mastery target: 80%. Answers are in Unit 15.

1. What is a pronoun?
2. Give one detached pronoun, one attached pronoun and one hidden-pronoun example.
3. Translate كِتَابُهُ.
4. Give the near masculine and feminine demonstratives.
5. Give the far masculine and feminine demonstratives.
6. Give the raf‘ and nasb/jarr forms of the masculine dual demonstrative.
7. Explain definite vs indefinite.
8. Name four ways an Ism can be definite.
9. Explain why هُوَ is definite.
10. Explain the difference between هَذَا كِتَابٌ and هَذَا الْكِتَابُ.

Unit 6 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
رَجُلٌ = a man; الرَّجُلُ = the man. The article الـ makes the noun definite.

Contrast pair
الرَّجُلُ الْكَبِيرُ = the big man, but الرَّجُلُ كَبِيرٌ = the man is big.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: “Tanwin always means indefinite in every situation.” Fix: tanwin is a useful beginner clue, but learn definiteness through the whole structure.

Build it yourself
Make بَيْتٌ، كِتَابٌ، طَالِبٌ definite, then add matching adjectives.

Spiral review
Review demonstratives: explain why a demonstrative itself is definite.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 7 - Adjectives and Agreement

Unit 7 of 15

Unit 7 learning plan

Before you begin
Know gender, number and definiteness.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Recognise an adjective phrase.
- Match adjectives in gender, number and definiteness.
- Begin recognising case agreement.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
صِفَةٌ	adjective
نَعْتٌ	adjective/attribute
مَوْصُوفٌ	described noun
مُطَابَقَةٌ	agreement
كَبِيرٌ	big

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal
Learn how Arabic adjectives describe nouns and why the adjective usually has to match the noun in gender, number, definiteness and grammatical case.

Lesson 40 - What is an adjective?

An adjective is a word that describes a noun. It tells us what kind of person or thing we are talking about.

English	Arabic	What is being described?
a big house	بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ	the house
a new book	كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ	the book
a beautiful garden	حَدِيقَةٌ جَمِيلَةٌ	the garden

Very important word order
In a normal Arabic noun + adjective phrase, the **noun normally comes first** and the adjective follows it.

بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ
not: “big house” in English order.

In traditional Arabic grammar, the adjective can be called نَعْتٌ or صِفَةٌ. At this level, you may think of both as “adjective/description”.

How to find the adjective

Ask: **Which word is describing another noun?**

رَجُلٌ طَوِيلٌ
رَجُلٌ = a man
طَوِيلٌ = tall. The word “tall” describes the man.

سَيَّارَةٌ سَرِيعَةٌ
سَيَّارَةٌ = a car
سَرِيعَةٌ = fast. The word “fast” describes the car.

Quick check
In each phrase, identify the noun and the adjective.

1. كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ
2. بِنْتٌ صَغِيرَةٌ
3. مَسْجِدٌ كَبِيرٌ

Answers
1. Noun: كِتَابٌ. Adjective: جَدِيدٌ.
2. Noun: بِنْتٌ. Adjective: صَغِيرَةٌ.
3. Noun: مَسْجِدٌ. Adjective: كَبِيرٌ.

Lesson 41 - The four things an adjective follows

Arabic adjective agreement is much stronger than English adjective agreement. The adjective normally follows the noun in four important areas:

Agreement	Question to ask	Simple example
Gender	Masculine or feminine?	وَلَدٌ صَغِيرٌ / بِنْتٌ صَغِيرَةٌ
Number	Singular, dual or plural?	طَالِبٌ مُجْتَهِدٌ / طَالِبَانِ مُجْتَهِدَانِ
Definiteness	Indefinite or definite?	بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ / الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ
Case	Raf‘, nasb or jarr?	introduced gently later in this unit

Memory sentence
The adjective follows the noun. First ask: **What is the noun?** Then make the adjective agree with it.

Lesson 42 - Gender agreement

If the noun is masculine, the adjective is normally masculine. If the noun is feminine, the adjective is normally feminine.

Masculine noun	Feminine noun
وَلَدٌ صَغِيرٌ a small boy	بِنْتٌ صَغِيرَةٌ a small girl
رَجُلٌ طَوِيلٌ a tall man	اِمْرَأَةٌ طَوِيلَةٌ a tall woman
كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ a new book	سَيَّارَةٌ جَدِيدَةٌ a new car

A very common feminine adjective ending is ـَةٌ, but do not reduce the whole rule to “add taa marbutah”. First identify the noun's gender, then use the correct adjective form.

Common mistake
سَيَّارَةٌ جَدِيدٌ is wrong in a normal adjective phrase because the noun is feminine but the adjective is masculine.
Correct: سَيَّارَةٌ جَدِيدَةٌ.

Make the adjective agree in gender

1. _____ بِنْتٌ (small: صَغِيرٌ / صَغِيرَةٌ)
2. _____ رَجُلٌ (tall: طَوِيلٌ / طَوِيلَةٌ)
3. _____ مَدْرَسَةٌ (big: كَبِيرٌ / كَبِيرَةٌ)

Answers
1. بِنْتٌ صَغِيرَةٌ
2. رَجُلٌ طَوِيلٌ
3. مَدْرَسَةٌ كَبِيرَةٌ

Lesson 43 - Number agreement

Arabic distinguishes singular, dual and plural. An adjective normally follows the noun in number as well.

Number	Masculine example	Meaning
Singular	طَالِبٌ مُجْتَهِدٌ	a hardworking student
Dual	طَالِبَانِ مُجْتَهِدَانِ	two hardworking students
Plural	طُلَّابٌ مُجْتَهِدُونَ	hardworking students

Number	Feminine example	Meaning
Singular	طَالِبَةٌ مُجْتَهِدَةٌ	a hardworking female student
Dual	طَالِبَتَانِ مُجْتَهِدَتَانِ	two hardworking female students
Plural	طَالِبَاتٌ مُجْتَهِدَاتٌ	hardworking female students

Do not panic about every ending yet.
At beginner level, first understand the agreement idea. The exact dual and plural case endings will become much clearer in the case-ending units.

Lesson 44 - The special non-human plural rule

This is one of the most important Arabic agreement rules for beginners.

Rule
A non-human plural is normally treated as feminine singular for adjective agreement.

Example:

كُتُبٌ جَدِيدَةٌ
new books

كُتُبٌ is plural, but the adjective is feminine singular: جَدِيدَةٌ.

Arabic	Meaning	Why the adjective looks singular feminine
بُيُوتٌ كَبِيرَةٌ	big houses	non-human plural
سَيَّارَاتٌ جَدِيدَةٌ	new cars	non-human plural
أَبْوَابٌ مَفْتُوحَةٌ	open doors	non-human plural

Compare human plural
طُلَّابٌ مُجْتَهِدُونَ = hardworking students. Because the plural refers to people, the adjective is also plural.

Lesson 45 - Definiteness agreement

You already met this in Unit 6. Now we make it part of the full adjective system.

Indefinite phrase	Definite phrase
بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ a big house	الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ the big house
كِتَابٌ جَدِيدٌ a new book	الْكِتَابُ الْجَدِيدُ the new book

> **Rule**
> If the adjective directly describes a definite noun, the adjective must also be definite.
> If the noun is indefinite, the direct adjective is also indefinite.

Phrase or sentence?

Arabic	Meaning	What is happening?
الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ	the big house	noun + adjective phrase
الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	the house is big	complete nominal sentence

This difference is extremely important. The presence or absence of الـ on the second word can completely change the structure.

Lesson 46 - Introduction to case agreement

Later, you will study الرَّفْعُ, النَّصْبُ and الْجَرُّ in depth. For now, learn the principle:

> **The adjective normally follows the noun in grammatical case too.**

Case idea	Example	What to notice
Raf‘	جَاءَ الرَّجُلُ الطَّوِيلُ	both end in a raf‘ form
Nasb	رَأَيْتُ الرَّجُلَ الطَّوِيلَ	both end in a nasb form
Jarr	مَرَرْتُ بِالرَّجُلِ الطَّوِيلِ	both end in a jarr form

You do not need to parse these sentences fully yet. The goal is simply to notice that the noun and adjective move together.

Unit 7 - Putting the agreement rules together

Four-question method
When you see a noun + adjective, ask:
1. Is the noun masculine or feminine?
2. Is it singular, dual or plural?
3. Is it definite or indefinite?
4. What grammatical case is it in?

Then make the adjective follow the noun.

Noun phrase	Gender	Number	Definiteness
رَجُلٌ طَوِيلٌ	masculine	singular	indefinite
السَّيَّارَةُ الْجَدِيدَةُ	feminine	singular	definite
طَالِبَانِ مُجْتَهِدَانِ	masculine	dual	indefinite
الطَّالِبَاتُ الْمُجْتَهِدَاتُ	feminine	plural	definite
كُتُبٌ جَدِيدَةٌ	non-human	plural noun; feminine-singular adjective	indefinite

Common beginner mistakes

Incorrect	Correct	Reason
بِنْتٌ صَغِيرٌ	بِنْتٌ صَغِيرَةٌ	gender must agree
الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ	الْكِتَابُ الْجَدِيدُ	if you mean “the new book”, definiteness must agree
كُتُبٌ جَدِيدُونَ	كُتُبٌ جَدِيدَةٌ	non-human plural rule
طَالِبَانِ مُجْتَهِدٌ	طَالِبَانِ مُجْتَهِدَانِ	number must agree

Guided Practice

1. Translate: بَيْتٌ جَمِيلٌ.

2. Translate: الْبَيْتُ الْجَمِيلُ.

3. Translate: الْبَيْتُ جَمِيلٌ.

4. Correct: سَيَّارَةٌ سَرِيعٌ.

5. Complete: _____ بِنْتَانِ (small).

6. Complete: _____ كُتُبٌ (new).

7. Why is كُتُبٌ جَدِيدَةٌ not كُتُبٌ جَدِيدُونَ?

8. What four things does a normal Arabic adjective follow?

Answers with reasons
1. A beautiful house.
2. The beautiful house.
3. The house is beautiful.
4. سَيَّارَةٌ سَرِيعَةٌ. The noun is feminine singular.
5. بِنْتَانِ صَغِيرَتَانِ.
6. كُتُبٌ جَدِيدَةٌ.
7. Because a non-human plural is normally treated as feminine singular in adjective agreement.
8. Gender, number, definiteness and grammatical case.

Unit 7 Checkpoint Exam

1. What is an adjective in plain English?

2. Give the Arabic grammatical terms commonly used for adjective/description.

3. Which normally comes first in Arabic: the noun or the adjective?

4. Translate: رَجُلٌ طَوِيلٌ.

5. Translate: الطَّالِبَةُ الْمُجْتَهِدَةُ.

6. Correct: بِنْتٌ جَمِيلٌ.

7. Correct: الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرَةُ.

8. Complete: _____ طَالِبَانِ (hardworking).

9. Complete: _____ سَيَّارَاتٌ (new).

10. Explain the difference between الرَّجُلُ الطَّوِيلُ and الرَّجُلُ طَوِيلٌ.

11. Name the four areas of adjective agreement.

12. In رَأَيْتُ الرَّجُلَ الطَّوِيلَ, what do you notice about the endings of the noun and adjective?

Model answers

1. A word that describes a noun.
2. نَعْتٌ and صِفَةٌ.
3. The noun normally comes first; the adjective follows it.
4. A tall man.
5. The hardworking female student.
6. بِنْتٌ جَمِيلَةٌ.
7. الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ.
8. طَالِبَانِ مُجْتَهِدَانِ.
9. سَيَّارَاتٌ جَدِيدَةٌ because the noun refers to non-human things.
10. The first means “the tall man” and is a noun + adjective phrase. The second means “the man is tall” and is a complete nominal sentence.
11. Gender, number, definiteness and case.
12. Both are in the same case form here: the noun and adjective are both manṣūb, so their visible endings agree.

Mastery target before Unit 8
You should now be able to build and recognise simple noun + adjective phrases and explain why the adjective changes for masculine/feminine, singular/dual/plural, definite/indefinite and grammatical case. You should also recognise the special non-human plural agreement rule.

Unit 7 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
سَيَّارَةٌ جَدِيدَةٌ. The adjective follows the noun and matches feminine singular indefiniteness.

Contrast pair
بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ vs الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ: indefiniteness and definiteness must match.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرَةٌ. Fix the gender: الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ.

Build it yourself
Describe a masculine noun, a feminine noun, and a non-human plural with suitable adjectives.

Spiral review
Before choosing the adjective, identify the noun’s gender, number and definiteness.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 8 - The Two Main Sentence Types

Unit 8 of 15

Unit 8 learning plan

Before you begin
Know noun phrases and basic verbs.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Distinguish nominal and verbal sentences.
- Identify Mubtada’ and Khabar.
- Understand why Arabic can omit “is” in simple present nominal sentences.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ	nominal sentence
جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ	verbal sentence
مُبْتَدَأٌ	starter/topic
خَبَرٌ	predicate/information

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal
By the end of this unit, you should be able to tell whether a simple Arabic sentence is nominal or verbal, identify the two basic parts of a nominal sentence, and understand why Arabic can make a complete present-tense sentence without writing a separate word for “is”.

Lesson 47 - Two Main Ways to Build a Sentence

Arabic has many kinds of sentences, but at beginner level we first learn two very important patterns:

Sentence type	Arabic name	Usually begins with	Example
Nominal sentence	جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ	an Ism	أَحْمَدُ طَالِبٌ
Verbal sentence	جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ	a verb	كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ

Beginner rule
If a simple sentence begins with an Ism, we usually call it a جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ. If it begins with a verb, we usually call it a جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ.

Compare:

Arabic	Meaning	Why?
أَحْمَدُ طَالِبٌ	Ahmed is a student.	It begins with the Ism أَحْمَدُ.
كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed wrote.	It begins with the verb كَتَبَ.

Important
This is a useful beginner rule, not the whole of advanced Arabic syntax. Later you will meet sentences whose analysis needs more detail. For now, this distinction gives you a strong foundation.

Guided practice

Classify each sentence as nominal or verbal.

1. الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ
2. ذَهَبَ أَحْمَدُ
3. الطَّالِبَةُ مُجْتَهِدَةٌ
4. فَتَحَ الْوَلَدُ الْبَابَ

Answers
1. Nominal - it begins with الْبَيْتُ, an Ism.
2. Verbal - it begins with ذَهَبَ, a verb.
3. Nominal - it begins with الطَّالِبَةُ, an Ism.
4. Verbal - it begins with فَتَحَ, a verb.

Lesson 48 - The Nominal Sentence

A nominal sentence often gives information about a person or thing. At the simplest level, it has two main parts:

Arabic term	Plain English	Job
مُبْتَدَأٌ	starting topic	the person or thing we begin talking about
خَبَرٌ	information / predicate	what we say about that topic

Example:

الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

The house is big.

Word	Meaning	Job
الْبَيْتُ	the house	مُبْتَدَأٌ - what we are talking about
كَبِيرٌ	big	خَبَرٌ - what we say about the house

Where is the word “is”?

English normally says:

> The house **is** big.

Arabic in a simple present-tense nominal sentence normally does not need a separate written word meaning “is”:

> **الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ**

Literally, the Arabic words are “the house - big”, but the natural English meaning is “The house is big.”

> **Memory rule**
> In a basic present-tense nominal sentence, do not automatically search for a separate Arabic word meaning “is”. The relationship between the two parts gives that meaning.

More examples

Arabic	Natural English	Mubtada'	Khabar
أَحْمَدُ طَالِبٌ	Ahmed is a student.	أَحْمَدُ	طَالِبٌ
الْمَاءُ بَارِدٌ	The water is cold.	الْمَاءُ	بَارِدٌ
السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةٌ	The car is new.	السَّيَّارَةُ	جَدِيدَةٌ
الطَّالِبَانِ حَاضِرَانِ	The two students are present.	الطَّالِبَانِ	حَاضِرَانِ

Lesson 49 - Mubtada' and Khabar in Depth

What exactly is the Mubtada'?

The مُبْتَدَأٌ is the starting topic of a basic nominal sentence. It is what the sentence begins talking about.

> **الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ**
>
> The student is hardworking.

We start by talking about الطَّالِبُ. Therefore it is the مُبْتَدَأٌ.

What exactly is the Khabar?

The خَبَرُ gives the information that completes the idea about the Mubtada'.

What are we saying about the student?

> **مُجْتَهِدٌ**
> hardworking

So مُجْتَهِدٌ is the Khabar.

A complete thought needs both parts

If someone only says:

> **الطَّالِبُ...**
> the student...

you naturally wait for more information. What about the student?

But:

> **الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ**

now gives a complete basic idea.

Basic grammatical state

At this beginner stage, learn this very important pattern:

> **Basic rule**
> The ordinary Mubtada' is normally مَرْفُوعٌ, and the ordinary Khabar is normally مَرْفُوعٌ.

With simple singular nouns, this is often shown by ـُ or tanwin ـٌ

الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

الْبَيْتُ ends in a ḍamma, and كَبِيرٌ has tanwin ḍamm. Later we will study the different signs of raf‘ in much more detail.

Common mistake: adjective phrase or full sentence?

Arabic	Meaning	Structure
الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ	the big house	noun + adjective; not a complete statement by itself
الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	the house is big	Mubtada' + Khabar; complete nominal sentence

Why the difference?
In الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ, both words are definite, so الْكَبِيرُ describes the noun. In الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ, the second word is indefinite and functions as new information: “is big”.

Guided practice

Identify the Mubtada' and Khabar.

1. الْجَوُّ جَمِيلٌ
2. فَاطِمَةُ طَالِبَةٌ
3. الْكِتَابُ مُفِيدٌ
4. الطَّالِبَاتُ مُجْتَهِدَاتٌ

Answers
1. Mubtada': الْجَوُّ; Khabar: جَمِيلٌ.
2. Mubtada': فَاطِمَةُ; Khabar: طَالِبَةٌ.
3. Mubtada': الْكِتَابُ; Khabar: مُفِيدٌ.
4. Mubtada': الطَّالِبَاتُ; Khabar: مُجْتَهِدَاتٌ.

Lesson 50 - The Verbal Sentence

A basic verbal sentence begins with a verb and tells us about an action or event.

كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الدَّرْسَ

Ahmed wrote the lesson.

Arabic	Meaning	Job
كَتَبَ	wrote	verb
أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed	doer - we will study الْفَاعِلُ in depth next
الدَّرْسَ	the lesson	object - we will study الْمَفْعُولُ بِهِ in depth next

Compare nominal and verbal sentences

Type	Arabic	Meaning	Main idea
Nominal	أَحْمَدُ مُجْتَهِدٌ	Ahmed is hardworking.	describes or gives information about Ahmed
Verbal	دَرَسَ أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed studied.	reports an action

The order can matter

At beginner level, notice this important contrast:

Arabic	Begins with	Beginner classification
كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ	verb	verbal sentence
أَحْمَدُ كَتَبَ	Ism	nominal sentence whose Khabar is a verbal clause; studied more fully later

Do not worry about the second structure yet.
It is included only to stop you from believing that “a sentence containing a verb must always be a verbal sentence.” The starting structure matters.

Mixed practice

For each sentence:
A. Decide whether it is nominal or verbal.
B. If nominal, identify Mubtada' and Khabar.
C. If verbal, identify the verb and the person doing the action.

1. الْمَدْرَسَةُ كَبِيرَةٌ
2. خَرَجَ الطَّالِبُ
3. مُحَمَّدٌ طَبِيبٌ
4. شَرِبَ الْوَلَدُ الْمَاءَ
5. السَّمَاءُ صَافِيَةٌ

Answers with reasons

1. Nominal. Mubtada': الْمَدْرَسَةُ; Khabar: كَبِيرَةٌ.
2. Verbal. Verb: خَرَجَ; doer: الطَّالِبُ.
3. Nominal. Mubtada': مُحَمَّدٌ; Khabar: طَبِيبٌ.
4. Verbal. Verb: شَرِبَ; doer: الْوَلَدُ; object: الْمَاءَ.
5. Nominal. Mubtada': السَّمَاءُ; Khabar: صَافِيَةٌ.

Unit 8 Checkpoint Exam

1. Name the two main beginner sentence types in Arabic.

2. What does a nominal sentence usually begin with?

3. What does a verbal sentence usually begin with?

4. What is a مُبْتَدَأٌ in plain English?

5. What is a خَبَرٌ in plain English?

6. In الْمَاءُ بَارِدٌ, identify the Mubtada' and Khabar.

7. Why is there no separate Arabic word for “is” in الْمَاءُ بَارِدٌ?

8. Is كَتَبَ عَلِيٌّ nominal or verbal? Why?

9. Explain the difference between الطَّالِبُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ and الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ.

10. What grammatical state are the ordinary basic Mubtada' and Khabar normally in?

11. Classify: الطَّقْسُ جَمِيلٌ.

12. Classify: فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ النَّافِذَةَ and identify the verb.

Model answers

1. جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ and جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ.
2. An Ism.
3. A verb.
4. The starting topic - the person or thing the sentence begins talking about.
5. The information given about the Mubtada'.
6. Mubtada': الْمَاءُ; Khabar: بَارِدٌ.
7. In a simple present nominal sentence, Arabic normally expresses the relationship without a separate written copula equivalent to English “is”.
8. Verbal, because it begins with the verb كَتَبَ.
9. The first means “the hardworking student” and is a noun + adjective phrase; the second means “the student is hardworking” and is a complete nominal sentence.
10. Both are normally marfūʿ in the basic pattern.
11. Nominal sentence.
12. Verbal sentence; the verb is فَتَحَ.

Mastery target before Unit 9

You should now be able to recognise a basic nominal sentence and verbal sentence, identify a simple Mubtada' and Khabar, explain why a present nominal sentence may have no visible Arabic word for “is”, and distinguish a noun + adjective phrase from a complete nominal sentence.

Unit 8 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ: الْبَيْتُ is Mubtada’ and كَبِيرٌ is Khabar.

Contrast pair
الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ is nominal; كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ is verbal.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: assuming Arabic must show a word equivalent to English “is.” Fix: simple present nominal sentences often have no separate copula.

Build it yourself
Create one nominal sentence and one verbal sentence using vocabulary already learned.

Spiral review
In your nominal sentence, check whether definiteness and adjective rules from Units 6-7 still apply.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 9 - The Doer and the Object

Unit 9 of 15

Unit 9 learning plan

Before you begin
Recognise verbal sentences.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Identify the Fa'il.
- Identify the Maf'ul Bihi.
- Distinguish basic transitive and intransitive verbs.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
فَاعِلٌ	doer/subject
مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ	direct object
لَازِمٌ	intransitive
مُتَعَدٍّ	transitive
فِعْلٌ	verb

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: understand who performs an action, what receives an action, and why Arabic gives these two jobs different grammatical states.

In the previous unit you learned that a verbal sentence usually begins with a verb. Now we slow down and study the two most important noun-jobs that can come with that verb.

Job	Arabic term	Plain English
Doer	فَاعِلٌ	the person or thing that performs the action
Direct object	مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ	the person or thing directly affected by the action

Three-question method: What happened? Who did it? What did the action affect?

Lesson 51 - The Doer: الْفَاعِلُ

Learning goal: recognise the doer in a simple verbal sentence and understand why it is normally marfū'.
Prerequisite: Unit 8.

Start with English

Ahmed opened the door.

Who performed the opening? **Ahmed.** Ahmed is the doer.

Now Arabic

فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ

Word	Meaning	Job
فَتَحَ	opened	verb
أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed	**doer - فَاعِلٌ**
الْبَابَ	the door	object

In the ordinary basic pattern, the فَاعِلٌ is **marfūʿ** - مَرْفُوعٌ.

At this stage, the most common visible sign you will see is a ḍamma or ḍammatayn:

Example	Why?
جَاءَ مُحَمَّدٌ	مُحَمَّدٌ is the doer of “came”.
كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ	الطَّالِبُ is the doer of “wrote”.
فَتَحَ الْوَلَدُ الْبَابَ	الْوَلَدُ is the doer of “opened”.

Do not use position alone. The doer often comes after the verb, but you should identify it by meaning and grammar: ask “Who or what performed the action?”

A doer can be a person, animal or thing

Sentence	Doer	Meaning
كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ	أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed wrote.
جَرَى الْحِصَانُ	الْحِصَانُ	The horse ran.
سَقَطَ الْكِتَابُ	الْكِتَابُ	The book fell.

A “doer” in grammar does not always mean a person choosing to do something. It means the noun connected to the verb as its grammatical subject.

Guided practice - find the doer

1. جَلَسَ الطَّالِبُ

2. خَرَجَ مُحَمَّدٌ

3. فَتَحَتْ فَاطِمَةُ الْبَابَ

4. شَرِبَ الْوَلَدُ الْمَاءَ

5. وَصَلَ الْقِطَارُ

Answers with reasons
1. الطَّالِبُ - the student performed the sitting.
2. مُحَمَّدٌ - Muhammad performed the leaving.
3. فَاطِمَةُ - Fatimah performed the opening.
4. الْوَلَدُ - the boy performed the drinking.
5. الْقِطَارُ - the train is the grammatical subject of “arrived”.

Lesson 52 - The Direct Object: الْمَفْعُولُ بِهِ

Learning goal: recognise the noun directly affected by the action and understand why it is normally manṣūb.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

English first

Ahmed opened the door.

Ahmed performed the action. But what did Ahmed open? **The door.** The door received the action.

Arabic

فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ

Question	Answer	Grammar job
What happened?	فَتَحَ	verb
Who opened?	أَحْمَدُ	فَاعِلٌ
What did he open?	الْبَابَ	مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ

In the ordinary basic pattern, the direct object - الْمَفْعُولُ بِهِ - is **manṣūb**: مَنْصُوبٌ.

For a simple singular noun, a fatḥa or fatḥatayn is often the visible sign:

Sentence	Object	Meaning
قَرَأَ الطَّالِبُ الْكِتَابَ	الْكِتَابَ	The student read the book.
أَكَلَ الْوَلَدُ التُّفَّاحَةَ	التُّفَّاحَةَ	The boy ate the apple.
كَتَبَتْ فَاطِمَةُ رِسَالَةً	رِسَالَةً	Fatimah wrote a letter.

Meaning first: do not call a noun “object” simply because it has fatḥa. Many other grammatical jobs can also be manṣūb. First identify the job; later identify the ending.

Doer and object side by side

Sentence	Doer - فَاعِلٌ	Object - مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ
كَتَبَ عَلِيٌّ الدَّرْسَ	عَلِيٌّ	الدَّرْسَ
شَرِبَ الطِّفْلُ الْحَلِيبَ	الطِّفْلُ	الْحَلِيبَ
فَتَحَ الْمُعَلِّمُ الْبَابَ	الْمُعَلِّمُ	الْبَابَ
غَسَلَتْ مَرْيَمُ السَّيَّارَةَ	مَرْيَمُ	السَّيَّارَةَ

Fast test:
Who did it? → doer.
What/who was directly affected? → direct object.

Guided practice - find both

For each sentence, identify the verb, doer and object.

1. كَسَرَ الْوَلَدُ الزُّجَاجَ

2. قَرَأَتْ فَاطِمَةُ الْقِصَّةَ

3. حَمَلَ الرَّجُلُ الْحَقِيبَةَ

4. شَرِبَ أَحْمَدُ الْعَصِيرَ

Answers
1. Verb: كَسَرَ; doer: الْوَلَدُ; object: الزُّجَاجَ.
2. Verb: قَرَأَتْ; doer: فَاطِمَةُ; object: الْقِصَّةَ.
3. Verb: حَمَلَ; doer: الرَّجُلُ; object: الْحَقِيبَةَ.
4. Verb: شَرِبَ; doer: أَحْمَدُ; object: الْعَصِيرَ.

Lesson 53 - Some Verbs Take an Object, Some Do Not

Learning goal: understand that not every verb needs a direct object.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

Verb that does not need an object

جَلَسَ أَحْمَدُ

Ahmed sat. The meaning is complete. We do not need to ask “What did Ahmed sit?”

Arabic later calls this kind of verb:

فِعْلٌ لَازِمٌ

For now, remember: **an intransitive verb can make a complete basic verbal sentence without a direct object.**

Verb that takes an object

فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ

The opening passes from Ahmed to the door. Arabic later calls this kind of verb:

فِعْلٌ مُتَعَدٍّ

For now, remember: **a transitive verb can act directly on an object.**

Sentence	Direct object?	Basic type
نَامَ الطِّفْلُ	No	لَازِمٌ / intransitive
جَلَسَ الطَّالِبُ	No	لَازِمٌ / intransitive
فَتَحَ الرَّجُلُ الْبَابَ	Yes: الْبَابَ	مُتَعَدٍّ / transitive
قَرَأَتْ مَرْيَمُ الْكِتَابَ	Yes: الْكِتَابَ	مُتَعَدٍّ / transitive

Later refinement: Arabic verbs can be more complex than this simple two-box introduction. Some verbs change behaviour with meaning or prepositions, and some can take more than one object. We will study those at higher levels.

Practice - object or no object?

1. نَامَ الطِّفْلُ
2. كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الرِّسَالَةَ
3. ذَهَبَ الطَّالِبُ
4. أَكَلَ الْوَلَدُ الْخُبْزَ
5. وَصَلَ الْقِطَارُ

Answers

1. No direct object.
2. Object: الرِّسَالَةَ.
3. No direct object in this sentence.
4. Object: الْخُبْزَ.
5. No direct object.

Lesson 54 - The Doer Can Be a Pronoun

Learning goal: recognise that Arabic does not always need to write a separate noun after the verb.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

In Arabic, information about the doer can be built into the verb form.

Arabic	Meaning	Where is the doer?
كَتَبْتُ	I wrote	the ending تُ points to “I”
كَتَبْنَا	we wrote	the ending نَا points to “we”
كَتَبُوا	they wrote	the verb ending carries plural masculine information

In detailed Nahw, we analyse these attached or understood pronouns precisely. For Beginner Nahw, the key idea is:

A verbal sentence can have a separate visible doer noun, or the doer information can be carried by the verb/pronoun ending.

Compare:

Sentence	Doer
كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ	visible noun: أَحْمَدُ
كَتَبْتُ	attached pronoun meaning “I”
كَتَبْنَا	attached pronoun meaning “we”

The full morphology of these verb endings belongs mainly to the separate Sarf book. Here we only need enough to analyse the sentence correctly.

Lesson 55 - Verb-Subject Agreement in Basic Standard Arabic

Learning goal: understand one important difference between a verb-first sentence and a subject-first sentence.
Prerequisite: Fa'il and basic pronoun agreement.

English normally says "the students wrote." Arabic can place the verb first or the subject first. In standard Arabic, the agreement pattern is not always identical.

1. Verb first: the basic VSO pattern

When an explicit plural or dual subject comes **after** the verb, the verb is normally kept singular in the basic standard pattern, while still matching the subject in gender.

Arabic	Meaning	What to notice
كَتَبَ الطَّالِبَانِ	The two male students wrote.	verb first: كَتَبَ stays singular masculine
كَتَبَ الطُّلَّابُ	The male students wrote.	verb first: singular masculine verb
كَتَبَتِ الطَّالِبَاتُ	The female students wrote.	verb first: singular feminine verb

2. Subject first: fuller agreement

Arabic	Meaning	What to notice
الطَّالِبَانِ كَتَبَا	The two male students wrote.	dual subject first: dual verb
الطُّلَّابُ كَتَبُوا	The male students wrote.	plural subject first: plural verb
الطَّالِبَاتُ كَتَبْنَ	The female students wrote.	plural feminine subject first: plural feminine verb

Beginner limit: Arabic agreement has additional details and exceptions. For this book, master the normal standard contrast above. More advanced agreement rules belong to later Nahw.

Choose the normal verb-first form.
1. ___ الطُّلَّابُ: كَتَبَ or كَتَبُوا?
2. ___ الطَّالِبَاتُ: كَتَبَتْ or كَتَبْنَ?

Answers: 1. كَتَبَ الطُّلَّابُ. 2. كَتَبَتِ الطَّالِبَاتُ. In the basic verb-first pattern the verb is singular.

Unit 9 - Full sentence analysis

Use the same order every time:

1. Find the verb. What happened?

2. Find the doer. Who or what performed the action?

3. Ask whether there is a direct object. What or who was directly affected?

4. Check the basic states. Doer normally marfūʿ; object normally manṣūb.

Example 1

قَرَأَ الطَّالِبُ الْكِتَابَ

Word	Analysis
قَرَأَ	past verb - read
الطَّالِبُ	doer / فَاعِلٌ; normally marfūʿ
الْكِتَابَ	direct object / مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ; normally manṣūb

Example 2

جَلَسَ الطَّالِبُ

Word	Analysis
جَلَسَ	past verb - sat
الطَّالِبُ	doer / فَاعِلٌ; normally marfūʿ

There is no direct object because the sentence is already complete.

Common beginner mistakes

Mistake 1: “Every verbal sentence has an object.”
Correction: No. جَلَسَ أَحْمَدُ has a verb and doer, but no direct object.

Mistake 2: “Every noun with fatḥa is a direct object.”
Correction: No. Fatḥa can mark several different manṣūb jobs. Always identify the grammatical job first.

Mistake 3: “The doer must be a human.”
Correction: No. In سَقَطَ الْكِتَابُ, the book is the grammatical subject/doer of the verb “fell”.

Mistake 4: “The doer must always be a separate noun.”
Correction: Verb endings can carry pronoun information, as in كَتَبْتُ and كَتَبْنَا.

Unit 9 Independent Practice

For each sentence, identify the verb, doer and direct object if there is one.

1. أَكَلَ الطِّفْلُ التُّفَّاحَةَ

2. خَرَجَ الْمُعَلِّمُ

3. فَتَحَتْ مَرْيَمُ النَّافِذَةَ

4. وَقَفَ الرَّجُلُ

5. حَمَلَ الطَّالِبُ الْكِتَابَ

6. شَرِبْتُ الْمَاءَ

7. كَتَبْنَا الدَّرْسَ

8. نَامَ الْوَلَدُ

Model answers

1. Verb: أَكَلَ; doer: الطِّفْلُ; object: التُّفَّاحَةَ.
2. Verb: خَرَجَ; doer: الْمُعَلِّمُ; no direct object.
3. Verb: فَتَحَتْ; doer: مَرْيَمُ; object: النَّافِذَةَ.
4. Verb: وَقَفَ; doer: الرَّجُلُ; no direct object.
5. Verb: حَمَلَ; doer: الطَّالِبُ; object: الْكِتَابَ.
6. Verb: شَرِبْتُ; doer: attached pronoun “I”; object: الْمَاءَ.
7. Verb: كَتَبْنَا; doer: attached pronoun “we”; object: الدَّرْسَ.
8. Verb: نَامَ; doer: الْوَلَدُ; no direct object.

Unit 9 Checkpoint Exam

1. Define فَاعِلٌ in plain English.

2. Define مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ in plain English.

3. What grammatical state is the ordinary basic فَاعِلٌ normally in?

4. What grammatical state is the ordinary basic مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ normally in?

5. Parse: كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الرِّسَالَةَ.

6. Does جَلَسَ الطَّالِبُ contain a direct object? Explain.

7. What is the simple difference between فِعْلٌ لَازِمٌ and فِعْلٌ مُتَعَدٍّ?

8. In شَرِبْتُ الْمَاءَ, who is the doer?

9. Why is it unsafe to say “every noun with fatḥa is an object”?

10. Analyse: قَرَأَتْ فَاطِمَةُ الْكِتَابَ.

Model answers

1. The noun or pronoun that functions as the grammatical subject/doer of the verb.
2. The noun or pronoun directly affected by a transitive action.
3. Marfūʿ - مَرْفُوعٌ.
4. Manṣūb - مَنْصُوبٌ.
5. كَتَبَ = past verb; أَحْمَدُ = doer, marfūʿ; الرِّسَالَةَ = direct object, manṣūb.
6. No. “The student sat” is complete without a direct object.
7. A basic intransitive verb does not require a direct object; a transitive verb can act directly on an object.
8. The attached تُ carries the meaning “I”.
9. Because several different grammatical jobs can be manṣūb. The job must be identified from sentence structure and meaning.
10. فَرَأَتْ = past verb; فَاطِمَةُ = doer, marfūʿ; الْكِتَابَ = direct object, manṣūb.

Mastery target before Unit 10

You should now be able to find the verb, identify a visible or pronoun doer, decide whether a direct object is present, and explain the basic rule: the doer is normally marfūʿ and the direct object is normally manṣūb.

Cumulative Review 3 - Units 7-9

Mastery target: 80%. Answers are in Unit 15.

1. Name the four beginner features of adjective agreement.
2. Correct: الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرَ.
3. Explain the non-human plural adjective rule.
4. Define nominal sentence.
5. Define Mubtada’ and Khabar.
6. Define verbal sentence.
7. Define Fa‘il and Maf‘ul Bihi.
8. Give one intransitive verb sentence.
9. Give one transitive verb sentence.
10. Explain the basic verb-first agreement rule with a plural human subject.

Unit 9 Enrichment Lab

Worked example

كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ: student = Fa‘il; lesson = Maf‘ul Bihi.

Contrast pair
جَلَسَ أَحْمَدُ needs no object; فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ has an object.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: “The first noun is always the subject.” Fix: identify the verb and ask who performed it.

Build it yourself
Write one intransitive verbal sentence and one transitive verbal sentence.

Spiral review
Classify each noun in your sentences as definite or indefinite.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

UNIT 10 - CASE ENDINGS FROM ZERO

Unit 10 of 15

Unit 10 learning plan

Before you begin
Recognise common grammatical jobs.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Explain why endings change.
- Distinguish raf', nasb, jarr and jazm.
- Distinguish a grammatical state from its visible sign.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
إِعْرَابٌ	case/mood inflection
رَفْعٌ	nominative state
نَصْبٌ	accusative/subjunctive state
جَرٌّ	genitive state
جَزْمٌ	jussive state

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

الإِعْرَابُ وَالْحَالَاتُ الإِعْرَابِيَّةُ

Unit goal: understand why Arabic word endings can change, and learn the four core grammatical states: الرَّفْعُ, النَّصْبُ, الْجَرُّ, and الْجَزْمُ.

Important: this unit teaches the *basic idea* first. Later books will teach the many different signs used by duals, plurals, the five nouns, the five verbs, diptotes, weak verbs, and other special groups.

Lesson 56 - Why Do Arabic Endings Change?

In English, word order often tells us who is doing the action and what receives it. Arabic also uses word order, but it can additionally change the ending of a word to show its grammatical job.

Look at the same name in three different places:

Arabic	What you hear at the end	Simple explanation
جَاءَ أَحْمَدُ	ـُ / -u	Ahmed is the doer of “came”.
رَأَيْتُ أَحْمَدَ	ـَ / -a	Ahmed is the object of “I saw”.
مَرَرْتُ بِأَحْمَدَ	special proper-name pattern here	This example warns us that not every noun shows jarr with kasrah. We will study such exceptions later.

Why use that third example? Because accuracy matters. A beginner may hear “jarr = kasrah” and assume it is always true. It is the **basic** sign for many nouns, but not every noun uses kasrah. We will begin with ordinary examples such as فِي الْبَيْتِ.

The idea of I‘rab - الإِعْرَابُ

For now, think of الإِعْرَابُ as:

> **the grammatical change shown at the end of a word because of its position or the word that affects it.**

Later we will refine this definition and learn the difference between words whose endings change and words whose endings stay fixed.

State is not the same as sign

This distinction is extremely important.

State	Arabic	Common basic sign
Raf‘	رَفْعٌ	ضَمَّةٌ ـُ
Nasb	نَصْبٌ	فَتْحَةٌ ـَ
Jarr	جَرٌّ	كَسْرَةٌ ـِ
Jazm	جَزْمٌ	سُكُونٌ ـْ

Think:
State = the grammatical condition of the word.
Sign = how that state is shown on this particular word.

For a basic singular noun, raf‘ is often shown by a ḍammah. But later, a dual noun can be raf‘ with ـَانِ, and a sound masculine plural can be raf‘ with ـُونَ. The **state** is still raf‘ even though the visible **sign** is different.

Lesson 57 - Raf‘: الرَّفْعُ

Beginner idea: Raf‘ is the grammatical state used by several important sentence jobs. In the simplest examples, it is often shown by a ḍammah.

ـُ ـُ

These are common basic raf‘ signs for ordinary singular nouns.

Where have you already seen raf‘?

You have already studied two major places:

Job	Example	Raf‘ word
Doer / فَاعِلٌ	كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ	الطَّالِبُ
Mubtada’ / مُبْتَدَأٌ	الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	الْبَيْتُ
Khabar / خَبَرٌ	الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	كَبِيرٌ

So the sentences you already know were quietly teaching you raf‘.

Definite and indefinite

Form	Example	Note
Definite	الطَّالِبُ	single ḍammah
Indefinite	طَالِبٌ	tanwīn ḍamm

Do not memorise “raf‘ always means ḍammah”. Say instead: “ḍammah is the basic raf‘ sign I am learning first.”

Guided practice

Find the raf‘ word or words.

1. جَلَسَ الْوَلَدُ

2. الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ

3. فَتَحَ الْمُعَلِّمُ الْبَابَ

4. السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةٌ

Answers
1. الْوَلَدُ - doer, so it is marfū‘.
2. الطَّالِبُ and مُجْتَهِدٌ - Mubtada’ and Khabar; both are marfū‘ in this simple sentence.
3. الْمُعَلِّمُ - doer, marfū‘.
4. السَّيَّارَةُ and جَدِيدَةٌ - Mubtada’ and Khabar; both marfū‘.

Lesson 58 - Nasb: النَّصْبُ

Beginner idea: Nasb is another grammatical state. The direct object is one of the first manṣūb jobs you learn.

ـً ـَ

These are common basic nasb signs for ordinary singular nouns.

The direct object

كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ

Word	Job	State
كَتَبَ	verb	-
الطَّالِبُ	doer	marfū‘
الدَّرْسَ	direct object	manṣūb

Here الدَّرْسَ has a fatḥah because it is an ordinary singular direct object.

Indefinite object

كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ رِسَالَةً

رِسَالَةً is indefinite and manṣūb, so it shows tanwīn fatḥ.

Meaning first: many other grammatical jobs are also manṣūb. Therefore "fatḥah = object" is not a safe rule. The object is identified by its job in the sentence; nasb is its grammatical state.

Guided practice

Find the direct object and say that it is manṣūb.

1. قَرَأَ أَحْمَدُ الْكِتَابَ

2. شَرِبَ الْوَلَدُ الْمَاءَ

3. فَتَحَتْ مَرْيَمُ النَّافِذَةَ

4. كَتَبْتُ رِسَالَةً

Answers
1. الْكِتَابَ - direct object, manṣūb.
2. الْمَاءَ - direct object, manṣūb.
3. النَّافِذَةَ - direct object, manṣūb.
4. رِسَالَةً - direct object, manṣūb.

Lesson 59 - Jarr: الْجَرُّ

Beginner idea: Jarr is a grammatical state that applies to nouns. One of its easiest causes is coming after a preposition.

-ٍ -ِ

These are common basic jarr signs for ordinary singular nouns.

After a preposition

Phrase	Preposition	Majrūr noun
فِي الْبَيْتِ	فِي	الْبَيْتِ
إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ	إِلَى	الْمَسْجِدِ
مِنَ السُّوقِ	مِنْ	السُّوقِ
عَلَى الْكُرْسِيِّ	عَلَى	الْكُرْسِيِّ

The noun after the preposition is called:

اِسْمٌ مَجْرُورٌ

Basic rule: a noun governed by a preposition is majrūr.

Indefinite example

فِي بَيْتٍ

“in a house” - بَيْتٍ is indefinite and majrūr, so it has tanwīn kasr.

Important: jarr belongs to nouns. A verb is not described as majrūr. Later we will also learn another major cause of jarr: Idafah.

Guided practice

Find the preposition and the majrūr noun.

1. الْكِتَابُ عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ

2. ذَهَبَ أَحْمَدُ إِلَى الْمَدْرَسَةِ

3. خَرَجَ الطَّالِبُ مِنَ الْفَصْلِ

4. مُحَمَّدٌ فِي مَسْجِدٍ

Answers
1. عَلَى + الطَّاوِلَةِ (majrūr).
2. إِلَى + الْمَدْرَسَةِ (majrūr).
3. مِنْ + الْفَصْلِ (majrūr).
4. فِي + مَسْجِدٍ (majrūr).

Lesson 60 - Jazm: الْجَزْمُ

Beginner idea: Jazm is different from the other three states because it applies to the present-tense verb, not to ordinary nouns.

You have learned:

State	Applies to	Basic sign being introduced
Raf‘	nouns and present verbs	ـُ
Nasb	nouns and present verbs	ـَ
Jarr	**nouns only**	ـِ
Jazm	**present verbs only**	ـْ

Simple example with لَمْ

يَكْتُبُ

He writes / is writing.

لَمْ يَكْتُبْ

He did not write.

The final ḍammah of the basic present verb disappears and the verb is shown here with sukūn:

يَكْتُبْ

We say the verb is:

مَجْزُومٌ

Do not overgeneralise: sukūn is only the basic jazm sign we are introducing. Some present verbs show jazm by deleting a final letter or deleting ن. Those rules belong to later units and the Intermediate books.

More beginner examples

Normal present	With لَمْ	Meaning
يَجْلِسُ	لَمْ يَجْلِسْ	he did not sit
يَفْتَحُ	لَمْ يَفْتَحْ	he did not open
يَشْرَبُ	لَمْ يَشْرَبْ	he did not drink

For Beginner Nahw: recognise the idea. Detailed particles of nasb and jazm, the five verbs, and weak-verb changes will be taught later in the curriculum.

Lesson 61 - Putting the Four States Together

Learning goal: choose the correct state from the grammatical job, rather than guessing from the vowel alone.
Prerequisite: the previous lesson in this unit.

Example	Target word	Why?	State
جَاءَ الطَّالِبُ	الطَّالِبُ	doer	raf‘
رَأَيْتُ الطَّالِبَ	الطَّالِبَ	direct object	nasb
مَرَرْتُ بِالطَّالِبِ	الطَّالِبِ	after بِـ	jarr
لَمْ يَجْلِسْ	يَجْلِسْ	present verb after لَمْ	jazm

A powerful comparison

Watch the noun الطَّالِب change according to its job:

Sentence	Job	Form
جَاءَ الطَّالِبُ	doer	الطَّالِبُ
رَأَيْتُ الطَّالِبَ	object	الطَّالِبَ
سَلَّمْتُ عَلَى الطَّالِبِ	after preposition	الطَّالِبِ

This is the beginner heart of I'rab: **same noun, different grammatical job, different ending.**

What about words whose endings do not visibly change?

Arabic grammar also contains words that are **built/fixed** in form (مَبْنِيّ) and words whose case may be estimated rather than clearly pronounced. We are not ignoring them; they are intentionally saved for later so the beginner first understands the main system.

Common beginner mistakes

Mistake 1: "Ḍammah means subject."
Correction: ḍammah is a sign. Many different jobs can be marfūʿ.

Mistake 2: "Fatḥah means object."
Correction: many jobs can be manṣūb. A direct object is only one of them.

Mistake 3: "Kasrah means after a preposition."
Correction: jarr has more than one cause, and some majrūr nouns use signs other than kasrah.

Mistake 4: "Jazm applies to nouns."
Correction: jazm belongs to the present-tense verb.

Unit 10 Guided Review

For each bold idea, give the grammatical state.

1. The doer in كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ.

2. The object in قَرَأَ الطَّالِبُ الْكِتَابَ.

3. The noun after فِي in فِي الْبَيْتِ.

4. The present verb after لَمْ in لَمْ يَكْتُبْ.

5. The Mubtada’ in الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ.

6. The Khabar in الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ.

Answers

1. Raf‘.
2. Nasb.
3. Jarr.
4. Jazm.
5. Raf‘.
6. Raf‘.

Unit 10 Checkpoint Exam

1. Explain the difference between a grammatical **state** and its **sign**.

2. Name the four grammatical states introduced in this unit.

3. Which state is used by the ordinary basic doer?

4. Which state is used by the ordinary basic direct object?

5. Which state follows a preposition?

6. Which state applies to a present verb after لَمْ?

7. Analyse the ending of الطَّالِبُ in جَاءَ الطَّالِبُ.

8. Analyse الْكِتَابَ in قَرَأَ أَحْمَدُ الْكِتَابَ.

9. Analyse الْمَسْجِدِ in ذَهَبْتُ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ.

10. Why is “raf‘ always equals ḍammah” an incomplete rule?

Model answers

1. The state is the grammatical condition of the word; the sign is the form used to show that state on that word.
2. الرَّفْعُ، النَّصْبُ، الْجَرُّ، الْجَزْمُ.
3. Raf‘.
4. Nasb.
5. Jarr for the governed noun.
6. Jazm.
7. الطَّالِبُ is the doer, so it is marfūʿ; here raf‘ is shown by ḍammah.
8. الْكِتَابَ is the direct object, so it is manṣūb; here nasb is shown by fatḥah.
9. الْمَسْجِدِ follows إِلَى, so it is majrūr; here jarr is shown by kasrah.
10. Because Arabic uses other raf‘ signs for some word types, such as the dual and sound masculine plural. Ḍammah is the basic sign, not the only sign.

Mastery target before Unit 11

You should now be able to explain the difference between **job → state → sign**, recognise the basic use of raf‘, nasb, jarr and jazm, and avoid the mistake of treating ḍammah/fatḥah/kasrah/sukūn as the grammatical jobs themselves.

Unit 10 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
In كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ, الطَّالِبُ is marfu‘ and الدَّرْسَ is mansub. Job/state comes before the visible vowel sign.

Contrast pair
State ≠ sign: raf‘ is a grammatical state; ḍammah is one common sign of raf‘.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: “Every marfu‘ word must visibly end in ḍammah.” Fix: advanced Arabic uses other signs too; Beginner Nahw starts with the common signs.

Build it yourself
Mark the state of the doer, object and noun after a preposition in three familiar sentences.

Spiral review
Return to Units 8-9 and explain which grammatical jobs commonly lead to raf‘ and nasb.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 11 - Prepositions حُرُوفُ الْجَرِّ

Unit 11 of 15

Unit 11 learning plan

Before you begin
Understand jarr.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Recognise common Arabic prepositions.
- Explain why the following noun is majrur.
- Recognise prepositions with attached pronouns.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
حَرْفُ جَرٍّ	preposition
فِي	in
مِنْ	from
إِلَى	to
عَلَى	on
مَجْرُورٌ	in jarr state

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal
Understand what a preposition does, learn the most useful Arabic prepositions, and recognise why the noun after a true preposition is مَجْرُورٌ.

Lesson 62 - What is a preposition?

Start with English. Words such as **in, from, to, on, with** connect one idea to another:

English	What it tells us
in the house	place
from the school	starting point
to the mosque	direction / destination
on the table	position
with the pen	instrument / means in some contexts

Arabic has words that do similar work. In traditional Nahw, an important group is called:

حُرُوفُ الْجَرِّ

Literally: **particles of jarr**.

> **The beginner rule**
> A true حَرْفُ جَرٍّ causes the noun it governs to be مَجْرُورًا.

Connect this to Unit 10

You already learned that **jarr is a grammatical state**. Now you are learning one of the most common causes of that state.

Step	Example	What happens?
1. Preposition	فِي	the governing particle
2. Noun after it	الْبَيْتِ	becomes majrūr
3. Basic visible sign	ـِ	kasrah here shows jarr

فِي الْبَيْتِ

in the house

Do not confuse the cause with the sign

> **Cause:** the noun comes after the preposition فِي.
> **State:** the noun is مَجْرُورٌ.
> **Sign in this example:** kasrah.

So do not say, “The noun is majrūr because it has kasrah.” The better explanation is: **it is majrūr because a preposition governs it; kasrah is the sign showing that state here.**

Lesson 63 - The most useful beginner prepositions

Arabic	Simple meaning	Example	Meaning
فِي	in / inside	فِي الْبَيْتِ	in the house
مِنْ	from	مِنَ الْبَيْتِ	from the house
إِلَى	to / toward	إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ	to the mosque
عَلَى	on / upon	عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ	on the table
عَنْ	from / about / away from	عَنِ الدَّرْسِ	about the lesson
بِـ	with / by / using	بِالْقَلَمِ	with the pen
لِـ	for / belonging to	لِلطَّالِبِ	for the student
كَـ	like / as	كَالْأَسَدِ	like the lion

Meaning depends on context. English translations are useful guides, but one Arabic preposition can have more than one English meaning. We will learn wider meanings gradually through sentences.

فِي - in

فِي often shows location or being inside something.

Arabic sentence	Plain English	Majrūr noun
أَحْمَدُ فِي الْبَيْتِ	Ahmed is in the house.	الْبَيْتِ
الْكِتَابُ فِي الْحَقِيبَةِ	The book is in the bag.	الْحَقِيبَةِ
الطَّالِبُ فِي الْفَصْلِ	The student is in the classroom.	الْفَصْلِ

Notice that the sentence can be nominal even though it contains a prepositional phrase. For now, simply recognise فِي + اسم مجرور.

مِنْ - from

مِنْ commonly shows a starting point or source.

Arabic	Meaning
خَرَجَ أَحْمَدُ مِنَ الْبَيْتِ	Ahmed left the house / came out of the house.
رَجَعَ الطَّالِبُ مِنَ الْمَدْرَسَةِ	The student returned from the school.
هَذَا مِنَ الْكِتَابِ	This is from the book.

You may hear مِنَ before a word beginning with الـ. The short helping vowel makes pronunciation easier; the preposition itself is مِنْ.

إِلَى - to / toward

إِلَى commonly shows direction or destination.

Arabic	Meaning	After إِلَى
ذَهَبَ أَحْمَدُ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ	Ahmed went to the mosque.	الْمَسْجِدِ
ذَهَبَتْ فَاطِمَةُ إِلَى الْمَدْرَسَةِ	Fatimah went to the school.	الْمَدْرَسَةِ

عَلَى - on / upon

Arabic	Meaning
الْكِتَابُ عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ	The book is on the table.
جَلَسَ أَحْمَدُ عَلَى الْكُرْسِيِّ	Ahmed sat on the chair.

عَنْ - about / away from

Arabic	Meaning
سَأَلَ الطَّالِبُ عَنِ الدَّرْسِ	The student asked about the lesson.
ابْتَعَدَ عَنِ الْبَابِ	He moved away from the door.

> Do not force one English translation onto every Arabic preposition. Learn the core idea, then learn its different uses through real examples.

Lesson 64 - The one-letter prepositions

Some common Arabic prepositions are attached directly to the following word in writing.

Particle	Example	Meaning
بِـ	بِالْقَلَمِ	with/by the pen
لِـ	لِلطَّالِبِ	for the student
كَـ	كَالْأَسَدِ	like the lion

They are still separate grammatical particles even though they are written attached to the next word.

بِـ - with / by / using

كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ بِالْقَلَمِ

Ahmed wrote with the pen.

الْقَلَمِ is majrūr because of بِـ.

لِـ - for / belonging to

هَذَا الْكِتَابُ لِلطَّالِبِ

This book is for the student.

كَـ - like / as

هُوَ كَالْأَسَدِ فِي الشَّجَاعَةِ

He is like a lion in courage.

Lesson 65 - What exactly becomes majrūr?

The preposition governs the **Ism** after it. In a basic example:

فِي الْمَسْجِدِ

Word	Category	Grammar
فِي	Harf	حَرْفُ جَرٍّ
الْمَسْجِدِ	Ism	اِسْمٌ مَجْرُورٌ

A useful beginner parsing sentence is:

فِي: حَرْفُ جَرٍّ.
الْمَسْجِدِ: اِسْمٌ مَجْرُورٌ بِفِي، وَعَلَامَةُ جَرِّهِ الْكَسْرَةُ.

Plain English: "فِي is a preposition. الْمَسْجِدِ is a noun made majrūr by فِي, and its jarr is shown here by kasrah."

Jarr does not always look like a kasrah

You learned this principle in Unit 10. Here it matters again.

Word type	Example after a preposition	Visible jarr sign
ordinary singular noun	مَعَ الطَّالِبِ	kasrah in the basic case
dual	عَلَى الطَّالِبَيْنِ	ي in the dual ending
sound masculine plural	عَلَى الْمُسْلِمِينَ	ي in the plural ending

Important accuracy note: مَعَ means "with," but it is normally analysed as an adverb/noun of accompaniment rather than one of the core حُرُوفُ الْجَرِّ. We include it here only to illustrate a following genitive construction; the true prepositions in this unit are the particles listed above.

Preposition + definite noun

Without preposition	After preposition
الْبَيْتُ	فِي الْبَيْتِ
الْمَسْجِدُ	إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ
الطَّالِبُ	لِلطَّالِبِ

Preposition + indefinite noun

Before	After preposition	Meaning
بَيْتٌ	فِي بَيْتٍ	in a house
مَسْجِدٌ	إِلَى مَسْجِدٍ	to a mosque
كِتَابٌ	مِنْ كِتَابٍ	from a book

For an ordinary indefinite singular noun, the basic jarr sign appears as **kasratayn**:

ـٍ

Lesson 66 - Prepositions with attached pronouns

A preposition can also be followed by an attached pronoun instead of a visible noun.

Phrase	Meaning	What changed?
فِيهِ	in it / in him (depending on referent)	ـهِ attached to فِي
فِيهَا	in it / in her	ـهَا
مِنْهُ	from him / from it	ـهُ
إِلَيْهِ	to him	attached pronoun after إِلَى
عَلَيْهَا	on her / on it	attached pronoun after عَلَى
لَهُ	for him / he has	ـهُ after لِـ
بِهِ	with him/it; by means of it	ـهِ after بِـ

In traditional analysis, the attached pronoun is said to be:

فِي مَحَلِّ جَرٍّ

in the grammatical position of jarr

> A pronoun such as ـهُ is built/fixed in form, so you do not look for a visible kasrah on it in the same way as an ordinary declinable noun.

Compare three uses of the same pronoun

Arabic	Meaning	Job
كِتَابُهُ	his book	attached possession; pronoun in a genitive relationship
رَأَيْتُهُ	I saw him/it	attached object pronoun
فِيهِ	in him/it	attached pronoun after a preposition

The same pronoun ending can have different grammatical jobs depending on what it attaches to.

Lesson 67 - Prepositional phrases inside sentences

A preposition plus what it governs forms a useful phrase:

فِي الْبَيْتِ

At beginner level, call this a **prepositional phrase**. In Arabic grammar you will often hear:

جَارٌّ وَمَجْرُورٌ

meaning: a preposition together with its majrūr element.

Example in a nominal sentence

اَلْكِتَابُ عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ

The book is on the table.

Part	Job
اَلْكِتَابُ	Mubtada’
عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ	prepositional phrase giving the information about the book

> At a later level we will analyse exactly how a prepositional phrase functions as or relates to the Khabar. For now, understand the sentence meaning and recognise the جَارٌّ وَمَجْرُورٌ.

Example in a verbal sentence

ذَهَبَ أَحْمَدُ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ

Part	Job
ذَهَبَ	verb
أَحْمَدُ	doer
إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ	prepositional phrase showing destination

Common beginner mistakes

> **Mistake 1:** “Every word meaning ‘with’ is a Harf Jarr.”
> **Correction:** Arabic can express similar English meanings through different grammatical structures. Learn the Arabic category, not only the translation.

> **Mistake 2:** “The noun after a preposition must always visibly have kasrah.”
> **Correction:** it is majrūr, but the sign of jarr depends on the word type.

> **Mistake 3:** writing the one-letter particles separately as if they were independent words.
> **Correction:** بِـ، لِـ، كَـ attach in writing: بِالْقَلَمِ، لِلطَّالِبِ، كَالْأَسَدِ.

Mistake 4: thinking the preposition itself becomes majrūr.
Correction: the preposition governs the Ism after it; the governed Ism is majrūr.

Mistake 5: assuming English and Arabic prepositions always match one-to-one.
Correction: preposition choice is often idiomatic and must be learned through examples.

Guided Practice

For each phrase, identify the preposition and the majrūr noun.

1. فِي الْبَيْتِ

2. إِلَى الْمَدْرَسَةِ

3. عَلَى الْكُرْسِيِّ

4. مِنَ الْمَسْجِدِ

5. بِالْقَلَمِ

6. لِلطَّالِبِ

Answers
1. فِي / الْبَيْتِ.
2. إِلَى / الْمَدْرَسَةِ.
3. عَلَى / الْكُرْسِيِّ.
4. مِنْ / الْمَسْجِدِ.
5. بِـ / الْقَلَمِ.
6. لِـ / الطَّالِبِ.

Practice: choose a suitable preposition

Use one suitable word from: فِي، مِنْ، إِلَى، عَلَى، بِـ، لِـ.

1. “in the house” = _____ الْبَيْتِ

2. “to the mosque” = _____ الْمَسْجِدِ

3. “with the pen” = _____ الْقَلَمِ

4. “on the table” = _____ الطَّاوِلَةِ

5. “from the school” = _____ الْمَدْرَسَةِ

6. “for the student” = _____ الطَّالِبِ

Model answers

1. فِي الْبَيْتِ
2. إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ
3. بِالْقَلَمِ
4. عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ
5. مِنَ الْمَدْرَسَةِ
6. لِلطَّالِبِ

Unit 11 Checkpoint Exam

1. What is حَرْفُ جَرٍّ?

2. What grammatical state does a true preposition normally cause in the Ism it governs?

3. Name six common Arabic prepositions from this unit.

4. Parse فِي الْبَيْتِ at beginner level.

5. Why is الْمَسْجِدِ majrūr in إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ?

6. What is the basic jarr sign on an ordinary singular noun?

7. Is kasrah the only possible sign of jarr? Explain briefly.

8. What does فِيهِ mean, and what is the grammatical position of the attached pronoun?

9. Explain the difference between the **cause**, **state**, and **sign** in بِالْقَلَمِ.

10. Analyse the sentence ذَهَبَ أَحْمَدُ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ into verb, doer, preposition, and majrūr noun.

11. Explain why translating a preposition with only one English word can be misleading.

12. Correct the idea: “Any Arabic word that translates as ‘with’ must be a Harf Jarr.”

Model answers

1. A grammatical particle that governs an Ism and causes it to be in jarr.
2. Jarr; the Ism becomes مَجْرُورًا.
3. Examples: فِي، مِنْ، إِلَى، عَلَى، عَنْ، بِـ، لِـ، كَـ (any six).
4. فِي is a Harf Jarr; الْبَيْتِ is an Ism majrūr by it, with kasrah as the basic visible sign here.
5. Because it is governed by the preposition إِلَى.
6. Kasrah.
7. No. Dual and sound masculine plural nouns, for example, use ي in their jarr forms.
8. “In him/it.” The attached pronoun is in the grammatical position of jarr.
9. Cause = بِـ; state = jarr; sign here = kasrah on الْقَلَمِ.
10. ذَهَبَ verb; أَحْمَدُ doer; إِلَى preposition; الْمَسْجِدِ majrūr noun.
11. Arabic prepositions can carry several meanings depending on the construction and context.
12. Similar English meanings can come from different Arabic grammatical structures; identify the Arabic form and category itself.

Mastery target before Unit 12
You should be able to recognise the main beginner حُرُوفُ الْجَرِّ, identify the Ism they govern, explain why that Ism is majrūr, distinguish state from sign, and recognise simple attached pronouns after prepositions.

Unit 11 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
فِي الْبَيْتِ: فِي is a preposition and الْبَيْتِ is majrur.

Contrast pair
الْبَيْتُ may be marfu‘ in one sentence, while فِي الْبَيْتِ makes it majrur after the preposition.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: calling kasrah the grammatical job. Fix: jarr is the state; kasrah is a common sign.

Build it yourself
Make phrases using فِي، مِنْ، إِلَى، عَلَى with four different nouns.

Spiral review
For each noun, state whether it is definite/indefinite and why.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 12 - Idafah / Possession الإِضَافَةُ

Unit 12 of 15

Unit 12 learning plan

Before you begin
Understand definiteness and jarr.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Build a two-word Idafah.
- Identify Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh.
- Handle definiteness, jarr and adjective placement in simple Idafah.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
إِضَافَةٌ	possessive/construct phrase
مُضَافٌ	first noun
مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ	second noun
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ	the student's book

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal
Learn how Arabic joins two Isms to express possession, belonging, description by relationship, or "of" relationships. By the end, you should be able to recognise and build simple Idafah phrases, identify مُضَافٌ and مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ, and explain why the second noun is majrūr.

1. Begin with English: "Ahmed's book"

English often places the owner first:

English	Owner	Thing owned
Ahmed's book	Ahmed	book
the student's pen	the student	pen
the house's door	the house	door

Arabic usually reverses this order. It puts the **thing first**, then the person or thing it belongs to.

Arabic	Literal order	Natural English
كِتَابُ أَحْمَدَ	book of Ahmed	Ahmed's book
قَلَمُ الطَّالِبِ	pen of the student	the student's pen
بَابُ الْبَيْتِ	door of the house	the door of the house

> **Easy memory rule:** English often says **owner + thing**. Arabic Idafah usually says **thing + owner**.

2. The two parts of an Idafah

An Idafah normally contains at least two Isms.

Position	Arabic term	Plain English	Example
First noun	مُضَافٌ	the thing being linked/possessed	كِتَابُ
Second noun	مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ	the owner / second linked noun	الطَّالِبِ

In كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ:

> كِتَابُ = مُضَافٌ
> الطَّالِبِ = مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ
>
> Meaning: **the student's book**.

3. Core rule 1: the second noun is majrūr

The مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ is in the grammatical state of جَرّ.

Phrase	Second noun	Why?
بَابُ الْبَيْتِ	الْبَيْتِ	second noun of Idafah, so majrūr
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ	الطَّالِبِ	second noun of Idafah, so majrūr
مِفْتَاحُ السَّيَّارَةِ	السَّيَّارَةِ	second noun of Idafah, so majrūr

> **Important:** Idafah itself is a reason for jarr. A preposition is not required. In بَابُ الْبَيْتِ, الْبَيْتِ is majrūr because it is مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ.

4. Core rule 2: the first noun does not take tanwin

Compare a normal indefinite noun with the same noun when it becomes the first member of an Idafah.

Normal noun	In Idafah	What changed?
كِتَابٌ = a book	كِتَابُ طَالِبٍ	tanwin disappears from كِتَابٌ
بَابٌ = a door	بَابُ بَيْتٍ	tanwin disappears from بَابٌ

The first noun, the مُضَافٌ, does not take tanwin while it is in this construction.

5. Core rule 3: do not put الـ on the first noun in a basic Idafah

For beginner Idafah, we write:

> كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ ✓
> بَابُ الْبَيْتِ ✓

We do **not** normally write the first noun with الـ:

> الْكِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ ✗ as an attempt to mean “the student's book.”
>
> The Idafah itself can make the first noun definite when the second noun is definite.

6. How definiteness works in Idafah

This is one of the most useful ideas in the unit.

Idafah	Meaning	Definite?
كِتَابُ طَالِبٍ	a student's book / a book of a student	indefinite
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ	the student's book	definite
كِتَابُ أَحْمَدَ	Ahmed's book	definite because Ahmed is a proper name

The first noun gets its definiteness from the second part of the Idafah.

> **Simple rule:**
> If the مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ is definite, the whole Idafah is definite.
> If the مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ is indefinite, the whole Idafah remains indefinite.

7. The first noun still has its own sentence job

The second noun is always majrūr because of Idafah, but the first noun can be marfūʿ, manṣūb, or majrūr depending on its job in the larger sentence.

Sentence	First noun	Second noun
هَذَا كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ This is the student's book.	كِتَابُ is marfūʿ here	الطَّالِبِ remains majrūr
قَرَأْتُ كِتَابَ الطَّالِبِ I read the student's book.	كِتَابَ is manṣūb as object	الطَّالِبِ remains majrūr
نَظَرْتُ إِلَى كِتَابِ الطَّالِبِ I looked at the student's book.	كِتَابِ is majrūr after إِلَى	الطَّالِبِ remains majrūr by Idafah

This is a powerful Nahw idea: the two nouns are connected to each other, but each also has its own grammatical reason for its ending.

8. Idafah is not only literal ownership

It can show many “of” relationships.

Arabic	Literal idea	Natural English
بَابُ الْبَيْتِ	door of the house	the house door / door of the house
إِمَامُ الْمَسْجِدِ	imam of the mosque	the mosque's imam
لُغَةُ الْعَرَبِ	language of the Arabs	the language of the Arabs
مَاءُ الْبَحْرِ	water of the sea	seawater / the sea's water

So “possession” is a useful beginner label, but Idafah is broader: it links one noun closely to another.

9. Idafah with proper names

Arabic	Meaning
كِتَابُ مُحَمَّدٍ	Muhammad's book
بَيْتُ خَالِدٍ	Khalid's house
سَيَّارَةُ فَاطِمَةَ	Fatimah's car

Accuracy note: proper names can have different case behaviour. For example, some names are diptotes and do not show ordinary kasrah in jarr. You do not need the full diptote system yet; we will teach it later. The key beginner point is that the proper name occupies the مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ position.

10. Idafah with attached pronouns

You already learned forms such as كِتَابُهُ in the pronoun unit.

Arabic	Breakdown	Meaning
كِتَابُهُ	كِتَابُ + هُ	his book
كِتَابُهَا	كِتَابُ + هَا	her book
كِتَابِي	كِتَابُ + ي	my book
كِتَابُنَا	كِتَابُ + نَا	our book

The attached pronoun is in the grammatical position of jarr because it functions as the second member of the possessive relationship.

> كِتَابُهُ
> كِتَابُ = first member / مُضَافٌ
> هُـ = attached pronoun in the position of jarr / مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ.

11. Longer Idafah chains

Arabic can connect more than two nouns.

> بَابُ بَيْتِ الطَّالِبِ
>
> Literal: door of house of the student
> Natural English: **the door of the student's house**.

Step by step:

Word	Role
بَابُ	first thing: door
بَيْتِ	linked to door, and itself linked to the next noun
الطَّالِبِ	final owner/link; majrūr

> **Do not rush.** Read a long chain in small pieces: بَابُ بَيْتِ = door of a house; then بَيْتِ الطَّالِبِ = the student's house.

12. Adjectives with Idafah: which noun are you describing?

This is where endings become very useful.

Arabic	Meaning	What does the adjective describe?
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ الْجَدِيدُ	the student's new book	الْجَدِيدُ describes كِتَابُ
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ الْجَدِيدِ	the new student's book	الْجَدِيدِ describes الطَّالِبِ

Notice the final vowel:

> الْجَدِيدُ matches the first noun's marfūʿ state.
> الْجَدِيدِ matches the second noun's majrūr state.

This shows why adjective agreement and case endings matter: they tell you which noun the adjective belongs to.

13. Idafah versus adjective phrase

Do not confuse these two structures.

Structure	Arabic	Meaning
Idafah	بَابُ الْبَيْتِ	the door of the house
Noun + adjective	الْبَابُ الْكَبِيرُ	the big door

In Idafah, the second Ism identifies a relationship. In an adjective phrase, the second word describes the first.

14. Idafah versus a complete sentence

Arabic	What is it?	Meaning
بَابُ الْبَيْتِ	Idafah phrase	the door of the house
بَابُ الْبَيْتِ مَفْتُوحٌ	complete nominal sentence	the door of the house is open

The Idafah can function as one larger noun phrase inside a sentence.

15. Common beginner mistakes

> **Mistake 1:** keeping English word order.
> **Wrong idea:** "Ahmed book."
> **Correction:** Arabic puts the thing first: كِتَابُ أَحْمَدَ.

> **Mistake 2:** adding tanwin to the first noun.
> **Correction:** the مُضَافٌ does not take tanwin: كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ, not كِتَابٌ الطَّالِبِ.

Mistake 3: adding الـ to the first noun in a basic Idafah.
Correction: بَابُ الْبَيْتِ, not an attempted الْبَابُ الْبَيْتِ for “the door of the house.”

Mistake 4: forgetting jarr on the second noun.
Correction: كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ; the second noun is مَجْرُورٌ.

Mistake 5: assuming the first noun is always marfūʿ.
Correction: its state depends on its job in the sentence: كِتَابُ / كِتَابَ / كِتَابِ الطَّالِبِ are all possible in different contexts.

Guided Practice A - identify the two parts

For each phrase, identify the مُضَافٌ and مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ.

1. بَابُ الْبَيْتِ

2. قَلَمُ الطَّالِبِ

3. مَفْتَاحُ السَّيَّارَةِ

4. كِتَابُ مُحَمَّدٍ

5. إِمَامُ الْمَسْجِدِ

Answers
1. بَابُ = Muḍāf; الْبَيْتِ = Muḍāf Ilayh.
2. قَلَمُ / الطَّالِبِ.
3. مَفْتَاحُ / السَّيَّارَةِ.
4. كِتَابُ / مُحَمَّدٍ.
5. إِمَامُ / الْمَسْجِدِ.

Guided Practice B - build the Arabic phrase

Translate using Idafah.

1. the student's book

2. the house door / the door of the house

3. Muhammad's pen

4. the mosque's imam

5. Fatimah's car

Model answers
1. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ
2. بَابُ الْبَيْتِ
3. قَلَمُ مُحَمَّدٍ
4. إِمَامُ الْمَسْجِدِ
5. سَيَّارَةُ فَاطِمَةَ

Guided Practice C - explain the endings

In each sentence, explain the state of the first Idafah noun and why the second noun is majrūr.

1. هَذَا كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ

2. قَرَأْتُ كِتَابَ الطَّالِبِ

3. نَظَرْتُ إِلَى كِتَابِ الطَّالِبِ

Explanation
1. كِتَابُ is marfūʿ in this sentence; الطَّالِبِ is majrūr because it is Muḍāf Ilayh.
2. كِتَابَ is manṣūb because it is the direct object of قَرَأْتُ; الطَّالِبِ remains majrūr by Idafah.
3. كِتَابِ is majrūr after إِلَى; الطَّالِبِ is also majrūr, but for a different reason: it is Muḍāf Ilayh.

Unit 12 Checkpoint Exam

1. What is الإِضَافَةُ in simple English?

2. What is the first noun called?

3. What is the second noun called?

4. What grammatical state is the مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ in?

5. What happens to tanwin on the first noun?

6. In a basic Idafah, should the first noun normally take الـ?

7. Explain the difference between كِتَابُ طَالِبٍ and كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ.

8. Analyse بَابُ الْبَيْتِ.

9. Why is الطَّالِبِ majrūr in كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ?

10. Explain why the first noun can appear as كِتَابُ, كِتَابَ, or كِتَابِ in different sentences.

11. Analyse كِتَابُهُ as a possessive structure.

12. Translate: “the door of the student's house.”

13. What is the difference in meaning between كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ الْجَدِيدُ and كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ الْجَدِيدِ?

14. Is every Idafah literal ownership? Give one example that is a relationship rather than ownership.

15. Correct this attempted phrase for “the student's book”: الْكِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ.

Model answers

1. A close noun-to-noun construction often translated with “of” or English possession.
2. مُضَافٌ.
3. مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ.
4. Jarr; it is majrūr.
5. The first noun does not take tanwin while it is Muḍāf.
6. No, not in the basic construct taught here.
7. كِتَابُ طَالِبٍ = a student's book (indefinite); كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ = the student's book (definite).
8. بَابُ = Muḍāf; الْبَيْتِ = Muḍāf Ilayh, majrūr.
9. Because it is the Muḍāf Ilayh.
10. The first noun takes its grammatical state from its own job in the sentence: it may be marfūʿ, manṣūb, or majrūr.
11. كِتَابُ is the possessed noun; ـهُ is an attached pronoun in the position of jarr, functioning as Muḍāf Ilayh; meaning “his book.”
12. بَابُ بَيْتِ الطَّالِبِ.
13. With الْجَدِيدُ, “new” describes the book. With الْجَدِيدِ, “new” describes the student.
14. No. Example: إِمَامُ الْمَسْجِدِ = the imam of the mosque.
15. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ.

Mastery target before Unit 13

You should be able to build and recognise a basic Idafah, identify Muḍāf and Muḍāf Ilayh, explain why the second noun is majrūr, explain why the first noun has no tanwin, distinguish definite and indefinite Idafah, and understand simple attached-pronoun and multi-noun Idafah structures.

Book 1 - Beginner Nahw • Units 1-12 complete • Unit 13 begins next

Cumulative Review 4 - Units 10-12

Mastery target: 80%. Answers are in Unit 15.

1. What is I‘rab in beginner terms?
2. Distinguish state from sign.
3. Which states can nouns enter?
4. Which states can changeable present verbs enter?
5. What does a preposition do to the following noun?
6. Give three common Arabic prepositions.
7. Define Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh.
8. Give two core Idafah rules.
9. Explain why كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ is definite.
10. Analyse the endings in فِي بَيْتِ الطَّالِبِ.

Unit 12 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ: book = Mudaf; student = Mudaf Ilayh and is majrur.

Contrast pair
بَيْتُ الطَّالِبِ is Idafah; بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ is noun + adjective.

Error-correction focus
Wrong basic form: الْكِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ when you mean “the student’s book.” Fix: كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ.

Build it yourself
Build: Ahmed’s book; the door of the house; the teacher’s new car.

Spiral review
Explain how jarr from Unit 10 appears in the second noun of Idafah.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 13 - Questions and Negation

Unit 13 of 15

Unit 13 learning plan

Before you begin
Recognise basic nominal and verbal sentences.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Form basic yes/no and information questions.
- Use beginner negation particles appropriately.
- Recognise the effect of lam and lan at beginner level.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
هَلْ	yes/no question
مَنْ	who
مَا	what
أَيْنَ	where
لَمْ	did not
لَنْ	will not

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: ask simple questions correctly, recognise the main beginner question words, answer yes/no questions, and understand the most useful basic ways Arabic makes a sentence negative.

Questions and negative sentences are everyday Arabic. The important thing is not to memorise a long list of particles without understanding them. We will first ask **what kind of meaning** the sentence needs, then choose the appropriate Arabic tool.

Two big ideas:
1. A question asks for information or confirmation.
2. Negation tells us that something did not happen, is not true, does not happen, or will not happen.

Lesson 68 - Yes/No Questions with هَلْ

English often changes word order to make a question: “You are a student” becomes “Are you a student?” Arabic can keep the basic sentence and place هَلْ at the beginning.

Statement	Question	Meaning
أَنْتَ طَالِبٌ	هَلْ أَنْتَ طَالِبٌ؟	You are a student. / Are you a student?
الْبَابُ مَفْتُوحٌ	هَلْ الْبَابُ مَفْتُوحٌ؟	The door is open. / Is the door open?
كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ	هَلْ كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ؟	Ahmed wrote. / Did Ahmed write?

Easy rule: at beginner level, think of هَلْ as a question particle that often turns a statement into a yes/no question.

How do you answer?

Arabic	Meaning	Example
نَعَمْ	yes	نَعَمْ، أَنَا طَالِبٌ - Yes, I am a student.
لَا	no	لَا، لَسْتُ طَالِبًا - No, I am not a student.

Do not confuse two uses of لَا. By itself, لَا can mean “no.” In other sentences it can also be a negative particle. Context tells you which job it is doing.

Lesson 69 - The Question Hamzah أَ

Arabic can also form a yes/no question with the interrogative hamzah أَ. It attaches to the beginning of the following word.

Arabic	Meaning
أَأَنْتَ طَالِبٌ؟	Are you a student?
أَذَهَبَ مُحَمَّدٌ؟	Did Muhammad go?
أَهَذَا كِتَابُكَ؟	Is this your book?

For a beginner, هَلْ is often easier to recognise. The hamzah is extremely important too, but it has additional uses that we will study more fully at higher levels.

Lesson 70 - Question Words: Asking for Information

A yes/no question asks whether something is true. A question word asks for a missing piece of information: a person, thing, place, time, manner, number, or choice.

Question word	Plain English	Easy example
مَنْ	who?	مَنْ هَذَا؟ - Who is this?
مَا	what?	مَا هَذَا؟ - What is this?
مَاذَا	what?	مَاذَا كَتَبْتَ؟ - What did you write?
أَيْنَ	where?	أَيْنَ الْكِتَابُ؟ - Where is the book?
مَتَى	when?	مَتَى سَافَرَ أَحْمَدُ؟ - When did Ahmed travel?
كَيْفَ	how?	كَيْفَ حَالُكَ؟ - How are you?
كَمْ	how many/how much?	كَمْ كِتَابًا عِنْدَكَ؟ - How many books do you have?
أَيُّ	which?	أَيُّ كِتَابٍ تُرِيدُ؟ - Which book do you want?

Beginner note: some question words have their own grammatical rules. For example, words after كَمْ and أَيّ need more detailed analysis. For now, learn the meaning and recognise the structure. We will revisit the deeper rules later.

Lesson 71 - مَنْ and مَا

مَنْ normally asks about a person. مَا normally asks about a thing, identity, or meaning.

Question	Answer
مَنْ هَذَا؟ - Who is this?	هَذَا أَحْمَدُ - This is Ahmed.
مَنْ فَتَحَ الْبَابَ؟ - Who opened the door?	فَتَحَهُ عَلِيٌّ - Ali opened it.
مَا هَذَا؟ - What is this?	هَذَا كِتَابٌ - This is a book.

Think about what information is missing. If the missing information is a person, مَنْ is a natural choice. If it is a thing or identity, مَا may be appropriate.

Lesson 72 - أَيْنَ، مَتَى، كَيْفَ

Question word	What it asks for	Example
أَيْنَ	place	أَيْنَ أَحْمَدُ؟ - Where is Ahmed?
مَتَى	time	مَتَى يَبْدَأُ الدَّرْسُ؟ - When does the lesson begin?
كَيْفَ	manner/condition	كَيْفَ ذَهَبْتَ؟ - How did you go?

Do not translate word by word mechanically. Ask what information the speaker is requesting.

Lesson 73 - Negation: What Does It Mean?

Negation makes a positive statement negative.

Positive idea	Negative idea
Ahmed wrote.	Ahmed did not write.
He writes.	He does not write.
The house is big.	The house is not big.
He will travel.	He will not travel.

English uses words such as “not,” “did not,” and “will not.” Arabic has several negative particles, and the correct one depends partly on the kind of sentence and the time meaning.

Lesson 74 - Basic Present Negation with لَا

One very common beginner pattern is لَا + present-tense verb.

Positive	Negative	Meaning
يَكْتُبُ أَحْمَدُ	لَا يَكْتُبُ أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed does not write / is not writing (depending on context).
أَشْرَبُ الْقَهْوَةَ	لَا أَشْرَبُ الْقَهْوَةَ	I do not drink coffee.
يَذْهَبُ إِلَى السُّوقِ	لَا يَذْهَبُ إِلَى السُّوقِ	He does not go to the market.

Important: Arabic has more than one type of لَا. The لَا used for an ordinary negative statement is not the same grammatical use as the لَا used to say “Do not...”. We separate them below.

Lesson 75 - Past Negation with مَا

A simple and common way to negate a past verb is to put مَا before it.

Positive	Negative	Meaning
كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ	مَا كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed did not write.
ذَهَبَ عَلِيٌّ	مَا ذَهَبَ عَلِيٌّ	Ali did not go.
فَتَحَ الْوَلَدُ الْبَابَ	مَا فَتَحَ الْوَلَدُ الْبَابَ	The boy did not open the door.

At this beginner stage, notice something useful: with this use of مَا, the past verb itself remains in its ordinary past form.

Lesson 76 - “Did Not” with لَمْ

Arabic also commonly expresses past negation with لَمْ followed by a present-form verb.

Arabic	Meaning
لَمْ يَكْتُبْ أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed did not write.
لَمْ يَذْهَبْ عَلِيٌّ	Ali did not go.
لَمْ يَفْتَحْ الْوَلَدُ الْبَابَ	The boy did not open the door.

Connection to Unit 10: لَمْ makes the present verb **majzūm**. In simple sound verbs, sukūn is often the visible sign: يَكْتُبُ becomes يَكْتُبْ.

Do not rush the exceptions. Weak verbs and the five verbs show jazm differently. Those details belong in later Nahw/Sarf study.

Lesson 77 - Future Negation with لَنْ

لَنْ is commonly used for future negation.

Arabic	Meaning
لَنْ أَذْهَبَ	I will not go.
لَنْ يَكْتُبَ أَحْمَدُ	Ahmed will not write.
لَنْ نَفْتَحَ الْبَابَ	We will not open the door.

Connection to Unit 10: لَنْ makes the present verb **manṣūb**. In an ordinary sound singular present verb, fatḥah is often the visible sign: يَكْتُبُ → لَنْ يَكْتُبَ.

Lesson 78 - “Is Not” with لَيْسَ

A simple nominal sentence has no visible “is” in the present:

الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

The house is big.

To say “The house is not big,” Arabic commonly uses لَيْسَ:

لَيْسَ الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرًا

The house is not big.

> **Preview only:** لَيْسَ behaves grammatically like the كَانَ family: its noun is normally marfūʿ and its predicate is normally manṣūb. We will study this family properly in Intermediate Nahw. For now, recognise the structure and meaning.

Positive	Negative
أَحْمَدُ مَرِيضٌ - Ahmed is ill.	لَيْسَ أَحْمَدُ مَرِيضًا - Ahmed is not ill.
السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةٌ	لَيْسَتِ السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةً

Lesson 79 - Negative Commands: “Do Not...”

To tell someone not to do something, Arabic uses لَا النَّاهِيَةُ with a present-form verb in jazm.

Positive command	Negative command	Meaning
اُكْتُبْ	لَا تَكْتُبْ	Write! / Do not write!
اِفْتَحْ	لَا تَفْتَحْ	Open! / Do not open!
اِجْلِسْ	لَا تَجْلِسْ	Sit! / Do not sit!

> **Compare carefully:**
> لَا تَكْتُبُ = you do not write / you are not writing (statement, depending on context).
> لَا تَكْتُبْ = do not write! (prohibition).
> The final vowel helps show that these are not the same grammatical structure.

Lesson 80 - Choosing the Right Negative Tool

Meaning you want	Beginner tool	Example
ordinary present/habit negative	لَا	لَا أَشْرَبُ الْقَهْوَةَ
simple past negative	مَا + past	مَا ذَهَبَ
past “did not”	لَمْ + present form	لَمْ يَذْهَبْ
future “will not”	لَنْ + present form	لَنْ يَذْهَبَ
“is not” in a nominal idea	لَيْسَ	لَيْسَ الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرًا
prohibition: “do not”	لَا النَّاهِيَةُ	لَا تَذْهَبْ

> **Accuracy note:** Arabic negation is richer than this beginner chart. Some particles overlap in real usage, and tense/aspect can be more subtle. This chart gives you a safe beginner framework, not every advanced possibility.

Lesson 81 - Questions and Negation Together

You can combine question structures with negative meaning.

Arabic	Meaning
هَلْ لَا تَشْرَبُ الْقَهْوَةَ؟	Do you not drink coffee?
لِمَاذَا لَمْ تَذْهَبْ؟	Why did you not go?
مَنْ لَمْ يَحْضُرْ؟	Who did not attend?
مَتَى لَنْ تَكُونَ هُنَا؟	When will you not be here? (grammatically possible; context determines naturalness)

The main skill is to identify each word's job separately: question word, negative particle, verb, doer, object, and so on.

Common Beginner Mistakes

Mistake	Better understanding
Thinking every question begins with هَلْ.	Information questions use words such as مَنْ، مَا، أَيْنَ، مَتَى، كَيْفَ.
Using one negative particle for every tense.	Arabic has several negative tools; choose according to meaning and structure.
Writing لَمْ يَكْتُبُ.	لَمْ causes jazm: لَمْ يَكْتُبْ.
Writing لَنْ يَكْتُبُ.	لَنْ causes nasb: لَنْ يَكْتُبَ.
Thinking لَا تَكْتُبُ and لَا تَكْتُبْ are identical.	The first can be an ordinary negative statement; the second is a prohibition: “Do not write.”

Guided Practice

A. Choose the correct question word.

1. _____ هَذَا؟ (Who is this person?)
2. _____ الْكِتَابُ؟ (Where is the book?)
3. _____ يَبْدَأُ الدَّرْسُ؟ (When does the lesson begin?)
4. _____ حَالُكَ؟ (How are you?)
5. _____ هَذَا؟ (What is this thing?)

Answers with explanation

1. مَنْ - asks about a person.
2. أَيْنَ - asks about place.
3. مَتَى - asks about time.
4. كَيْفَ - asks about condition/manner.
5. مَا - asks what a thing is.

B. Make each sentence negative in the way requested.

1. كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ - use مَا.
2. يَكْتُبُ أَحْمَدُ - use ordinary لَا.
3. يَكْتُبُ أَحْمَدُ - make it “Ahmed did not write” with لَمْ.
4. يَكْتُبُ أَحْمَدُ - make it “Ahmed will not write” with لَنْ.
5. الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ - make it “The house is not big.”

Answers

1. مَا كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ.
2. لَا يَكْتُبُ أَحْمَدُ.
3. لَمْ يَكْتُبْ أَحْمَدُ. Notice the sukūn: the verb is majzūm.
4. لَنْ يَكْتُبَ أَحْمَدُ. Notice the fatḥah: the verb is manṣūb.
5. لَيْسَ الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرًا.

C. Explain the difference.

1. لَا تَكْتُبُ
2. لَا تَكْتُبْ

Answer: لَا تَكْتُبُ can be a negative statement such as “you do not write.” لَا تَكْتُبْ is a prohibition: “Do not write.” The second verb is majzūm.

Unit 13 Checkpoint Exam

1. What kind of answer does a question with هَلْ normally expect?

2. What does مَنْ ask about?

3. What does أَيْنَ ask about?

4. Translate: مَا هَذَا؟

5. Make “Ahmed wrote” into a yes/no question using هَلْ.

6. Negate ذَهَبَ عَلِيٌّ with مَا.

7. Negate “Ahmed writes” using ordinary لَا.

8. Make “Ahmed did not write” using لَمْ.

9. Why does يَكْتُبُ become يَكْتُبْ after لَمْ?

10. Make “Ahmed will not write” using لَنْ.

11. What grammatical state does لَنْ cause in the present verb?

12. Translate: لَيْسَ الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرًا.

13. What is the difference between ordinary negative لَا and لَا النَّافِيَةُ?

14. Translate: لَا تَفْتَحْ الْبَابَ.

15. Choose the correct question word for “When did Muhammad travel?” and write the Arabic question.

Model answers

1. A yes/no answer or confirmation.
2. A person: “who?”
3. A place: “where?”
4. What is this?
5. هَلْ كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ؟
6. مَا ذَهَبَ عَلِيٌّ.
7. لَا يَكْتُبُ أَحْمَدُ.
8. لَمْ يَكْتُبْ أَحْمَدُ.
9. Because لَمْ causes jazm; for this sound singular verb, sukūn is the visible sign.
10. لَنْ يَكْتُبَ أَحْمَدُ.
11. Nasb: the verb becomes manṣūb.
12. The house is not big.
13. Ordinary negative لَا makes a negative statement; لَا النَّاهِيَةُ gives a prohibition, “do not,” and causes jazm.
14. Do not open the door.
15. مَتَى سَافَرَ مُحَمَّدٌ؟

Mastery target before Unit 14

You should be able to recognise yes/no questions, choose the main question words by meaning, distinguish a question from a statement, make simple present/past/future negatives, recognise لَمْ and لَنْ as particles that affect the present verb, and distinguish an ordinary negative statement from a negative command.

Unit 13 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
هَلْ أَنْتَ طَالِبٌ؟ asks yes/no. أَيْنَ الْكِتَابُ؟ asks for a place.

Contrast pair
لَا تَكْتُبُ can negate “you do not write”; لَا تَكْتُبْ can function as “do not write!” with prohibitive la.

Error-correction focus
Wrong: treating every negative particle as grammatically identical. Fix: each particle has its own use and may affect the following verb differently.

Build it yourself
Write one yes/no question, one “where” question, one past negative and one future negative.

Spiral review
Analyse the noun jobs inside one of your question sentences.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 14 - Full Beginner Sentence Analysis

Unit 14 of 15

Unit 14 learning plan

Before you begin
All Units 1-13.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Apply a repeatable analysis method.
- Analyse mixed nominal and verbal sentences.
- Give beginner I'rab for familiar structures.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
تَحْلِيلٌ	analysis
إِعْرَابٌ	grammatical parsing
وَظِيفَةٌ	job/function
عَلَامَةٌ	sign/marker

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Unit goal: bring together everything from Units 1-13. You will learn a repeatable method for analysing a sentence without guessing. By the end of this unit, you should be able to identify the word family, sentence type, grammatical job, grammatical state, visible sign, and important phrase relationships in a beginner-level sentence.

Important: Full analysis does not mean saying every advanced rule you know. Good analysis is organised. First understand the meaning. Then identify the structure. Then add the grammatical labels that you have already learned.

Lesson 82 - A Five-Step Method for Analysing Any Beginner Sentence

When students see a longer Arabic sentence, they often try to analyse everything at once. That creates confusion. Instead, use the same five steps every time.

Step	Question	What you are looking for
1	What does the sentence mean?	Understand the basic message before using grammar labels.
2	What kind of sentence is it?	Nominal sentence or verbal sentence.
3	What is each word?	Ism, Fi'l, or Harf; then smaller types such as pronoun, adjective, preposition.
4	What job is each word doing?	Mubtada', Khabar, Fa'il, Maf'ul Bihi, adjective, Mudaf Ilayh, etc.
5	What state and sign does that job require?	Raf', Nasb, Jarr, or Jazm, and the visible sign when you have learned it.

Memory rule: Meaning first - structure second - labels third - endings last.

Worked example

كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ

Word	Type	Job	State	Visible sign
كَتَبَ	past verb	the action	built form; not analysed with noun case	-
الطَّالِبُ	Ism	فَاعِلٌ - doer	مَرْفُوعٌ	ḍammah
الدَّرْسَ	Ism	مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ - object	مَنْصُوبٌ	fatḥah

Meaning: **The student wrote the lesson.** Because the sentence begins with a verb, it is a verbal sentence. The student performs the action, so الطَّالِبُ is the Fa'il. The lesson receives the action, so الدَّرْسَ is the Maf'ul Bihi.

Lesson 83 - Analysing a Simple Nominal Sentence

الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

Meaning: **The house is big.**

Word	Type	Job	State	Why?
الْبَيْتُ	Ism	مُبْتَدَأٌ	مَرْفُوعٌ	The sentence begins by talking about the house.
كَبِيرٌ	Ism used as a description	خَبَرٌ	مَرْفُوعٌ	It tells us something about the house.

Key distinction: الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ means “the big house” and is a noun + adjective phrase. الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ means “the house is big” and is a complete nominal sentence.

Lesson 84 - Analysing a Verbal Sentence with an Adjective

كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ الدَّرْسَ

Meaning: **The hardworking student wrote the lesson.**

Word	Job	State	Explanation
كَتَبَ	past verb	-	It gives the action.
الطَّالِبُ	Fa‘il	marfū‘	The student performed the action.
الْمُجْتَهِدُ	adjective of الطَّالِبُ	marfū‘	The adjective follows its noun in case, definiteness, gender and number.
الدَّرْسَ	Maf‘ul Bihi	manṣūb	The lesson received the action.

Do not analyse an adjective independently from the noun it describes. First find the noun, then ask whether the following description agrees with it.

Lesson 85 - Analysing a Prepositional Phrase

الطَّالِبُ فِي الْفَصْلِ

Meaning: **The student is in the classroom.**

Word	Analysis
الطَّالِبُ	Mubtada’, marfū‘.
فِي	preposition - حَرْفُ جَرٍّ.
الْفَصْلِ	noun after the preposition, therefore majrūr.

The phrase فِي الْفَصْلِ gives the information about the student. At beginner level, it is enough to say that the prepositional phrase functions as the Khabar. Later, advanced Nahw will explain the hidden relationship in more technical detail.

Professor-level accuracy note: In detailed I'rab, grammarians often say the prepositional phrase is connected to an omitted Khabar, rather than saying the two visible words themselves are literally the Khabar. This beginner book gives the functional explanation first.

Lesson 86 - Analysing Idafah Inside a Sentence

بَابُ الْبَيْتِ مَفْتُوحٌ

Meaning: **The door of the house is open.**

Word	Job	State	Extra relationship
بَابُ	Mubtada'	marfū'	It is also مُضَافٌ.
الْبَيْتِ	Mudaf Ilayh	majrūr	It completes the Idafah: "of the house."
مَفْتُوحٌ	Khabar	marfū'	It tells us that the door is open.

A word can have more than one description. بَابُ is the Mubtada' of the sentence and at the same time the Mudaf of the Idafah phrase.

Lesson 87 - Analysing an Attached Pronoun

كِتَابُهُ جَدِيدٌ

Meaning: **His book is new.**

Part	Analysis
كِتَابُ	Mubtada', marfū'; it is also Mudaf.
هُ	attached pronoun meaning "his"; grammatically it is in a genitive relationship as Mudaf Ilayh.
جَدِيدٌ	Khabar, marfū'.

Do not treat كِتَابُهُ as one undivided grammatical idea. The written word contains a noun plus an attached pronoun with its own grammatical relationship.

Lesson 88 - Analysing a Demonstrative Construction

هَذَا الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ

Meaning: **This student is hardworking.**

At beginner level, analyse هَذَا الطَّالِبُ together as the subject/topic expression and مُجْتَهِدٌ as the Khabar. The demonstrative identifies which student we mean.

Part	Simple analysis
هَذَا	demonstrative Ism: “this.”
الطَّالِبُ	the noun being pointed to.
مُجْتَهِدٌ	Khabar: “hardworking.”

Do not overcomplicate this yet. Detailed analysis of demonstratives and the noun after them can vary with structure and is better expanded at intermediate level. For Beginner Nahw, recognise the demonstrative phrase and its function in the sentence.

Lesson 89 - Analysing Negation

لَمْ يَكْتُبْ أَحْمَدُ الدَّرْسَ

Meaning: **Ahmed did not write the lesson.**

Word	Analysis
لَمْ	particle of negation and jazm; it gives past negative meaning with a present-form verb.
يَكْتُبْ	present verb made majzūm by لَمْ; sukūn is the visible sign here.
أَحْمَدُ	Fa‘il, marfū‘.
الدَّرْسَ	Maf‘ul Bihi, manṣūb.

Notice the order of reasoning: first recognise لَمْ; then know what it does to the present verb; then analyse the doer and object normally.

Compare with لَنْ

لَنْ يَكْتُبَ أَحْمَدُ الدَّرْسَ

لَنْ gives future negation and causes nasb in the present verb. Therefore يَكْتُبُ becomes يَكْتُبَ.

Lesson 90 - Analysing a Question

هَلْ كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الدَّرْسَ؟

Word	Analysis
هَلْ	question particle asking for yes/no confirmation.
كَتَبَ	past verb.
أَحْمَدُ	Fa'il, marfū'.
الدَّرْسَ	Maf'ul Bihi, manṣūb.

The question particle changes the sentence into a question, but it does not remove the internal verbal-sentence structure.

Lesson 91 - A Longer Mixed Sentence

كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ دَرْسَ النَّحْوِ فِي الدَّفْتَرِ

Meaning: **The hardworking student wrote the Nahw lesson in the notebook.**

Word or phrase	Analysis
كَتَبَ	past verb.
الطَّالِبُ	Fa'il, marfū'.
الْمُجْتَهِدُ	adjective describing the Fa'il; marfū' to agree with it.
دَرْسَ	Maf'ul Bihi, manṣūb; also Mudaf.
النَّحْوِ	Mudaf llayh, majrūr.
فِي	preposition.
الدَّفْتَرِ	noun after the preposition, majrūr.

This is the point of the whole beginner book: one sentence can contain several structures at the same time. You do not need a new rule for the whole sentence. You recognise the smaller structures you already know and combine them.

Lesson 92 - Beginner I‘rab: How to State an Analysis Clearly

الإِعْرَابُ can mean grammatical analysis, especially explaining a word's grammatical position/state and its sign. At beginner level, use a short, repeatable formula.

Example word	Beginner I‘rab formula
الطَّالِبُ in كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ	فَاعِلٌ مَرْفُوعٌ وَعَلَامَةُ رَفْعِهِ الضَّمَّةُ - a doer, marfūʿ, and its sign of raf‘ is the ḍammah.
الدَّرْسَ	مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ مَنْصُوبٌ وَعَلَامَةُ نَصْبِهِ الْفَتْحَةُ.
الْبَيْتِ after فِي	اسْمٌ مَجْرُورٌ وَعَلَامَةُ جَرِّهِ الْكَسْرَةُ.

For now, do not force this formula onto forms whose signs you have not studied properly. Duals, sound plurals, five nouns, diptotes and other special signs will be expanded later in the curriculum.

Lesson 93 - Common Analysis Traps

Trap	Correct approach
Calling every noun after a verb the Fa‘il.	Ask who actually performed the action. Some nouns may be objects or part of prepositional phrases.
Calling every description a Khabar.	A description may be an adjective. Check whether it agrees with a noun and forms one phrase with it.
Seeing kasrah and automatically saying “preposition.”	Kasrah is a sign. First identify the cause of jarr: preposition, Idafah, or another rule.
Analysing an Idafah as adjective + noun.	Check the relationship: “book of the student” is Idafah; “new book” is adjective agreement.
Ignoring attached pronouns.	Attached pronouns can carry possession, object meaning or prepositional meaning and should be recognised.
Starting with the final vowel before understanding the sentence.	Meaning and grammatical job come first. The ending confirms the analysis.

Guided Practice - Full Analysis

A. Analyse the sentence in five steps.

فَتَحَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّغِيرُ بَابَ الْبَيْتِ

1. Translate the sentence.
2. Nominal or verbal?
3. Identify the verb, Fa'il and Maf'ul Bihi.
4. Identify the adjective.
5. Identify the Idafah.

Model answer

1. The small boy opened the door of the house.
2. Verbal sentence because it begins with فَتَحَ.
3. Verb: فَتَحَ. Fa'il: الْوَلَدُ, marfū'. Maf'ul Bihi: بَابَ, manṣūb.
4. الصَّغِيرُ describes الْوَلَدُ and is therefore also marfū'.
5. بَابَ الْبَيْتِ: بَابَ is Mudaf and الْبَيْتِ is Mudaf Ilayh, majrūr.

B. Analyse:

الطَّالِبُ الْجَدِيدُ فِي الْفَصْلِ

Model answer

Meaning: The new student is in the classroom.
الطَّالِبُ = Mubtada', marfū'.
الْجَدِيدُ = adjective describing the Mubtada', marfū'.
فِي = preposition.
الْفَصْلِ = noun after the preposition, majrūr.
The prepositional phrase gives the Khabar meaning.

C. Analyse the effect of the negative particle:

لَنْ يَفْتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ

Model answer
لَنْ = negative particle causing nasb in the present verb and giving future negative meaning.
يَفْتَحَ = present verb, manṣūb after لَنْ; fatḥah is the visible sign here.
أَحْمَدُ = Fa'il, marfū'.
الْبَابَ = Maf'ul Bihi, manṣūb.
Meaning: Ahmed will not open the door.

Independent Practice

For each sentence: translate it, identify the sentence type, then analyse every important word or phrase using only rules from this book.

1. الْمُعَلِّمُ فِي الْمَدْرَسَةِ

2. قَرَأَ الطَّالِبُ الْكِتَابَ الْجَدِيدَ

3. كِتَابُ الْمُعَلِّمِ عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ

4. هَذَا الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

5. لَمْ يَشْرَبْ عَلِيٌّ الْمَاءَ

6. هَلْ دَخَلَ مُحَمَّدٌ الْفَصْلَ؟

7. فِي بَيْتِ الطَّالِبِ غُرْفَةٌ كَبِيرَةٌ

8. لَا تَفْتَحْ بَابَ الْغُرْفَةِ

Unit 14 Checkpoint Exam

1. Write the five analysis steps in order.

2. Analyse الْجَوُّ جَمِيلٌ.

3. Analyse كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الرِّسَالَةَ.

4. In الطَّالِبُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ, what is the relationship between the two words?

5. Analyse فِي الْبَيْتِ.

6. Analyse the Idafah in بَابُ الْفَصْلِ.

7. In كِتَابُهُ جَدِيدٌ, what does هُ mean and what relationship does it have to كِتَابُ?

8. Analyse لَمْ يَكْتُبْ مُحَمَّدٌ.

9. What does لَنْ do to a present verb?

10. Analyse هَلْ فَتَحَ عَلِيٌّ الْبَابَ؟.

11. Fully analyse قَرَأَ الطَّالِبُ الْجَدِيدُ كِتَابَ النَّحْوِ.

12. Explain why it is dangerous to decide a word's job only from its final vowel.

13. Give the beginner I‘rab formula for a normal singular Fa‘il ending in ḍammah.

14. Give the beginner I‘rab formula for a normal singular direct object ending in fatḥah.

15. Explain the difference between الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ and الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ.

Model answers

1. Meaning; sentence type; word type; grammatical job; state and sign.

2. الْجَوُّ = Mubtada’, marfūʿ by ḍammah. جَمِيلٌ = Khabar, marfūʿ by ḍammah. Meaning: The weather is beautiful.

3. كَتَبَ past verb; أَحْمَدُ Faʿil, marfūʿ; الرِّسَالَةَ Mafʿul Bihi, manṣūb.

4. الْمُجْتَهِدُ is an adjective describing الطَّالِبُ; it agrees with it in the features studied in this book.

5. فِي is a preposition; الْبَيْتِ is a majrūr noun after it. Together they form a prepositional phrase.

6. بَابُ is Mudaf; الْفَصْلِ is Mudaf Ilayh and therefore majrūr.

7. هُ means “his.” It is an attached pronoun in the possessive/genitive relationship, functioning as Mudaf Ilayh.

8. لَمْ is a negative/jussive particle; يَكْتُبْ is majzūm by لَمْ; مُحَمَّدٌ is Faʿil, marfūʿ.

9. It causes nasb in the present verb and normally gives future negative meaning.

10. هَلْ question particle; فَتَحَ past verb; عَلِيٌّ Faʿil, marfūʿ; الْبَابَ Mafʿul Bihi, manṣūb.

11. قَرَأَ past verb; الطَّالِبُ Faʿil, marfūʿ; الْجَدِيدُ adjective of the Faʿil, marfūʿ; كِتَابَ Mafʿul Bihi, manṣūb and Mudaf; النَّحْوِ Mudaf Ilayh, majrūr.

12. The ending is a sign, not the reason. First identify meaning and grammatical job; then use the ending as evidence.

13. فَاعِلٌ مَرْفُوعٌ وَعَلَامَةُ رَفْعِهِ الضَّمَّةُ.

14. مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ مَنْصُوبٌ وَعَلَامَةُ نَصْبِهِ الْفَتْحَةُ.

15. الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ is one noun phrase: “the big house.” الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ is a complete nominal sentence: “the house is big.”

Mastery target before Unit 15

You should now be able to take a beginner sentence apart systematically, identify the structures you have studied, explain why the important nouns are marfūʿ, manṣūb or majrūr, recognise basic jazm/nasb effects on present verbs, and give a short beginner iʿrab without guessing from the final vowel alone.

Unit 14 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
Analyse كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ فِي الدَّفْتَرِ: verb → doer → object → preposition + majrur noun.

Contrast pair
Do not jump straight to the final vowel. First identify word family, then structure, then job/state, then sign.

Error-correction focus
Wrong method: “I see kasrah, therefore I know everything.” Fix: explain why the word is in jarr and what caused it.

Build it yourself
Take one sentence from Units 8-13 and write a full beginner analysis for every word.

Spiral review
Use your five-question analysis method without looking back at the answer key.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Unit 15 - Revision, Mastery and Final Exams

Unit 15 of 15

Unit 15 learning plan

Before you begin
Complete Units 1-14.

By the end of this unit, you should be able to:

- Recall the entire Beginner Nahw framework.
- Correct common mistakes.
- Build and analyse sentences independently.
- Reach at least 80% mastery before moving on.

Mini vocabulary bank

Arabic	Plain English
مُرَاجَعَةٌ	revision
اِخْتِبَارٌ	exam/test
إِجَابَةٌ	answer
خَطَأٌ	mistake
صَحِيحٌ	correct

Self-study / teacher note: Read examples aloud, explain the rule in your own words, then complete practice without looking back. Aim for at least 80% before moving on.

Mastery standard for Book 1: aim for at least **80%** on cumulative reviews and the final exam. A lower score is not failure; it tells you exactly which unit to revisit before moving on.

Purpose of this final unit
This unit does not introduce a large new grammar topic. Its job is to make the knowledge from Units 1-14 usable. You will revise the main ideas, correct common mistakes, build sentences, analyse complete sentences, and then take a final Beginner Nahw examination.

Important: Passing a grammar course is not the same as memorising terminology. A beginner is ready to move forward when they can explain the meaning of a sentence, identify the major grammatical relationships, and give the reason for the important endings.

1. Master Revision Map

Area	You should now understand	Typical example
Word families	Ism, Fi'l and Harf	كِتَابٌ، كَتَبَ، فِي
Ism system	Gender, number, definiteness, pronouns and demonstratives	هَذِهِ الطَّالِبَةُ
Adjectives	Agreement and the difference between phrase and sentence	الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ / الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ
Sentence types	Nominal and verbal sentences	أَحْمَدُ طَالِبٌ / كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ
Nominal sentence	Mubtada' and Khabar	الْجَوُّ جَمِيلٌ
Verbal sentence	Verb, Fa'il and Maf'ul Bihi	فَتَحَ عَلِيٌّ الْبَابَ
Case states	Raf', nasb, jarr and beginner jazm	الطَّالِبُ / الطَّالِبَ / الطَّالِبِ / يَكْتُبْ
Prepositions	Harf Jarr + majrūr noun	فِي الْبَيْتِ
Idafah	Mudaf + Mudaf Ilayh	كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ
Questions	Question particles and question words	هَلْ، مَنْ، مَا، أَيْنَ، مَتَى، كَيْفَ
Negation	Basic use of لَا، مَا، لَمْ، لَنْ، لَيْسَ	لَمْ يَكْتُبْ
Analysis	Meaning - sentence type - word type - grammatical job - state/sign	Full beginner I'rab

2. The Five Questions to Ask Every Time

Question 1 - What does the sentence mean?
Never begin with the ending. First understand the message.

Question 2 - What type of sentence is it?
Nominal or verbal? This immediately narrows the possible jobs.

Question 3 - What kind of word is each important word?
Ism, Fi'l or Harf? Then identify smaller types where you can.

Question 4 - What grammatical job is the word doing?
Mubtada', Khabar, Fa'il, Maf'ul Bihi, adjective, Mudaf Ilayh, noun after a preposition, and so on.

Question 5 - What state and sign follow from that job?
Raf‘, nasb, jarr or jazm? What visible sign is used in this example?

3. Rapid Recognition Drill

Classify each item. Give the most useful beginner label.

1. فِي
2. كَتَبَ
3. جَمِيلٌ
4. هُوَ
5. هَذَا
6. الطَّالِبُ in كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ
7. الرِّسَالَةَ in كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الرِّسَالَةَ
8. الْبَيْتِ in فِي الْبَيْتِ
9. الْمُعَلِّمِ in كِتَابُ الْمُعَلِّمِ
10. كَبِيرٌ in الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ

Answers with reasons
1. Harf - specifically a preposition.
2. Fi‘l - a past verb.
3. Ism - functioning as a description/adjective when it describes a noun.
4. Ism - detached pronoun.
5. Ism - demonstrative.
6. Fa‘il - the doer; normally marfū‘.
7. Maf‘ul Bihi - the direct object; normally manṣūb.
8. Noun after a preposition; majrūr.
9. Mudaf Ilayh; majrūr.
10. Khabar; normally marfū‘.

4. Error-Correction Clinic

The following mistakes are deliberately chosen because beginners make them often. Correct the Arabic or the analysis and explain the reason.

#	Incorrect idea	Your task
1	فِي الْبَيْتُ	Correct the ending.
2	كَتَبَ الطَّالِبَ الدَّرْسَ	Correct the normal singular Fa‘il.
3	الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرٌ	Correct adjective agreement.
4	كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ	Correct the first member of the Idafah.
5	“كَبِيرٌ cannot be an Ism because it is an adjective.”	Explain the error.
6	“Every Arabic sentence begins with a verb.”	Explain the error.
7	“Kasrah always means there is a preposition.”	Explain the error.
8	لَمْ يَكْتُبُ	Correct the present verb ending.
9	لَنْ يَكْتُبُ	Correct the present verb ending.
10	“In الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ, كَبِيرٌ is merely an adjective attached to الْبَيْتُ.”	Explain the correct structure.

Corrections

1. فِي الْبَيْتِ - the noun after فِي is majrūr.
2. كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ - the Fa‘il is normally marfū‘.
3. الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ - the adjective agrees with the definite marfū‘ noun here.
4. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ - the first member of a normal Idafah does not take tanwin.
5. Traditional Arabic grammar places adjectives inside the broad category Ism.
6. Arabic has both nominal and verbal sentences.
7. Kasrah is a sign of jarr in many examples; jarr can be caused by a preposition or Idafah and has other signs in other noun types.
8. لَمْ يَكْتُبْ - لَمْ causes jazm.
9. لَنْ يَكْتُبَ - لَنْ causes nasb.
10. It is a complete nominal sentence: الْبَيْتُ is Mubtada’ and كَبِيرٌ is Khabar.

Sentence-Building Workshop

> **Goal:** grammar should help you build correct Arabic, not only label sentences that somebody else wrote.

5. Build a Nominal Sentence

Turn each pair into a simple nominal sentence.

1. house / big - الْبَيْتُ / كَبِيرٌ
2. student / hardworking - الطَّالِبُ / مُجْتَهِدٌ
3. car / new - السَّيَّارَةُ / جَدِيدَةٌ
4. books / useful - الْكُتُبُ / مُفِيدَةٌ

1. الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ
2. الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ
3. السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةٌ
4. الْكُتُبُ مُفِيدَةٌ. The non-human plural is treated as feminine singular for adjective agreement at this level.

6. Build a Verbal Sentence

Arrange the ideas into Arabic verbal sentences.

1. Ahmed / opened / the door
2. the student / read / the book
3. Muhammad / drank / the water
4. the small boy / wrote / the lesson

Possible answers:
1. فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ
2. قَرَأَ الطَّالِبُ الْكِتَابَ
3. شَرِبَ مُحَمَّدٌ الْمَاءَ
4. كَتَبَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّغِيرُ الدَّرْسَ

7. Build an Idafah

Translate into a basic Idafah.

1. the student's book
2. the house's door / the door of the house
3. Ahmed's car
4. the teacher's room

1. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ
2. بَابُ الْبَيْتِ
3. سَيَّارَةُ أَحْمَدَ
4. غُرْفَةُ الْمُعَلِّمِ

8. Build with Prepositions

Translate.

1. in the house
2. from the school
3. to the mosque
4. on the table
5. with him

1. فِي الْبَيْتِ
2. مِنَ الْمَدْرَسَةِ
3. إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ
4. عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ
5. مَعَهُ

9. Build Questions and Negatives

Translate the intended meaning.

1. Did Ahmed enter the house?
2. Where is the book?
3. Muhammad did not write.
4. Ali will not open the door.
5. Do not write!

Possible answers:
1. هَلْ دَخَلَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَيْتَ؟
2. أَيْنَ الْكِتَابُ؟
3. لَمْ يَكْتُبْ مُحَمَّدٌ
4. لَنْ يَفْتَحَ عَلِيٌّ الْبَابَ
5. لَا تَكْتُبْ!

Cumulative Exam A - Recognition

Part 1 - Word and phrase recognition

1. Classify إِلَى as Ism, Fi'l or Harf.
2. Classify جَمِيلٌ in the broad traditional category.
3. Is هُوَ an Ism, Fi'l or Harf?
4. What kind of verb is اُكْتُبْ?
5. What does هَذِهِ mean and what kind of word is it?

Part 2 - Noun system

6. Is مُحَمَّدٌ a common noun or proper noun?
7. Give the feminine form of طَالِبٌ.
8. Give the dual meaning of طَالِبَانِ.
9. Is كُتُبٌ a sound plural or broken plural?
10. Explain why الْكُتُبُ جَدِيدَةٌ uses a feminine singular description.

Part 3 - Definiteness and structure

11. Which is definite: بَيْتٌ or الْبَيْتُ?
12. Explain the difference between الطَّالِبُ الْجَدِيدُ and الطَّالِبُ جَدِيدٌ.
13. Identify the Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh in بَابُ الْفَصْلِ.
14. What case state is normally caused by a preposition?
15. What is the broad job of ـهُ in كِتَابُهُ?

Answer Key - Exam A

1. Harf.
2. Ism; it can function as an adjective.
3. Ism; detached pronoun.
4. Command verb.
5. “This” for feminine singular; a demonstrative Ism.
6. Proper noun.
7. طَالِبَةٌ.
8. Two male students / two students in the masculine dual form.
9. Broken plural.
10. Non-human plurals normally take feminine singular agreement in this beginner rule.
11. الْبَيْتُ is definite.
12. First is one phrase “the new student”; second is a sentence “the student is new.”
13. بَابُ = Mudaf; الْفَصْلِ = Mudaf Ilayh.
14. Jarr.
15. Attached possessive pronoun, in a genitive/Idafah-type relationship.

Cumulative Exam B - Grammatical Jobs

For each bolded Arabic word or phrase, identify its job and state where appropriate.

1. كَتَبَ **الطَّالِبُ** الدَّرْسَ
2. كَتَبَ الطَّالِبُ **الدَّرْسَ**
3. **الْجَوُّ** جَمِيلٌ
4. الْجَوُّ **جَمِيلٌ**
5. فِي **الْمَسْجِدِ**
6. كِتَابُ **الطَّالِبِ**
7. الطَّالِبُ **الْمُجْتَهِدُ**
8. **لَمْ** يَكْتُبْ
9. لَمْ **يَكْتُبْ**
10. لَنْ **يَكْتُبَ**

Answer Key - Exam B

1. Fa‘il, marfū‘.
2. Maf‘ul Bihi, manṣūb.
3. Mubtada’, marfū‘.
4. Khabar, marfū‘.
5. Noun governed by a preposition, majrūr.
6. Mudaf Ilayh, majrūr.
7. Adjective describing a marfū‘ definite noun, therefore marfū‘ here.
8. Negative/jussive particle.
9. Present verb made majzūm by لَمْ; sukūn is the visible sign in this simple example.
10. Present verb made manṣūb by لَنْ; fatḥah is the visible sign here.

Cumulative Exam C - Full Sentence Analysis

Use the five-step method on each sentence.

1. الطَّالِبُ مُجْتَهِدٌ

2. فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ

3. الطَّالِبُ الْجَدِيدُ فِي الْفَصْلِ

4. كِتَابُ الْمُعَلِّمِ عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ

5. قَرَأَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّغِيرُ كِتَابَ النَّحْوِ

6. لَمْ يَدْخُلْ مُحَمَّدٌ الْبَيْتَ

7. لَنْ يَفْتَحَ عَلِيٌّ بَابَ الْغُرْفَةِ

8. هَذِهِ السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةٌ

9. أَيْنَ كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ؟

10. فِي بَيْتِ الْمُعَلِّمِ غُرْفَةٌ كَبِيرَةٌ

Model analysis highlights

1. Nominal: الطَّالِبُ Mubtada’ marfū‘; مُجْتَهِدٌ Khabar marfū‘.

2. Verbal: فَتَحَ past verb; أَحْمَدُ Fa‘il marfū‘; الْبَابَ Maf‘ul Bihi manṣūb.

3. Nominal: الطَّالِبُ Mubtada’; الْجَدِيدُ adjective; فِي الْفَصْلِ prepositional phrase functioning as the Khabar meaning.

4. Nominal: كِتَابُ begins an Idafah and is the Mubtada’; الْمُعَلِّمِ Mudaf Ilayh majrūr; عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ prepositional phrase gives the Khabar meaning.

5. Verbal: قَرَأَ verb; الْوَلَدُ Fa‘il marfū‘; الصَّغِيرُ adjective marfū‘; كِتَابَ direct object manṣūb and Mudaf; النَّحْوِ Mudaf Ilayh majrūr.

6. لَمْ causes jazm; يَدْخُلْ majzūm; مُحَمَّدٌ Fa‘il; الْبَيْتَ direct object/complement in this beginner analysis.

7. لَنْ causes nasb; يَفْتَحَ manṣūb; عَلِيٌّ Fa‘il; بَابَ object and Mudaf; الْغُرْفَةِ Mudaf Ilayh.

8. هَذِهِ demonstrative; السَّيَّارَةُ identifies the demonstrated noun; جَدِيدَةٌ Khabar.

9. أَيْنَ asks about place; كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ is an Idafah inside the question.

10. Fronted prepositional phrase فِي بَيْتِ الْمُعَلِّمِ gives the Khabar meaning; غُرْفَةٌ is the delayed Mubtada’; كَبِيرَةٌ describes غُرْفَةٌ. More advanced ordering will be studied later.

Cumulative Exam D - Sentence Production

Write Arabic sentences meeting each requirement. More than one answer may be correct.

1. A nominal sentence with a masculine singular Mubtada’ and Khabar.
2. A nominal sentence with a feminine singular noun.
3. A verbal sentence containing a Fa‘il and Maf‘ul Bihi.
4. A sentence containing an adjective phrase.
5. A sentence containing an Idafah.
6. A sentence containing a prepositional phrase.
7. A yes/no question using هَلْ.
8. A question using أَيْنَ.
9. A past negative sentence using لَمْ.
10. A future negative sentence using لَنْ.

Possible answers

1. الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ.
2. السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةٌ.
3. كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الدَّرْسَ.
4. رَأَيْتُ الْبَيْتَ الْكَبِيرَ - this includes vocabulary beyond some earlier drills but illustrates agreement.
5. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ جَدِيدٌ.
6. الْكِتَابُ عَلَى الطَّاوِلَةِ.
7. هَلْ أَنْتَ طَالِبٌ؟
8. أَيْنَ الْكِتَابُ؟
9. لَمْ يَكْتُبْ أَحْمَدُ.
10. لَنْ يَذْهَبَ مُحَمَّدٌ.

Diagnostic and Cumulative Review Answer Bank

Diagnostic Pre-Test

1. How words work together. 2. A naming word/category such as person, place, thing or idea. 3. A word expressing action/state. 4. A word replacing a noun/person. 5. opened. 6. Ahmed. 7. the door. 8. Ism. 9. Fi'l. 10. Harf. 11. Makes it definite in the basic use. 12. he. 13. singular = one; plural = more than one. 14. the house. 15. in the house. 16. Ahmed. 17. Yes. 18. A word that describes a noun/Ism. 19. It shows a relationship such as place/direction/time and in Arabic may affect case. 20. Any correct Arabic word + meaning.

Cumulative Review 1 - Units 1-3

1. Nahw studies word jobs/relationships in sentences. 2. Nahw = sentence job; Sarf = word structure/change. 3. Ism, Fi'l, Harf. 4. Any two valid signs such as الـ, tanwin, after a preposition, after يَا. 5. Example رَجُلٌ / أَحْمَدُ. 6. Example طَالِبٌ / طَالِبَةٌ. 7. طَالِبَانِ. 8. Sound masculine plural. 9. Broken plural. 10. Traditional Ism is broader than English noun and includes adjectives.

Cumulative Review 2 - Units 4-6

1. A word standing for a noun/person. 2. Example detached هُوَ; attached كَتَبْتُ; hidden أَكْتُبُ with understood أَنَا. 3. his book. 4. هَذَا / هَذِهِ. 5. ذَلِكَ / تِلْكَ. 6. هَذَانِ / هَذَيْنِ. 7. indefinite = non-specific; definite = identified. 8. Examples: الـ, proper name, pronoun, demonstrative, definite Idafah, relative pronoun. 9. A pronoun points to an identified referent in context. 10. "This is a book" vs "this book".

Cumulative Review 3 - Units 7-9

1. Gender, number, definiteness and case. 2. الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ. 3. Non-human plurals normally take feminine singular adjective agreement in standard beginner examples. 4. A sentence beginning with an Ism-type construction. 5. Mubtada' = starting topic; Khabar = information about it. 6. A sentence beginning with a verb in the basic pattern. 7. Fa'il = doer; Maf'ul Bihi = direct object. 8. Example جَلَسَ أَحْمَدُ. 9. Example فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ. 10. With an overt plural/dual subject after the verb, the basic standard verb-first pattern normally uses a singular verb while matching gender.

Cumulative Review 4 - Units 10-12

1. Identifying grammatical state/sign from the word's role. 2. State is the grammatical condition; sign is what shows it. 3. Raf', nasb, jarr. 4. Raf', nasb, jazm. 5. It causes jarr. 6. Any three, e.g. فِي، مِنْ، إِلَى. 7. First and second nouns of Idafah; second is majrūr. 8. First normally has no tanwin and no الـ in basic Idafah; second is majrūr. 9. It is definite because the second noun الطَّالِبِ is definite. 10. فِي causes بَيْتِ to be majrūr; الطَّالِبِ is Mudaf Ilayh and majrūr.

How to use these reviews: If you score below 80% on one review, revisit only the units named in that review, then retake it before continuing.

Marking Rubrics for Analysis and I'rab

Skill	Full-credit standard	Partial credit
Meaning	Accurate plain-English meaning of the sentence.	Main meaning understood but one word inaccurate.
Word type	Correctly identifies Ism / Fi'l / Harf and relevant sub-type.	Broad family correct but sub-type missing.
Grammatical job	Correct role: Mubtada', Khabar, Fa'il, Maf'ul Bihi, adjective, Mudaf Ilayh, etc.	Sentence structure understood but one role mislabeled.
State	Correct raf' / nasb / jarr / jazm where applicable.	Correct job but state omitted.
Visible sign	Correct sign when the sign has been taught in Book 1.	Correct state but sign omitted or minor sign error.
Explanation	Explains *why* the word has that job/state.	Correct answer without explanation.

Final Beginner Nahw Examination

Final Exam Coverage Map

Exam area	Main units sampled
Foundations / word families	Units 1-3
Pronouns / demonstratives / definiteness	Units 4-6
Adjectives / sentence types / doer-object / agreement	Units 7-9
Case states / prepositions / Idafah	Units 10-12
Questions / negation / full analysis	Units 13-14
Production and cumulative mastery	Units 1-14

Suggested marking: 100 marks. **Mastery target: 80%.** The exam samples the entire Beginner Nahw course. If you score below 80%, use the coverage map to identify which units to revisit, then retake the relevant section.

Section A - Foundations (20 marks)

1. Explain Nahw in plain English. (2)
2. Explain the difference between Nahw and Sarf. (2)
3. Name the three broad Arabic word families. (3)
4. Give two signs that can help identify an Ism. (2)
5. Name the three basic verb types. (3)
6. Explain why an adjective such as كَبِيرٌ belongs to the broad Ism category. (2)
7. Explain definite vs indefinite in simple English. (2)
8. What is the difference between a nominal and verbal sentence? (2)
9. What is I'rab in beginner terms? (2)

Section B - Structures and Jobs (25 marks)

10. Define Mubtada' and Khabar. (4)
11. Define Fa'il and Maf'ul Bihi. (4)
12. Explain the four grammatical states introduced in this book. (4)
13. What normally happens to a noun after a preposition? (2)
14. Define Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh. (4)
15. Give two rules of a basic Idafah. (2)
16. Explain adjective agreement at beginner level. (3)
17. Explain the non-human plural agreement rule. (2)

Section C - Correct the Mistake (15 marks)

Correct each and explain briefly.

18. فِي الْمَسْجِدُ (3)
19. كَتَبَ أَحْمَدَ الرِّسَالَةَ (3)
20. الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ (3)
21. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ (3)
22. لَمْ يَذْهَبُ (3)

Section D - Full Analysis (25 marks)

Analyse the important words and structures.

23. الطَّالِبُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ فِي الْفَصْلِ (5)

24. فَتَحَ الْوَلَدُ الصَّغِيرُ بَابَ الْبَيْتِ (6)

25. لَمْ يَكْتُبْ مُحَمَّدٌ الدَّرْسَ (5)

26. هَذِهِ السَّيَّارَةُ جَدِيدَةٌ (4)

27. أَيْنَ كِتَابُ الْمُعَلِّمِ؟ (5)

Section E - Produce Arabic (15 marks)

28. Write “The house is big.” (2)
29. Write “the big house.” (2)
30. Write “Ahmed opened the door.” (3)
31. Write “the student's book.” (2)
32. Write “in the school.” (2)
33. Write “Muhammad did not write.” using لَمْ. (2)
34. Write “Where is the teacher?” (2)

Final Examination - Detailed Answer Guide

1. Nahw studies the grammatical jobs and relationships of words inside sentences.

2. Nahw asks what a word is doing in the sentence. Sarf studies how the word itself is built and changes form.

3. اِسْمٌ، فِعْلٌ، حَرْفٌ.

4. Possible signs include accepting الـ, tanwin, coming after a preposition, or being addressed after يَا. Not every Ism shows every sign.

5. Past, present/future, and command: مَاضٍ، مُضَارِعٌ، أَمْرٌ.

6. Traditional Arabic grammar uses Ism as a broad category that includes nouns, adjectives, pronouns, demonstratives and other noun-type words.

7. Indefinite means non-specific; definite means identified/specific in grammar. Example: بَيْتٌ vs الْبَيْتُ.

8. A nominal sentence begins with an Ism-type construction; a verbal sentence begins with a verb in the basic distinction taught here.

9. I'rab is identifying the grammatical state of a changeable word and the sign showing that state, after understanding its grammatical job.

10. Mubtada' is the starting noun/topic of a basic nominal sentence; Khabar gives information about it. Both are normally marfū' in the simple pattern.

11. Fa'il is the doer of the verb and is normally marfū'. Maf'ul Bihi is the direct object receiving the action and is normally manṣūb.

12. Raf', nasb and jarr apply to nouns in the ways introduced; jazm applies to present verbs. These are grammatical states, not merely vowel names.

13. It becomes majrūr. In a normal singular example the visible sign is often kasrah.

14. Mudaf is the first noun in an Idafah; Mudaf Ilayh is the second noun, which is majrūr.

15. The first noun normally does not take tanwin and normally does not take الـ as the first member of a simple Idafah; the second noun is majrūr.

16. The adjective agrees with the noun it describes in the features introduced: gender, number, definiteness and case in the relevant examples.

17. A non-human plural is normally treated as feminine singular for adjective agreement in standard beginner examples.

18. فِي الْمَسْجِدِ. The preposition causes jarr.

19. كَتَبَ أَحْمَدُ الرِّسَالَةَ. Ahmed is the Fa'il and is normally marfū'.

20. الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ. The adjective agrees with the definite marfū' noun.

21. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ. The first noun of the Idafah loses tanwin; the second is majrūr.

22. لَمْ يَذْهَبْ. لَمْ causes jazm.

23. الطَّالِبُ = Mubtada' marfū'; الْمُجْتَهِدُ = adjective marfū' agreeing with it; فِي = preposition; الْفَصْلِ = majrūr noun; the prepositional phrase gives the Khabar meaning.

24. فَتَحَ = past verb; الْوَلَدُ = Fa'il marfū'; الصَّغِيرُ = adjective marfū'; بَابَ = Maf'ul Bihi manṣūb and Mudaf; الْبَيْتِ = Mudaf Ilayh majrūr.

25. لَمْ = negative/jussive particle; يَكْتُبْ = present verb majzūm; مُحَمَّدٌ = Fa'il marfū'; الدَّرْسَ = Maf'ul Bihi manṣūb.

26. هَذِهِ = feminine singular demonstrative; السَّيَّارَةُ = demonstrated noun; جَدِيدَةٌ = Khabar in the sentence "This car is new."

27. أَيْنَ asks about place; كِتَابُ is the first member of the Idafah; الْمُعَلِّمِ is Mudaf Ilayh majrūr. Meaning: Where is the teacher's book?

28. الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ.
29. الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ.
30. فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ.
31. كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ.
32. فِي الْمَدْرَسَةِ.
33. لَمْ يَكْتُبْ مُحَمَّدٌ.
34. أَيْنَ الْمُعَلِّمُ؟.

How to Interpret Your Result

Score	Interpretation	Action
90-100	Very strong beginner mastery	Review mistakes and proceed to Beginner Sarf while revising Nahw.
80-89	Book 1 mastery standard met	Repair any weak unit, then proceed.
70-79	Close, but not yet at the mastery target	Use the exam coverage map, revise weak units, and retake the relevant section.
Below 70	Important foundation gaps remain	Return to the earliest weak cumulative review and rebuild from there.

Unit 15 Enrichment Lab

Worked example
Choose one final-exam sentence and analyse it in four passes: meaning → word family → grammatical job → state/sign.

Contrast pair
Recognition is easier than production. Mastery means you can both identify a rule and build a correct example yourself.

Error-correction focus
Wrong study method: rereading only. Fix: retrieve from memory, correct mistakes, rebuild sentences, then re-test.

Build it yourself
Create a six-sentence mini-test for yourself covering nominal sentence, verbal sentence, adjective, preposition, Idafah, and negation.

Spiral review
Return to your diagnostic pre-test and compare what you can now explain without help.

Mastery statement	Check
I can explain this unit’s main ideas in plain English.	☐
I can identify the structure in an Arabic example.	☐
I can produce at least one correct example without copying.	☐
I scored 80% or higher on this unit’s review/checkpoint.	☐

Pronunciation and Case-Ending Guide

Why endings matter
At beginner level, short vowels at the end of a word often help you hear its grammatical state. Do not treat the vowel as the job itself: first identify the job/state, then use the ending as a clue.

Common beginner ending	Sound	What it often signals	Example
ـٌ / ـُ	u / un	Often raf‘	الطَّالِبُ / طَالِبٌ
ـً / ـَ	a / an	Often nasb	الدَّرْسَ / دَرْسًا
ـٍ / ـِ	i / in	Often jarr	الْبَيْتِ / بَيْتٍ
ـْ	no short vowel	Can be a beginner sign of jazm on a present verb	لَمْ يَكْتُبْ

Pronunciation habit: read each example once slowly with the ending, then once naturally. In pause, final short vowels may not be pronounced in ordinary reading, but learning them helps you understand Nahw.

Visual Sentence Maps

Map 1 - Verbal sentence

كَتَبَ
verb
→
الطَّالِبُ
doer
→
الدَّرْسَ
object

Map 2 - Nominal sentence

الْبَيْتُ
Mubtada’
→
كَبِيرٌ
Khabar
→
complete meaning

Map 3 - Prepositional phrase

فِي
preposition
→
الْبَيْتِ
majrur noun
→
فِي الْبَيْتِ
phrase

Map 4 - Idafah

كِتَابُ
Mudaf
→
الطَّالِبِ
Mudaf Ilayh
→
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ
the student’s book

Common Mistakes Index

Use this as a final revision checklist. If you make one of these mistakes, return to the relevant unit and rebuild the rule from meaning.

Common mistake	Correction
Calling an adjective “not an Ism”	Remember: adjective is a smaller type inside the broad Ism family.
Assuming every Ism accepts الـ	Pronouns and some other Ism types do not.
Forgetting dual	Arabic distinguishes one, two, and plural.
Mixing هُوَ with ـهُ	Detached and attached pronouns have different forms/jobs.
Using demonstratives without gender awareness	Match basic gender/number, then learn special plural rules.
Writing الرَّجُلُ كَبِيرٌ when you mean a full sentence	Khabar is normally marfu‘: الرَّجُلُ كَبِيرٌ.
Confusing adjective phrase with nominal sentence	Definiteness often distinguishes الرَّجُلُ الْكَبِيرُ from الرَّجُلُ كَبِيرٌ.
Assuming first noun is always the doer	Find the verb and ask who performed it.
Treating ḍammah as “raf‘ itself”	Raf‘ is the state; ḍammah is one sign.
Treating kasrah as the reason for jarr	A governor such as a preposition causes jarr; kasrah may show it.
Putting tanwin on the first noun of basic Idafah	The Mudaf normally loses tanwin.
Putting الـ on the first noun of a basic Idafah	Basic Idafah normally leaves the first noun without الـ.
Making Mudaf Ilayh non-majrur	The second noun in Idafah is majrur.
Using one negation rule for لا، لم، لن	These particles differ in meaning and grammatical effect.
Starting I‘rab with the vowel only	Start with meaning → word family → job/state → sign.

Beginner Nahw Glossary

How to use this glossary

1. Find the Arabic grammar term you saw in a lesson.
2. Read the plain-English meaning before memorising the label.
3. Return to the lesson if you need examples or a full explanation.
4. Use the Master Terminology Index on pages 179-180 for quick review pages.
5. If two terms look similar, compare their grammatical job, not only their ending.

Tip: learn the meaning first, then the Arabic term, then practise it in a sentence.

Arabic term	Plain English meaning in this book
نَحْوٌ	Sentence grammar; the jobs and relationships of words.
صَرْفٌ	Word structure and how word forms change.
اِسْمٌ	Broad noun-type category, including nouns, adjectives, pronouns and more.
فِعْلٌ	Verb.
حَرْفٌ	Particle.
مُبْتَدَأٌ	Starting noun/topic of a basic nominal sentence.
خَبَرٌ	Information given about the Mubtada’.
فَاعِلٌ	Doer/subject of the verb.
مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ	Direct object receiving the action.
نَعْتٌ / صِفَةٌ	Adjective/description.
مُضَافٌ	First noun of an Idafah.
مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ	Second noun of an Idafah; majrūr.
مَرْفُوعٌ	In the state of raf‘.
مَنْصُوبٌ	In the state of nasb.
مَجْرُورٌ	In the state of jarr.
مَجْزُومٌ	Present verb in the state of jazm.
ضَمَّةٌ	Ḍammah; often a visible sign of raf‘ in simple singular nouns.
فَتْحَةٌ	Fatḥah; often a visible sign of nasb in simple singular nouns.
كَسْرَةٌ	Kasrah; often a visible sign of jarr in simple singular nouns.
سُكُونٌ	Sukūn; one visible sign of jazm in appropriate present verbs.
مَعْرِفَةٌ	Definite.
نَكِرَةٌ	Indefinite.
جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ	Nominal sentence.
جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ	Verbal sentence.
حَرْفُ جَرٍّ	Preposition that causes jarr in the following noun.
إِضَافَةٌ	Noun-to-noun possession/relationship structure.
إِعْرَابٌ	Grammatical analysis of a word's state and sign based on its role.

Master Terminology Index

Arabic term	Transliteration	Simple English meaning	Pages
اِسْمٌ	ism	noun-type word / broad nominal category	14-73
فِعْلٌ	fi'l	verb	14-18
حَرْفٌ	harf	particle	14-18
ضَمِيرٌ	damir	pronoun	34-44
مُذَكَّرٌ	mudhakkar	masculine	25-28
مُؤَنَّثٌ	mu'annath	feminine	25-29
مُفْرَدٌ	mufrad	singular	26-30
مُثَنًّى	muthanna	dual	26-28
جَمْعٌ	jam'	plural	26-31
نَكِرَةٌ	nakirah	indefinite	54-64
مَعْرِفَةٌ	ma'rifah	definite	54-64
نَعْتٌ / صِفَةٌ	na't / sifah	adjective	65-73
جُمْلَةٌ اسْمِيَّةٌ	jumlah ismiyyah	nominal sentence	74-82
جُمْلَةٌ فِعْلِيَّةٌ	jumlah fi'liyyah	verbal sentence	74-82
مُبْتَدَأٌ	mubtada'	starter/topic of nominal sentence	75-77
خَبَرٌ	khabar	predicate/information	75-77
فَاعِلٌ	fa'il	doer / verbal subject	83-95
مَفْعُولٌ بِهِ	maf'ul bihi	direct object	85-95
إِعْرَابٌ	i'rab	grammatical inflection/parsing	96-107, 142-154
رَفْعٌ	raf'	nominative grammatical state	98-107
نَصْبٌ	nasb	accusative/subjunctive state	99-107
جَرٌّ	jarr	genitive state	100-130
جَزْمٌ	jazm	jussive state	102-107, 135-141
حَرْفُ جَرٍّ	harf jarr	preposition	108-119
مُضَافٌ	mudaf	first noun in Idafah	120-130

مُضَافٌ إِلَيْهِ	mudaf ilayh	second noun in Idafah	120-130
إِضَافَةٌ	idafah	construct/possessive structure	120-130

Translation Support Appendix

Purpose: no learner should have to guess the meaning of a teaching example. In explanation and reference sections, Arabic is paired with clear English. In exercises that intentionally test comprehension, the English meaning is supplied in the answer/support section rather than beside the question.

High-frequency sentences used throughout Book 1

Arabic sentence	Plain English	Main grammar point
فَتَحَ أَحْمَدُ الْبَابَ	Ahmed opened the door.	verb + doer + object
كَتَبَ مُحَمَّدٌ الدَّرْسَ	Muhammad wrote the lesson.	Fa'il and Maf'ul Bihi
شَرِبَ الْوَلَدُ الْمَاءَ	The boy drank the water.	direct object
قَرَأَ الطَّالِبُ الْكِتَابَ	The student read the book.	verbal sentence
جَلَسَ عَلِيٌّ	Ali sat.	verb with no direct object
الْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	The house is big.	Mubtada' + Khabar
الْبَيْتُ الْكَبِيرُ	The big house.	noun + adjective phrase
هَذَا كِتَابٌ	This is a book.	demonstrative + Khabar
هَذَا الْكِتَابُ	This book.	demonstrative phrase
هَذِهِ سَيَّارَةٌ جَدِيدَةٌ	This is a new car.	feminine demonstrative + adjective
فِي الْبَيْتِ	In the house.	preposition + majrur noun
إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ	To the mosque.	preposition + majrur noun
كِتَابُ الطَّالِبِ	The student's book.	Idafah
بَابُ الْبَيْتِ	The door of the house.	Idafah
بَابُ بَيْتِ الطَّالِبِ	The door of the student's house.	Idafah chain
كِتَابُهُ جَدِيدٌ	His book is new.	attached possessive pronoun
رَأَيْتُهُ	I saw him.	attached object pronoun
ذَهَبَ الطَّالِبُ إِلَى الْمَدْرَسَةِ	The student went to the school.	verbal sentence + prepositional phrase
الطَّالِبُ الْمُجْتَهِدُ فِي الْفَصْلِ	The hard-working student is in the classroom.	adjective + prepositional Khabar
لَمْ يَكْتُبْ مُحَمَّدٌ الدَّرْسَ	Muhammad did not write the lesson.	negation with lam + jazm
لَنْ يَكْتُبَ الطَّالِبُ الدَّرْسَ	The student will not write the lesson.	negation with lan + nasb
لَا تَكْتُبْ	Do not write.	negative command
هَلْ أَنْتَ طَالِبٌ؟	Are you a student?	yes/no question

Root-Family Bridge to Beginner Sarf

What is a root? A root is a set of basic consonants that carries a central meaning. A root is not usually a complete word by itself. Different patterns build real words from the same root.

ك ت ب

كَتَبَ ← كِتَابٌ ← كَاتِبٌ ← مَكْتُوبٌ

he wrote ← book ← writer ← written

Boundary: this appendix helps you notice word families. Full pattern analysis, added letters, Forms I-X, weak roots and derivation belong to Beginner Sarf. The 60 roots below are **60 different root families**; duplicates have been removed.

60 useful Arabic root families

Root	Core idea	Examples from the family	Plain English
ك ت ب	writing	كَتَبَ، كِتَابٌ، كَاتِبٌ، مَكْتُوبٌ	wrote, book, writer, written
ع ل م	knowledge	عَلِمَ، عِلْمٌ، عَالِمٌ، مَعْلُومٌ، مُعَلِّمٌ	knew, knowledge, scholar, known, teacher
د ر س	study	دَرَسَ، دَرْسٌ، مَدْرَسَةٌ، مُدَرِّسٌ	studied, lesson, school, teacher
ف ت ح	opening	فَتَحَ، فَتْحٌ، فَاتِحٌ، مَفْتُوحٌ	opened, opening, opener, opened
د خ ل	entering	دَخَلَ، دُخُولٌ، دَاخِلٌ، مَدْخَلٌ	entered, entering, inside, entrance
خ ر ج	going out	خَرَجَ، خُرُوجٌ، خَارِجٌ، مَخْرَجٌ	went out, going out, outside, exit
ج ل س	sitting	جَلَسَ، جُلُوسٌ، جَالِسٌ، مَجْلِسٌ	sat, sitting, one sitting, gathering/ place of sitting
ن ص ر	help/support	نَصَرَ، نَصْرٌ، نَاصِرٌ، مَنْصُورٌ	helped, help/victory, helper, supported
س م ع	hearing	سَمِعَ، سَمْعٌ، سَامِعٌ، مَسْمُوعٌ	heard, hearing, listener, heard/ audible
ق ر أ	reading	قَرَأَ، قِرَاءَةٌ، قَارِئٌ، مَقْرُوءٌ	read, reading, reader, read/readable

60 useful Arabic root families - continued

Root	Core idea	Examples from the family	Plain English
ح ف ظ	preserving / memorising	حَفِظَ، حِفْظٌ، حَافِظٌ، مَحْفُوظٌ	memorised/preserved, preservation, memoriser, preserved
ع ب د	worship/service	عَبَدَ، عِبَادَةٌ، عَبْدٌ، مَعْبُودٌ	worshipped, worship, servant, object of worship
ر ح م	mercy	رَحِمَ، رَحْمَةٌ، رَحِيمٌ، مَرْحُومٌ	had mercy, mercy, merciful, shown mercy
س ل م	peace/safety/ submission	سَلِمَ، سَلَامٌ، إِسْلَامٌ، مُسْلِمٌ	was safe, peace, Islam/submission, Muslim
ص ب ر	patience	صَبَرَ، صَبْرٌ، صَابِرٌ	was patient, patience, patient person
ش ر ب	drinking	شَرِبَ، شُرْبٌ، شَرَابٌ، مَشْرُوبٌ	drank, drinking, drink, beverage
أ ك ل	eating	أَكَلَ، أَكْلٌ، آكِلٌ، مَأْكُولٌ	ate, eating, eater, eaten/edible
ذ ه ب	going	ذَهَبَ، ذَهَابٌ، ذَاهِبٌ	went, going, one going
ر ج ع	returning	رَجَعَ، رُجُوعٌ، رَاجِعٌ، مَرْجِعٌ	returned, return, one returning, reference/return point
ع م ل	work/action	عَمِلَ، عَمَلٌ، عَامِلٌ، مَعْمُولٌ	worked, work, worker, made/done
ل ع ب	playing	لَعِبَ، لَعْبٌ، لَاعِبٌ، مَلْعَبٌ	played, play, player, playground/ stadium
س ك ن	dwelling/stillness	سَكَنَ، سُكْنَى، سَاكِنٌ، مَسْكَنٌ	lived/dwelt, dwelling, resident, home
ط ل ب	seeking/requesting	طَلَبَ، طَلَبٌ، طَالِبٌ، مَطْلُوبٌ	requested/sought, request, student/ seeker, wanted
ف ه م	understanding	فَهِمَ، فَهْمٌ، فَاهِمٌ، مَفْهُومٌ	understood, understanding, one who understands, concept
ع ر ف	knowing/recognising	عَرَفَ، مَعْرِفَةٌ، عَارِفٌ، مَعْرُوفٌ	knew/recognised, knowledge, knower, known
ح م د	praise	حَمِدَ، حَمْدٌ، حَامِدٌ، مَحْمُودٌ	praised, praise, one who praises, praised
ش ك ر	gratitude	شَكَرَ، شُكْرٌ، شَاكِرٌ، مَشْكُورٌ	thanked, gratitude, thankful, thanked/appreciated

60 useful Arabic root families - continued

Root	Core idea	Examples from the family	Plain English
غ ف ر	forgiveness	غَفَرَ، مَغْفِرَةٌ، غَفُورٌ، مَغْفُورٌ	forgave, forgiveness, very forgiving, forgiven
د ع و	calling/inviting	دَعَا، دُعَاءٌ، دَاعٍ، مَدْعُوٌّ	called/invited/prayed, supplication, caller, invited
ه د ي	guidance	هَدَى، هُدًى، هِدَايَةٌ، هَادٍ	guided, guidance, guidance, guide
ق و ل	saying/speech	قَالَ، قَوْلٌ، قَائِلٌ، مَقُولٌ	said, saying, speaker, said/quoted
ب ي ع	selling	بَاعَ، بَيْعٌ، بَائِعٌ، مَبِيعٌ	sold, sale, seller, sold item
ق و م	standing/rising	قَامَ، قِيَامٌ، قَائِمٌ، مَقَامٌ	stood, standing, one standing, place/station
ن ز ل	descending/lodging	نَزَلَ، نُزُولٌ، نَازِلٌ، مَنْزِلٌ	descended, descent, one descending/guest, home
ر ك ب	riding	رَكِبَ، رُكُوبٌ، رَاكِبٌ، مَرْكُوبٌ	rode, riding, rider/passenger, ridden mount
س ج د	prostration	سَجَدَ، سُجُودٌ، سَاجِدٌ، مَسْجِدٌ	prostrated, prostration, one prostrating, mosque
ك ب ر	greatness/bigness	كَبُرَ، كَبِيرٌ، أَكْبَرُ، تَكْبِيرٌ	became big, big/great, bigger/greater, magnification
ص غ ر	smallness	صَغُرَ، صِغَرٌ، صَغِيرٌ، أَصْغَرُ	became small, smallness, small, smaller
ج م ل	beauty	جَمُلَ، جَمَالٌ، جَمِيلٌ، تَجَمَّلَ	was beautiful, beauty, beautiful, beautified oneself
ق ر ب	nearness	قَرُبَ، قُرْبٌ، قَرِيبٌ، اِقْتَرَبَ	became near, nearness, near, approached
ذ ك ر	remembering/mentioning	ذَكَرَ، ذِكْرٌ، ذَاكِرٌ، مَذْكُورٌ	mentioned, remembrance, one remembering, mentioned
و ج د	finding/existence	وَجَدَ، وُجُودٌ، مَوْجُودٌ	found, existence, present/existing
و ص ل	reaching/connecting	وَصَلَ، وُصُولٌ، وَاصِلٌ، مَوْصُولٌ	arrived/reached, arrival, reaching, connected
ن و م	sleeping	نَامَ، نَوْمٌ، نَائِمٌ، مَنَامٌ	slept, sleep, sleeping person, dream/sleeping place

60 useful Arabic root families - continued

Root	Core idea	Examples from the family	Plain English
س ي ر	travelling/moving	سَارَ، سَيْرٌ، سَائِرٌ، مَسِيرٌ	travelled, movement/journey, one moving, course/journey
ح ب ب	love	حَبَّ، حُبٌّ، حَبِيبٌ، مَحْبُوبٌ	loved, love, beloved, loved/beloved
ك ر م	generosity/honour	كَرُمَ، كَرَمٌ، كَرِيمٌ، إِكْرَامٌ	was noble, generosity, generous/noble, honouring
ق ط ع	cutting	قَطَعَ، قَطْعٌ، قَاطِعٌ، مَقْطُوعٌ	cut, cutting, cutter/decisive, cut off
ج م ع	gathering	جَمَعَ، جَمْعٌ، جَامِعٌ، مَجْمُوعٌ	gathered, collection, collector/gathering, collected
ف ص ل	separating/dividing	فَصَلَ، فَصْلٌ، فَاصِلٌ، مَفْصُولٌ	separated, division/chapter, separator, separated
ح ض ر	presence/attending	حَضَرَ، حُضُورٌ، حَاضِرٌ، مَحْضَرٌ	attended, attendance, present, record/meeting place
س أ ل	asking	سَأَلَ، سُؤَالٌ، سَائِلٌ، مَسْؤُولٌ	asked, question, asker, responsible/asked person
ن ظ ر	looking/considering	نَظَرَ، نَظَرٌ، نَاظِرٌ، مَنْظَرٌ	looked, looking/view, observer, view/scene
ح س ن	goodness/beauty	حَسُنَ، حُسْنٌ، حَسَنٌ، أَحْسَنُ	was good/beautiful, goodness, good, better/best
ش ه د	witnessing	شَهِدَ، شَهَادَةٌ، شَاهِدٌ، مَشْهُودٌ	witnessed, testimony, witness, witnessed
غ س ل	washing	غَسَلَ، غَسْلٌ، غَاسِلٌ، مَغْسُولٌ	washed, washing, washer, washed
ط ب خ	cooking	طَبَخَ، طَبْخٌ، طَبَّاخٌ، مَطْبَخٌ	cooked, cooking, cook, kitchen
ح م ل	carrying	حَمَلَ، حَمْلٌ، حَامِلٌ، مَحْمُولٌ	carried, carrying/load, carrier, carried
ب ن ي	building	بَنَى، بِنَاءٌ، بَانٍ، مَبْنِيٌّ	built, building, builder, built
م ل ك	owning/ruling	مَلَكَ، مُلْكٌ، مَلِكٌ، مَمْلُوكٌ	owned, ownership/kingdom, king, owned

Root Recognition Practice

How to study a root family

1. Find the three root letters.
2. Identify the shared central idea.
3. Notice extra letters and vowel changes in each real word.
4. Do not guess every meaning from the root alone - learn the actual word and its usage.
5. Save full pattern analysis for Sarf, where the rules are taught systematically.

Mini practice

1. Find the root of مَكْتُوبٌ.
2. Find the root of مَدْرَسَةٌ.
3. Find the root of مَسْجِدٌ.
4. Find the root of مَغْفِرَةٌ.
5. Find the root of مَعْلُومٌ.

Answers: ك ت ب، د ر س، س ج د، غ ف ر، ع ل م.

Ready for Beginner Sarf: you do not need to derive every word yet. Your goal here is simply to recognise that related words can share root letters and a broad meaning. Beginner Sarf will teach the patterns systematically.

Pre-Test vs Final Mastery Reflection

Return to the diagnostic pre-test from the beginning of the book. Answer it again without notes. Then compare your first attempt with your new answers.

I can now...	Yes / Review
Explain Nahw and Sarf in plain English.	☐ Yes ☐ Review
Classify Ism, Fi'l and Harf.	☐ Yes ☐ Review
Recognise pronouns, demonstratives, adjectives and Idafah.	☐ Yes ☐ Review
Distinguish nominal and verbal sentences.	☐ Yes ☐ Review
Identify Mubtada', Khabar, Fa'il and Maf'ul Bihi.	☐ Yes ☐ Review
Explain raf', nasb, jarr and jazm at beginner level.	☐ Yes ☐ Review
Analyse a mixed beginner sentence using the five-step method.	☐ Yes ☐ Review

Ready for the next book? If your final exam score is at least 80% and you can explain the checklist above without memorised scripts, you are ready to begin Beginner Sarf.

Publication QA Standards Used in This Edition

- Arabic examples are kept fully vocalised through the core beginner teaching sections unless a deliberate later-stage reading exercise says otherwise.
- Hamzah and alif spellings follow one consistent Modern Standard/Classical teaching convention.
- Arabic words are rendered right-to-left in a fixed-page PDF so mobile viewers cannot reorder letters or words.
- Guided-practice answers may appear near the exercise; mastery and cumulative-review answers are consolidated in the final unit.
- Nahw content is kept separate from full Sarf conjugation and root-pattern study.
- Every new Arabic teaching example is paired with plain-English meaning on first introduction; exercise-only Arabic is translated in the support/answer material.
- A 60-root-family bridge is included only as recognition preparation for Beginner Sarf, not as a substitute for systematic Sarf study. S

Final expert QA completed: Arabic/Nahw accuracy, English explanations, answer consistency, root-family uniqueness, cross-references and page layout were checked again. Future edits should be limited to genuine errata.

Readiness Checklist

Put a tick beside each statement you can genuinely do without looking at the answer.

- ☐ I can explain Ism, Fi'l and Harf.
- ☐ I can recognise the two main sentence types.
- ☐ I can find a basic Mubtada' and Khabar.
- ☐ I can find a basic Fa'il and Maf'ul Bihi.
- ☐ I understand why a preposition causes jarr.
- ☐ I can recognise an Idafah.
- ☐ I can distinguish an adjective phrase from a nominal sentence.
- ☐ I understand the difference between a grammatical state and its visible sign.
- ☐ I can explain the beginner use of raf', nasb, jarr and jazm.
- ☐ I can recognise basic question words and negation particles.
- ☐ I can analyse a mixed beginner sentence in five steps.
- ☐ I can build simple Arabic sentences using the structures in this book.

Specialist revision applied
This edition incorporates the first full specialist audit: global lesson renumbering, missing agreement rules, pronoun-category correction, dual demonstrative case forms, case-domain clarification, cumulative reviews, diagnostic assessment, rubrics, scope control, and publication-layout improvements. This edition includes the final translation-support and root-family expansion pass.

Next book in the paired curriculum: Beginner Sarf. It will teach roots, patterns, the 14 pronoun/conjugation positions, past and present conjugation, commands, Form I families, basic Masdar, active/passive participles, and the introduction to sound and weak verbs. Nahw revision should continue alongside it.

Arabic Step by Step

Book 1

Beginner Nahw

A Clear and Structured Introduction to Arabic Grammar

This book is designed for complete beginners who want to learn Arabic grammar (Nahw) in a clear, simple and structured way. It uses easy explanations, colourful examples, and practical exercises to help you build a strong foundation in the Arabic language.

What You Will Learn

- Parts of speech (ism, fi'l, harf)
- Nouns, verbs and particles
- Pronouns and their forms
- Adjectives and descriptive forms
- Sentence structure
- Real-life examples
- Practice exercises
- Unit reviews
- Mini vocabulary lists
- Step-by-step progression

Key Features



Clear Explanations



Practice Exercises



Progress Step by Step



Suitable for Self-Study

ISBN 978-1-739847-01-0

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